
Logic and Computer Design Fundamentals

Chapter 4 – Sequential Circuits

Part 1 – Storage Elements and Sequential Circuit Analysis

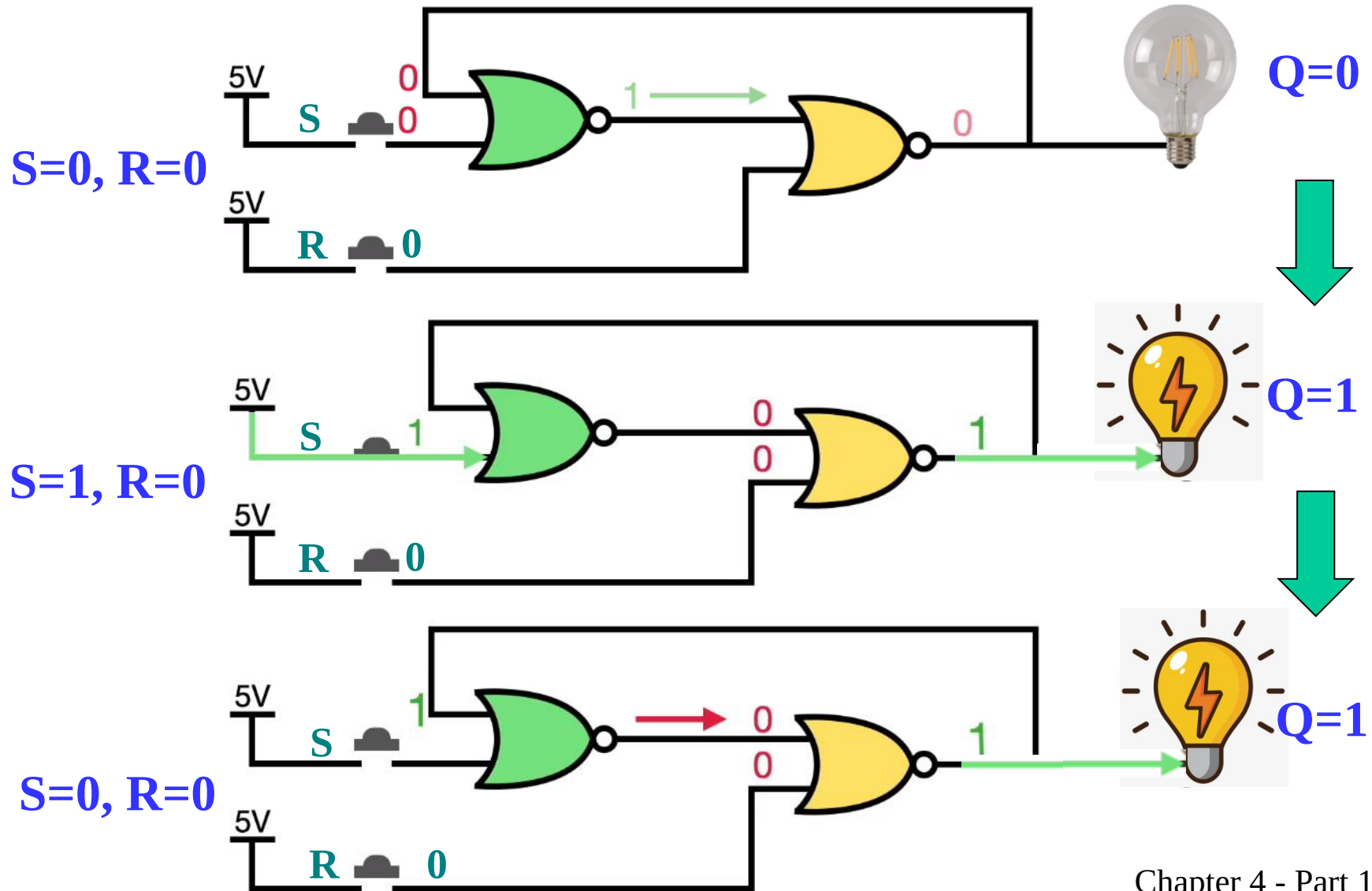
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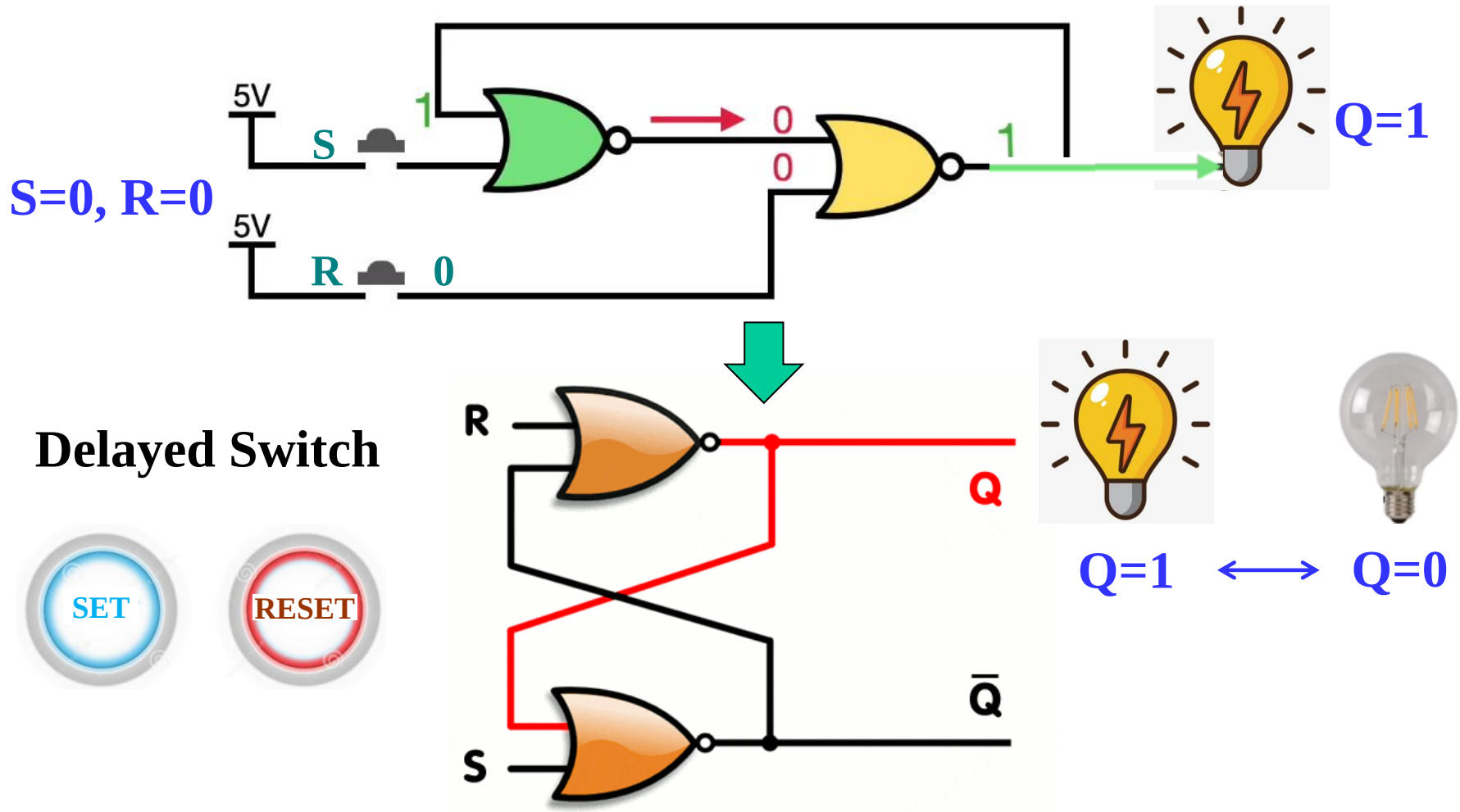
Overview

- **Part 1 - Storage Elements and Analysis**
 - Introduction to sequential circuits
 - Types of sequential circuits
 - Storage elements
 - Latches
 - Flip-flops
 - Sequential circuit analysis
 - State tables
 - State diagrams
 - Equivalent states
 - Moore and Mealy Models
- **Part 2 - Sequential Circuit Design**
- **Part 3 – State Machine Design**

Going Beyond Combinational Logic



Going Beyond Combinational Logic (continued)



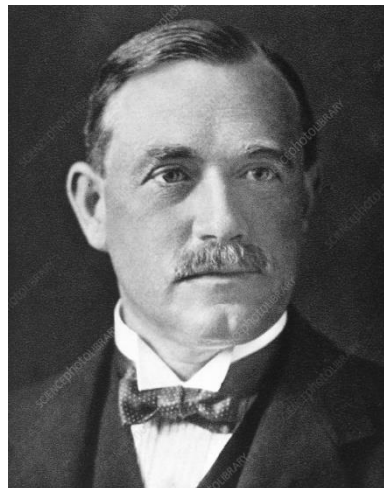
By **cross-coupling** two NOR/NAND gates, a **latch** can maintain two stable states using **positive feedback**.

Brief History of Latch

- The first **latch**—originally called a **trigger circuit**—was invented in **1918** by British physicists William Eccles and F. W. Jordan.
- At that time, most electronic devices used vacuum tubes to amplify and process signals. However, due to noise interference, signal transitions were often unreliable.
- Therefore, it became urgent to design a circuit with a "**memory**" that could stably store signal states, in order to improve the accuracy and stability of the devices.

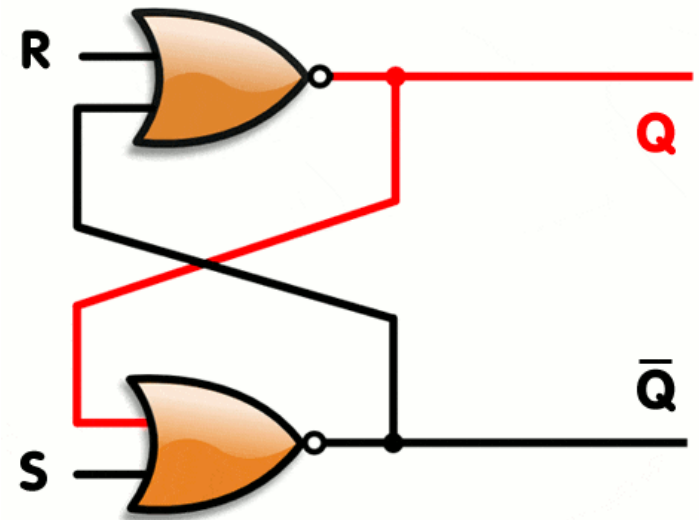
Brief History of Latch (continued)

- In an experiment, Jordan discovered that by introducing two vacuum tubes into a circuit and allowing them to **feedback** to each other, it was possible to achieve switching between two stable states.



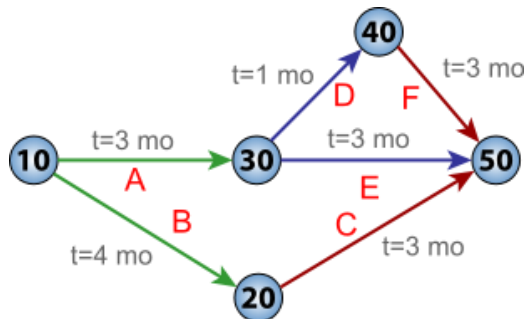
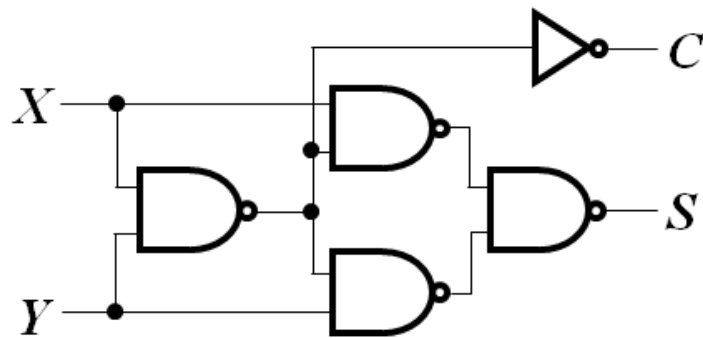
Frank Wilfred Jordan
1881 - 1941

William Eccles
1875-1966

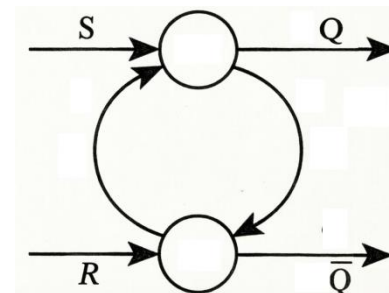
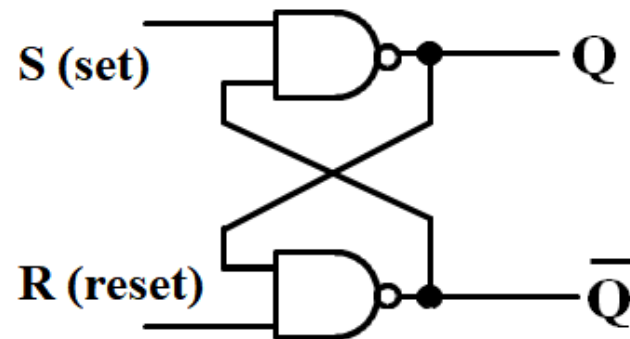


Going Beyond Combinational Logic (continued)

- A circuit whose output depends not only on the present input but also on the history of the input is called a **sequential circuit**.
- Combinational circuits vs. Sequential circuits



Combinational circuits

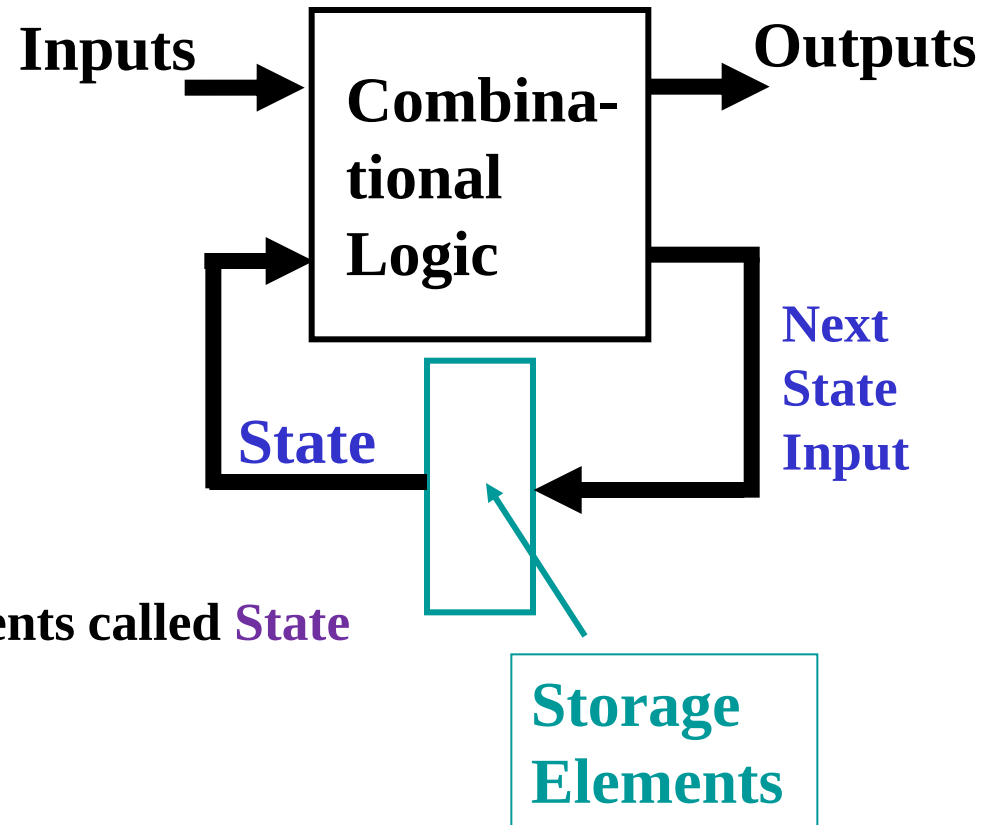


Sequential circuits

Introduction to Sequential Circuits

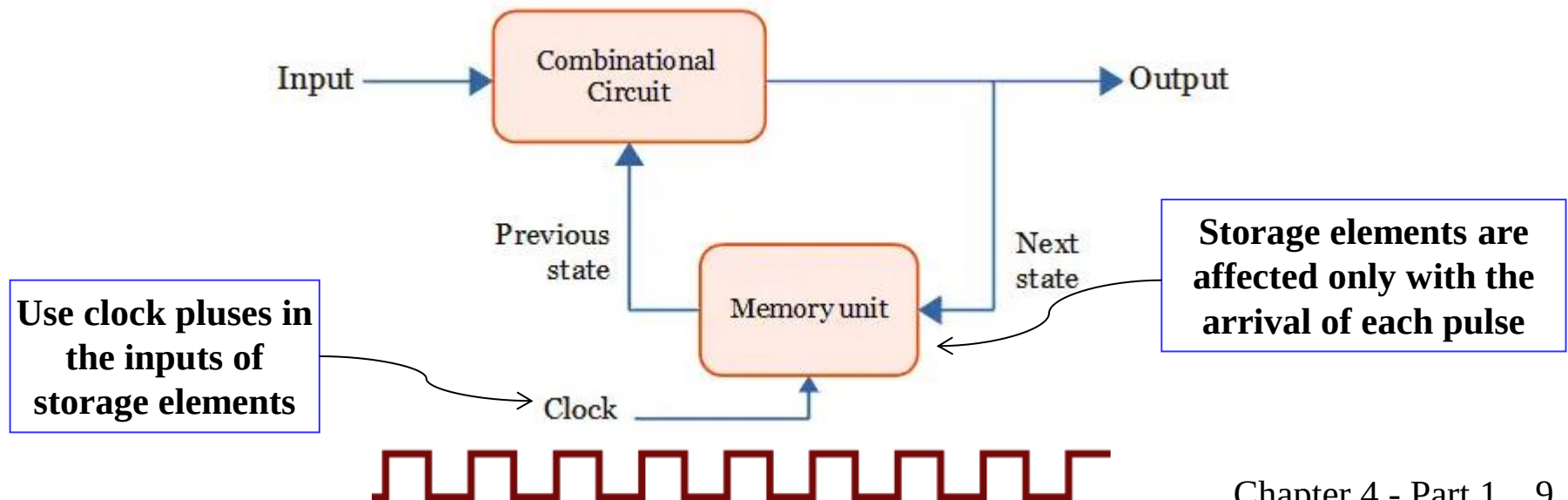
- A sequential circuit contains:

- Storage elements:
Latches or **Flip-Flops**
- Combinational Logic:
 - Inputs:
 - signals from the outside
 - signals from storage elements called **State** or **Present State**.
 - Outputs:
 - signals to the outside
 - signals to storage elements called **Next State**



Types of Sequential Circuits

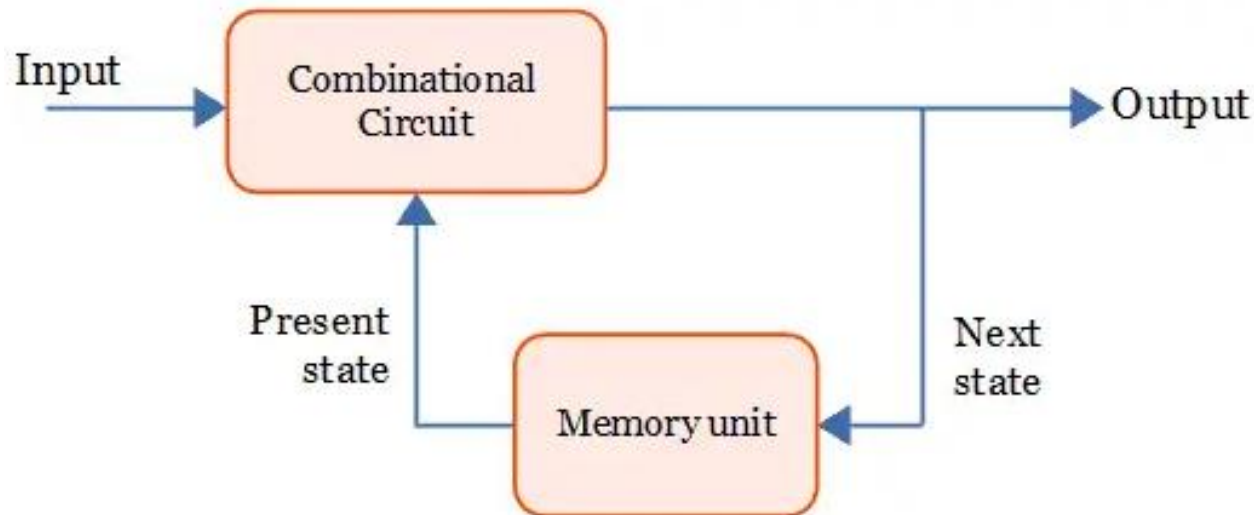
- Depends on the times at which:
 - storage elements observe their inputs, and
 - storage elements change their state
- Synchronous
 - Behavior defined from knowledge of its signals at discrete instances of time
 - Storage elements observe inputs and can **change state only in relation to a timing signal** (clock pulses from a clock)



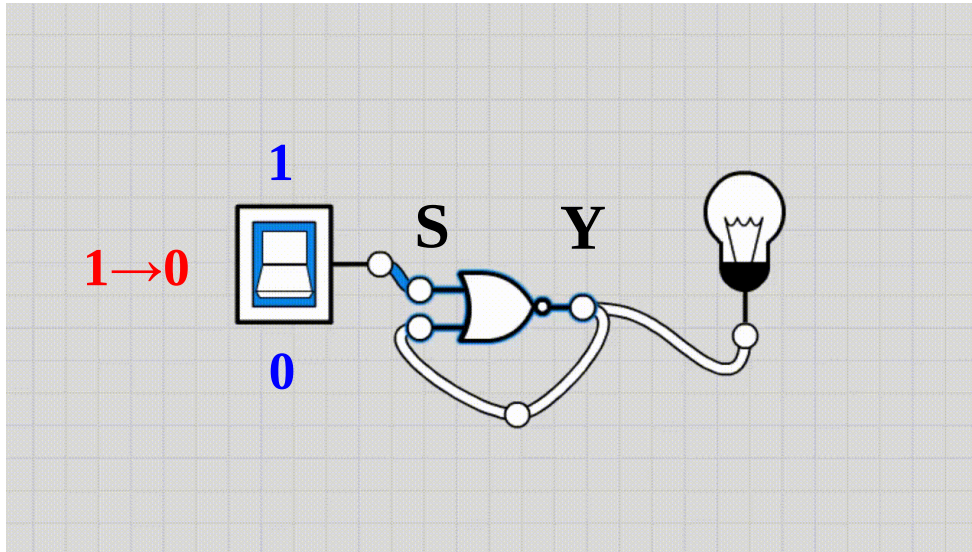
Types of Sequential Circuits (continued)

■ Asynchronous

- Behavior defined from knowledge of inputs at **any instant of time** and the order **in continuous time in which inputs change**
- If clock just regarded as another input, all circuits are asynchronous!
- Nevertheless, the synchronous abstraction makes complex designs tractable!



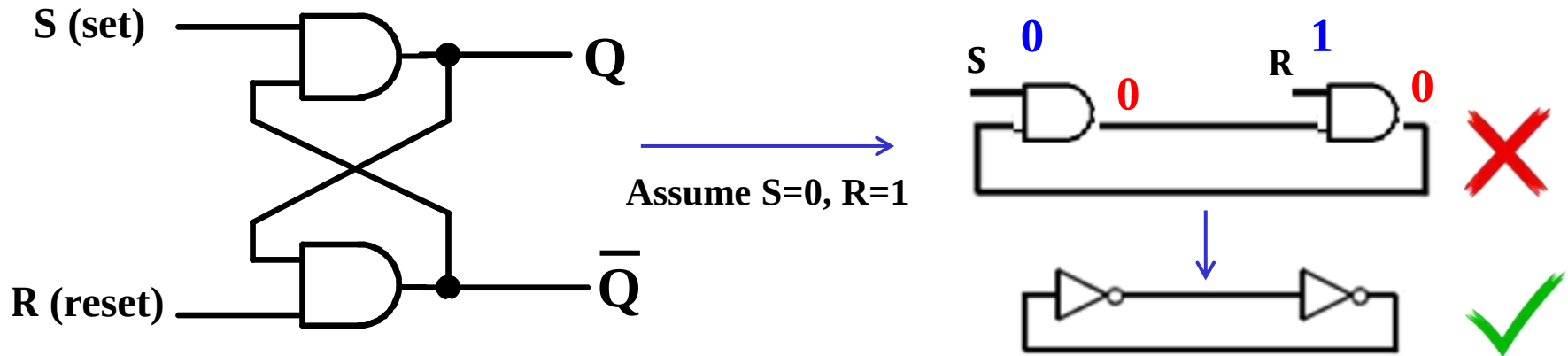
Astable Condition: Oscillation Error



$$\begin{aligned} Y_n &= \overline{S + Y_{n-1}} \\ &= \overline{S} \, \overline{Y}_{n-1} \end{aligned}$$

- **Oscillation errors** are common problems when designing digital circuits with feedback loops.
- Oscillation is essentially caused by the system being in an **astable condition** with **no stable equilibrium states**.

Monostable: Why Two AND/OR/XOR Gates Won't Make a Latch?

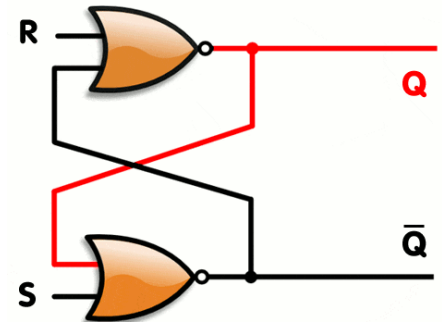


- Why don't they work (e.g., two ANDs):
 - Initial State (Assume $S=0$, $R=1$)
 - Their outputs will be 0.
 - Feedback Collapse (for all input combinations):
 - Their outputs will be stuck at state 0.

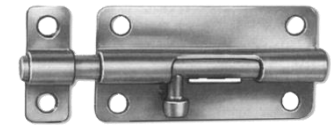
Two cross-coupled AND, OR or XOR gates lack the feedback necessary for **bistability**, resulting in **a single steady state** where both outputs remain either low or high.

Latches

- Many components to store historical state
 - Capacitors, Inductors, etc.
 - Latches, Triggers
- Meets three conditions → **latch**
 - Two stable states ("0", "1");
 - Maintains state long-term;
 - Changeable under condition (set/reset).
- The simplest latches, such as the RS latch and D latch, are implemented by **cross-coupling** two **NOR** or **NAND** gates.

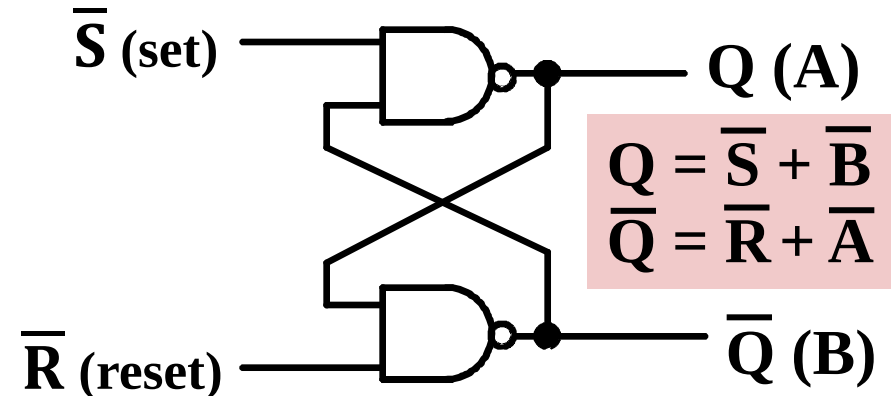
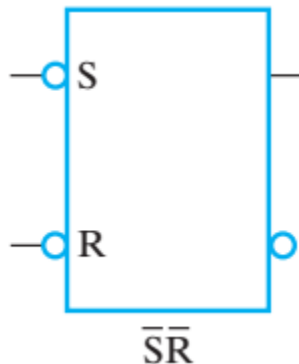


Basic (NAND) $\bar{S}$ – $\bar{R}$ Latch



- “**Cross-Coupling**”
two NAND gates gives
the $\bar{S}$ - $\bar{R}$ Latch:
- Which has the time
sequence behavior:
- $S = 0, R = 0$ is
forbidden as
input pattern

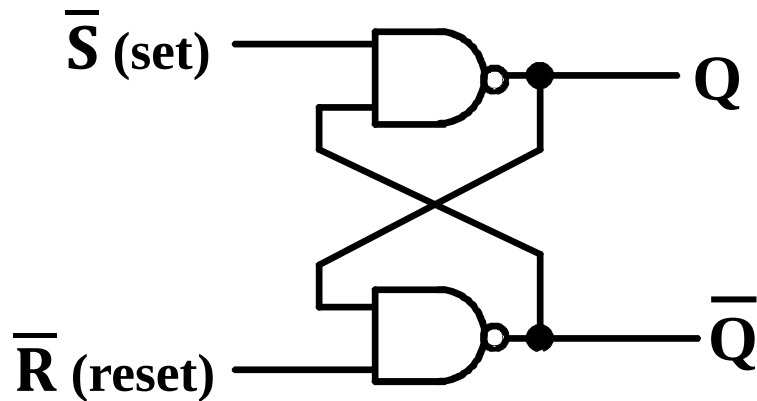
graphics
symbol for
 $\bar{S}\bar{R}$ Latch



Time

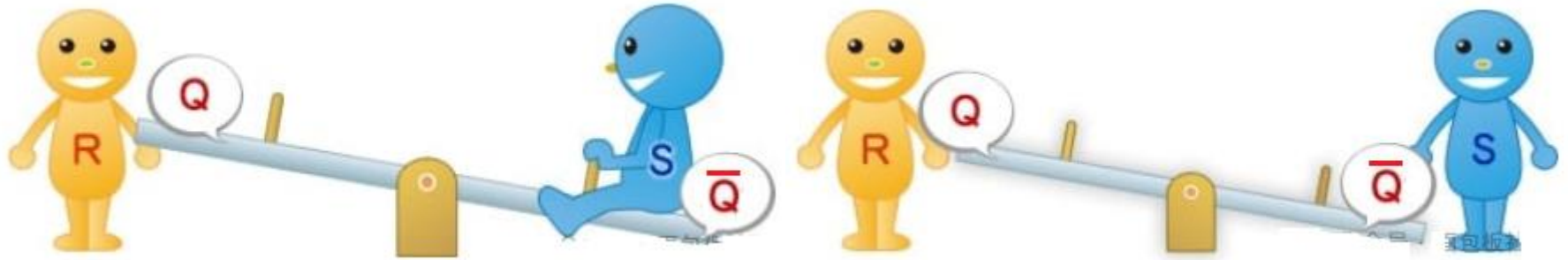
R	S	Q	$\bar{Q}$	Comment
1	1	?	?	Stored state unknown
1	0	1	0	“Set” Q to 1
1	1	1	0	Now Q “remembers” 1
0	1	0	1	“Reset” Q to 0
1	1	0	1	Now Q “remembers” 0
0	0	1	1	Both go high
1	1	?	?	Unstable!

An analogy for Latch



- The principle of a latch is quite similar to a **seesaw**:
 - The two ends of the seesaw represent the outputs Q and $\bar{Q}$.
 - The two people, Mr. R and Mr. S, represent the inputs R and S .
 - Only one person is allowed to sit at a time — they can't sit together.

An analogy for Latch (Continued)



- When Mr. S sits on the seesaw, the output Q becomes high.
- Even if Mr. S gets off the seesaw, the seesaw keeps its state.
- When Mr. R sits on the seesaw, Q becomes low. When Mr. R gets off, the seesaw still holds that state.

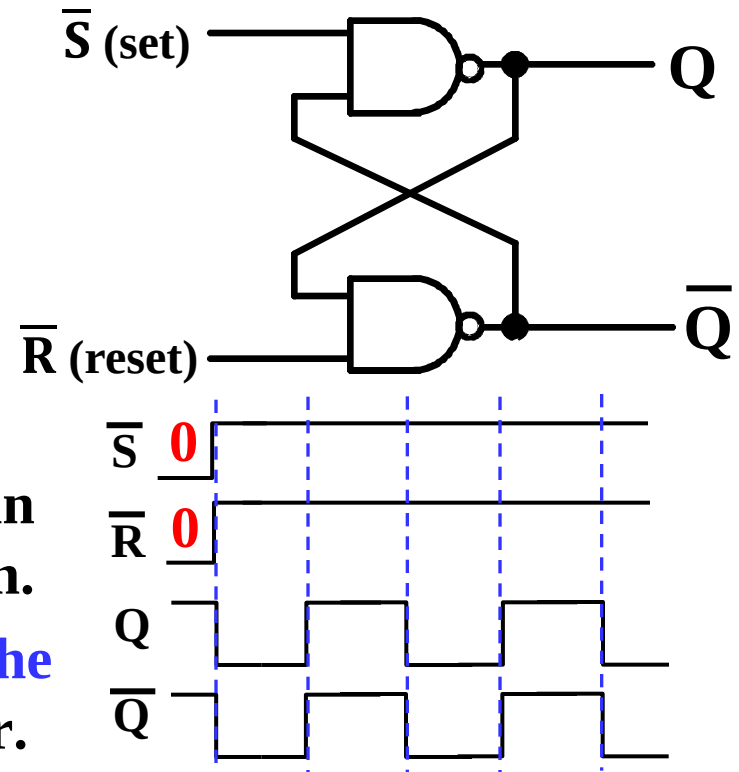
In this way, the seesaw “remembers” who sat on it before— just like a latch remembers the previous input.

Unstable Latch Behavior (Oscillation)

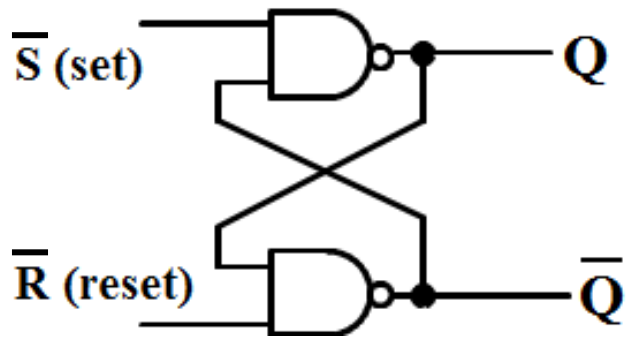
- Why both inputs of the latch to 0 are forbidden?

- If both gates have the same delay then they will both output a 0 at the same time. Feeding 0 back to the input will produce 1, again at exactly the same time, which again will produce a 0, and so on and on.
- This **oscillating behavior, called the critical race**, will continue forever.

- If the two gates do not have the same delay then the latch will go into one state or the other. However, we do not know which state the latch will go into. Thus, the **latch's next state is undefined**.



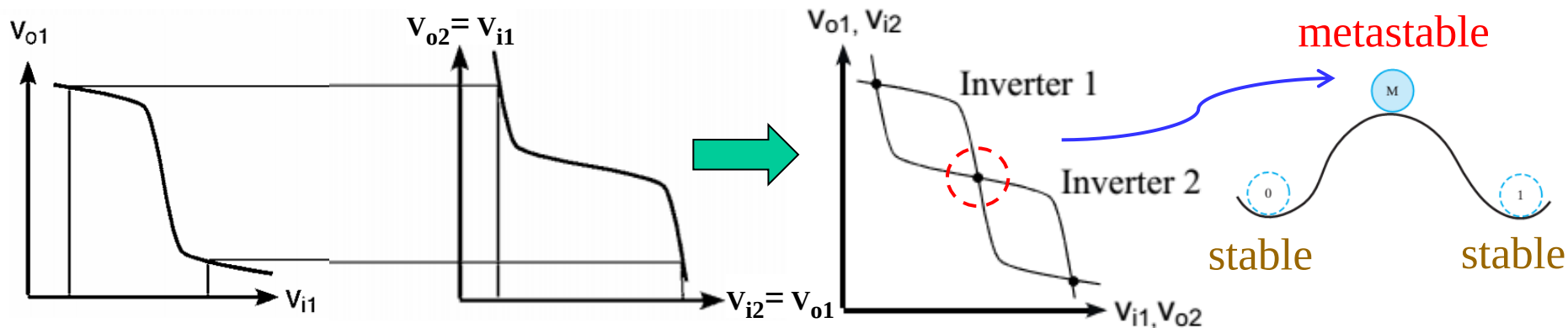
Unstable Latch Behavior (Metastable State)



- Equivalent circuit for the latch when $R = S = 1$



- Consider the transfer characteristics of two inverters

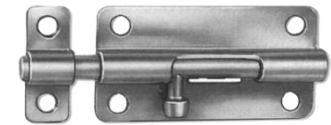


- The dot in the middle represents a **metastable state**.
- Small changes in any of the signals are amplified and the circuit leaves the metastable state.

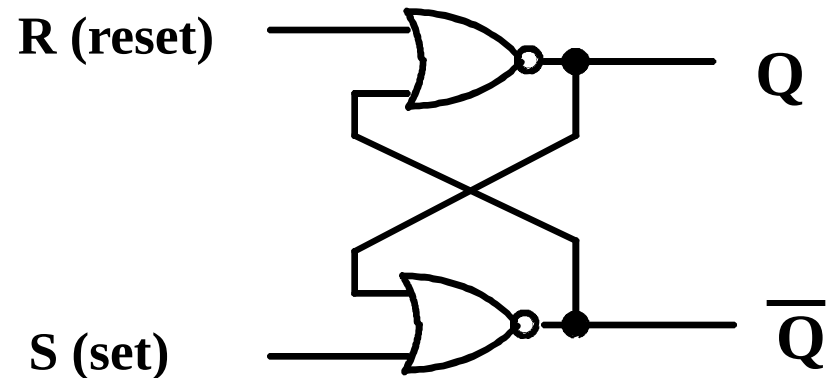
Avoiding Unstable Behavior of Latches

- Since both the **oscillation** and the **metastable state** are undesirable behaviors, we should try to avoid them.
- Do not change R and S from 0 to 1 at the same time.
 - This is necessary to avoid the oscillation behavior.
 - One way to guarantee that is to never allow them to both be 0 at the same time.
- Once you change an input, do not change it again until the circuit has had time to complete all its signal transitions and reach a stable state.
 - This is necessary to avoid the metastable behavior.

Basic (NOR) S – R Latch



- Cross-coupling two NOR gates gives the S – R Latch:
- Which has the time sequence

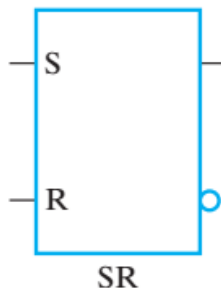


behavior: Time

- $S = 1, R = 1$ is **forbidden** as input pattern

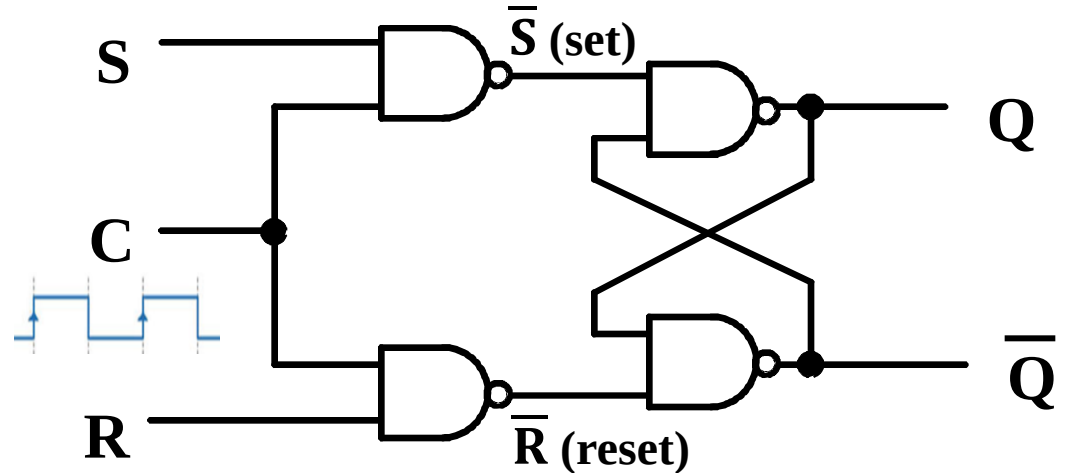
R	S	Q	$\bar{Q}$	Comment
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1	0	0	1	“Reset” Q to 0
0	0	0	1	Now Q “remembers” 0
1	1	0	0	Both go low
0	0	?	?	Unstable!

graphics
symbol for
SR Latch

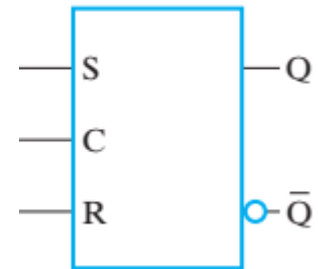


Clocked S – R Latch: **Synchronous** Circuit

- Adding two NAND gates to the basic $\bar{S}$ - $\bar{R}$ NAND latch gives the **clocked S – R latch**:



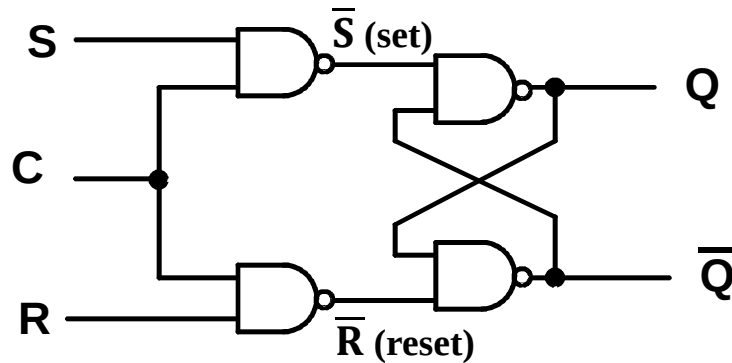
- Has a time sequence behavior similar to the basic S-R latch except that the S and R inputs are only observed **when the line C is high**.
- C means “control” or “clock”.
- From asynchronous to synchronous
 - **Asynchronous Sequential Circuit**: Basic $\bar{S}$ – $\bar{R}$ Latch
 - **Synchronous Sequential Circuit**: Clocked S - R Latch



SR Latch with
Control Input

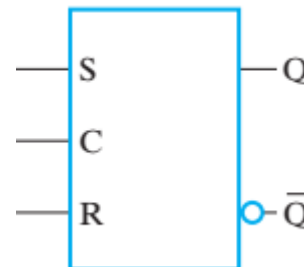
Clocked S - R Latch (continued)

- The Clocked S-R Latch can be described by a table:



C	S	R	Q(t + 1)
0	X	X	No change
1	0	0	No change
1	0	1	0: Clear Q
1	1	0	1: Set Q
1	1	1	Indeterminate

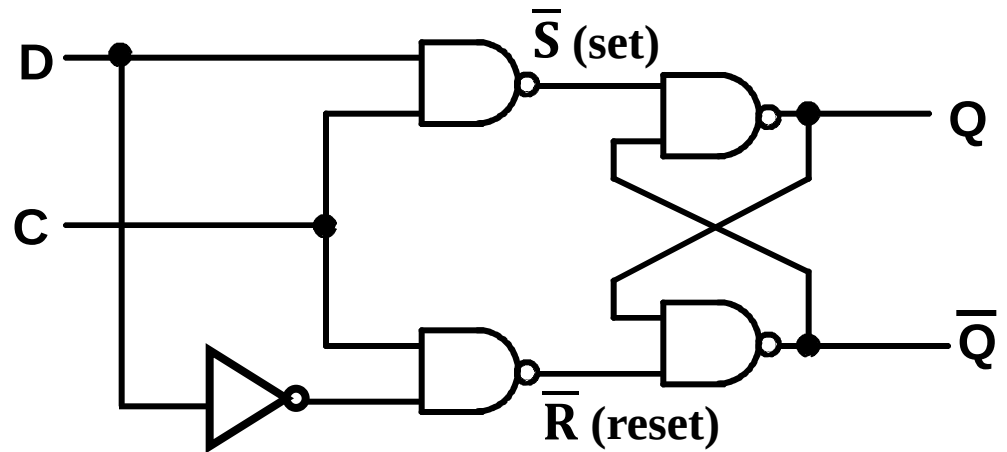
- The table describes what happens after the clock [at time (t+1)] based on:
 - current inputs (S,R,C) and
 - current state Q(t).



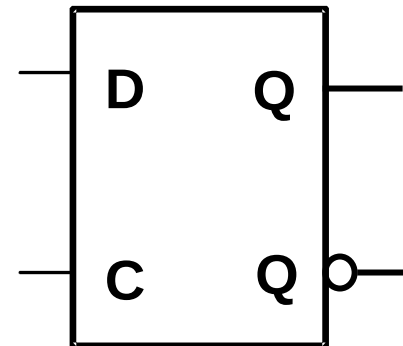
SR Latch with
Control Input

D Latch

- Adding an **inverter** to the S-R Latch, gives the D Latch:
- Note that there are **no “indeterminate” states!**



The graphic symbol for a D Latch is:



C	D	Q(t + 1)
0	X	No change
1	0	0: Clear Q
1	1	1: Set Q

Latch and Transparent Latch

- A clocked latch is also known as a **transparent latch**.

	clock dependency	output behavior
Latch	clock-independent (Asynchronous)	The output always follows the input — — transparent
Transparent Latch	clock-dependent (Synchronous)	• Enabled = 1: The output will follow the input — transparent • Enabled = 0: Data are latched or held. The output is opaque to the input — opaque

Flip-Flops

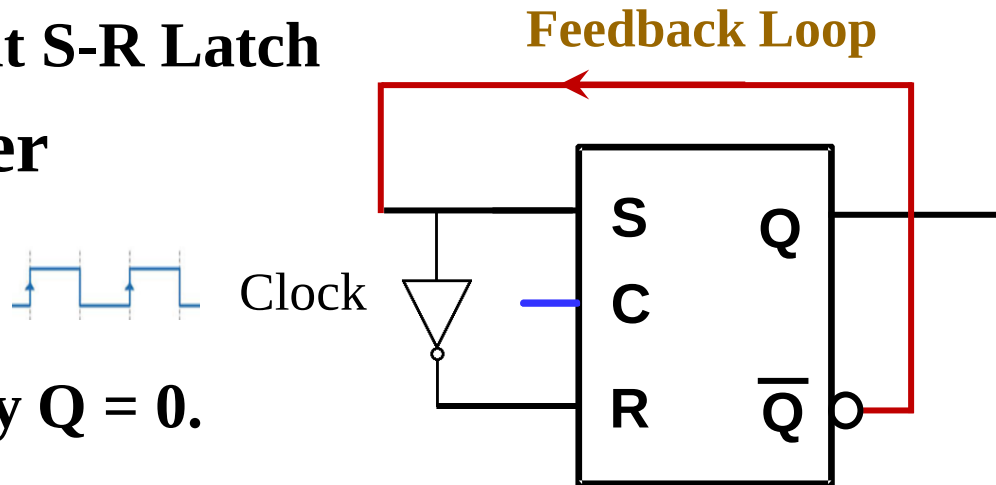
- **The latch timing problem**
- **Master-slave flip-flop**
- **Edge-triggered flip-flop**
- **Standard symbols for storage elements**
- **Direct inputs to flip-flops**

The Latch Timing Problem

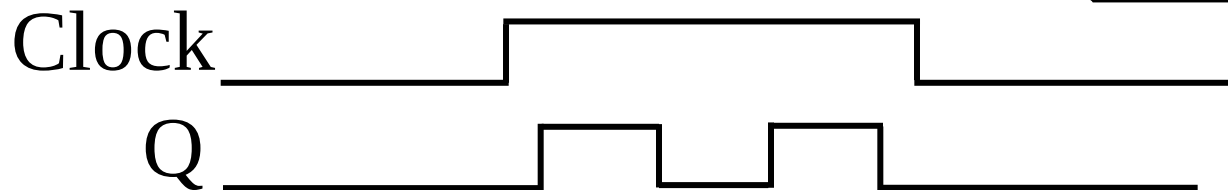
- In a latch circuit, paths may exist through combinational logic:
 - From one storage element to another storage element
 - From a storage element back to the same storage element
- The combinational logic between a latch output and a latch input may be as simple as an interconnect.
- For a clocked D-latch, the output Q depends on the input D whenever the clock input has value 1

The Latch Timing Problem (continued)

- Consider the LSB-bit S-R Latch in a binary counter



- Suppose that initially $Q = 0$.



$$\begin{aligned} S &= \bar{Q} \\ R &= Q \end{aligned}$$

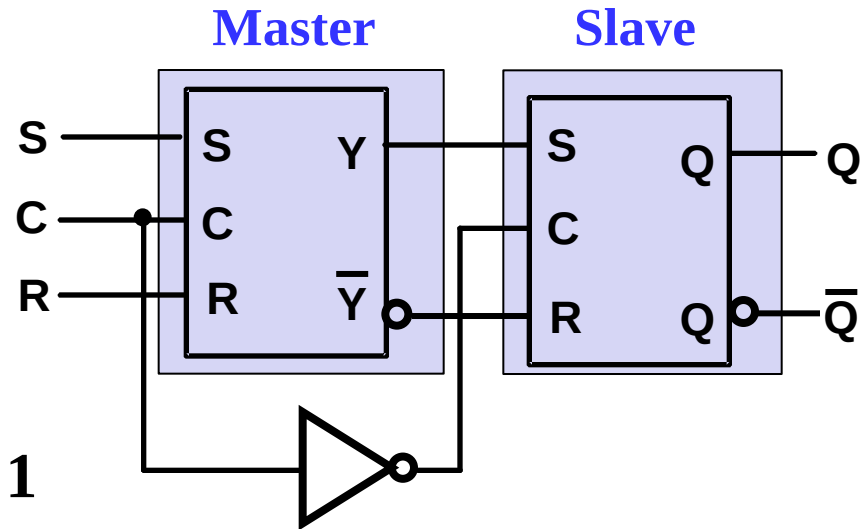
- As long as $C = 1$, the value of Q continues to change!
- The changes are based on the delay present on the loop through the connection from Q back to Q .
- Desired behavior: Q changes only once per clock pulse**
- This behavior is clearly unacceptable!**

The Latch Timing Problem (continued)

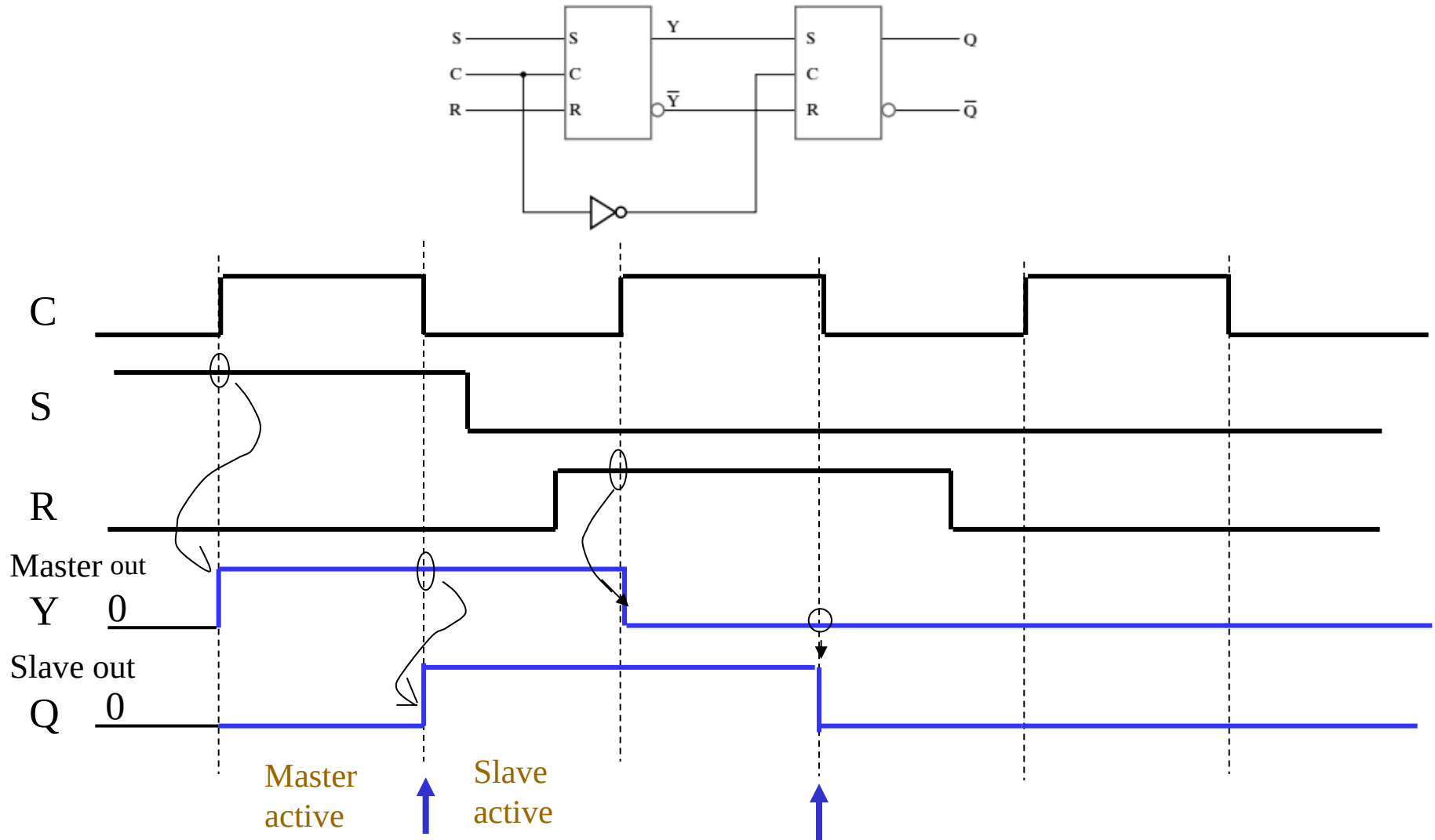
- A solution to the latch timing problem is to **break the closed path** from Q to Q within the storage element
- The commonly-used, path-breaking solutions replace the S-R latch with:
 - **Level-triggered flip-flops** (Master-slave FFs)
 - **Edge-triggered flip-flops**
- A change in value on the control input allows the state of a latch in a flip-flop to switch. This change is called a **trigger**.

S-R Master-Slave Flip-Flop

- Consists of two clocked S-R latches in series with the clock on the second latch inverted
- The input is observed by the first latch with $C = 1$
- The output is changed by the second latch with $C = 0$
 - **Master**: read input at first half of clock cycle
 - **Slave**: change the output at second half of clock cycle
- The path from input to output is broken by the difference in clocking values (**alternating clocks**).

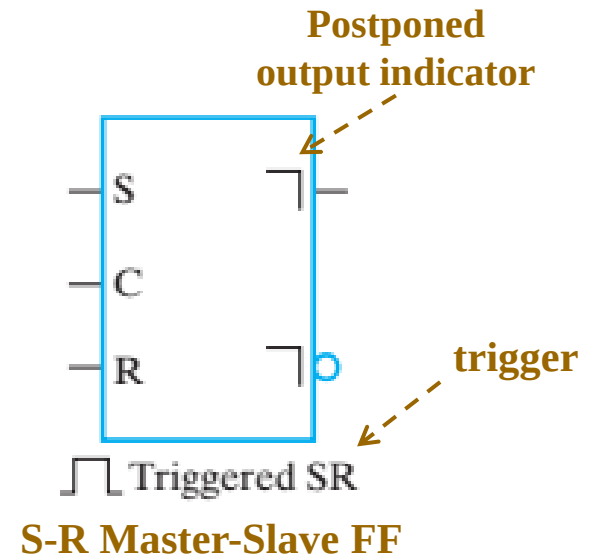
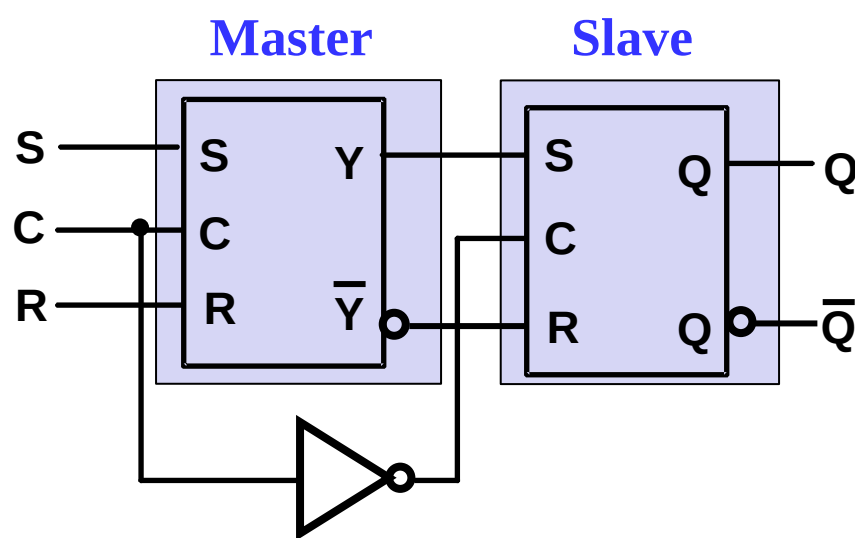


Timing diagram of S-R Master-Slave Flip-Flop



Output changes at negative clock edge

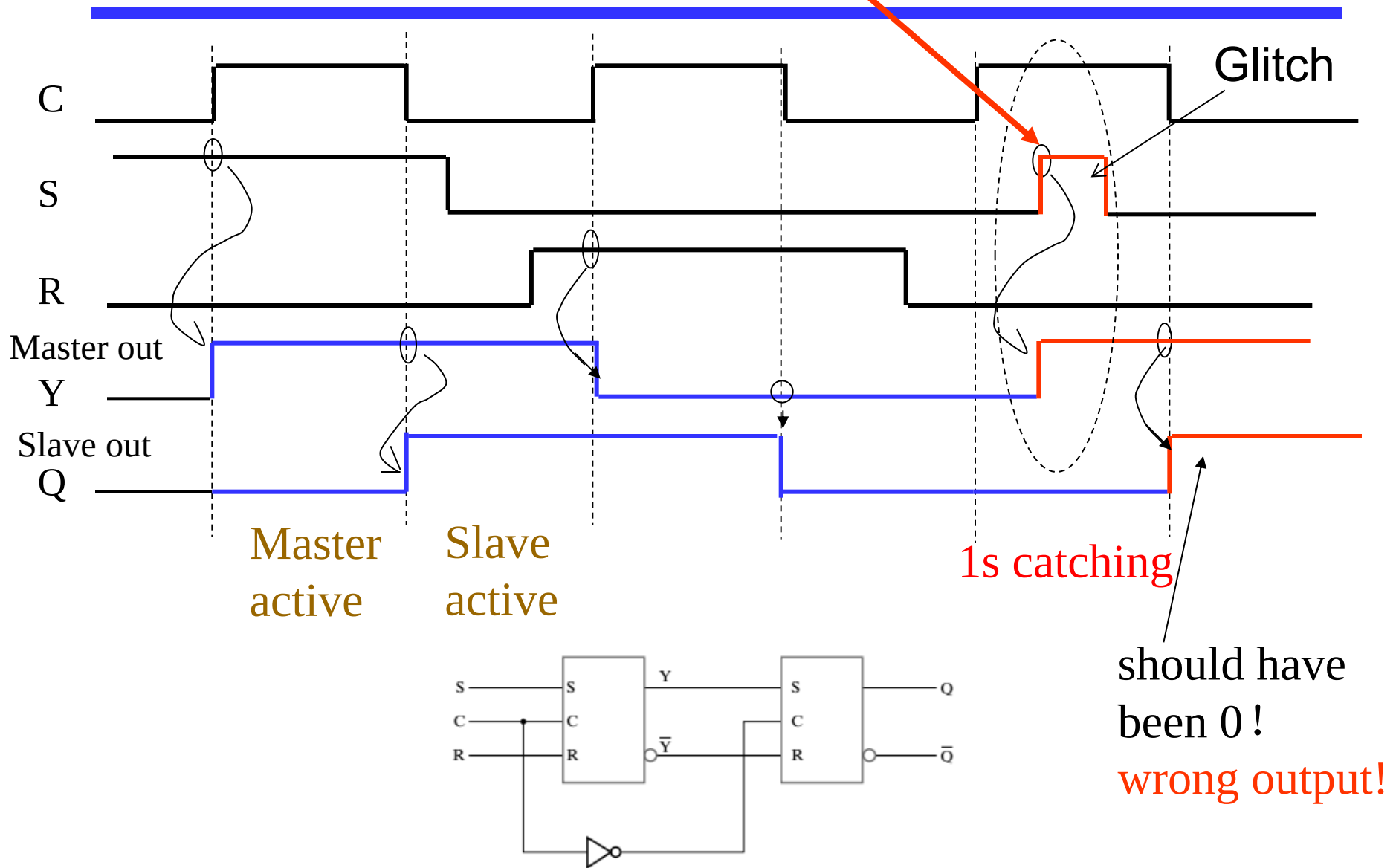
S-R Master-Slave Flip-Flop (continued)



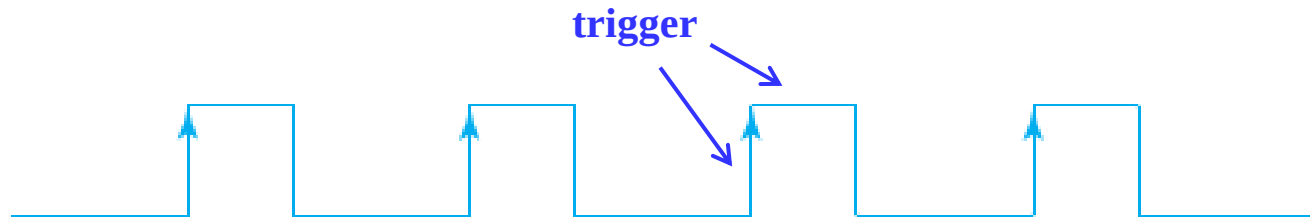
- In S-R master-slave flip-flop, the path from input to output is broken by the **difference in clocking values (alternating clocks)**.
- Such a circuit is called a **pulse-triggered** or **level-triggered** flip-flop.

S-R Master-Slave Flip-Flop

Problem: **1s catching**



Solutions for Avoiding 1s catching

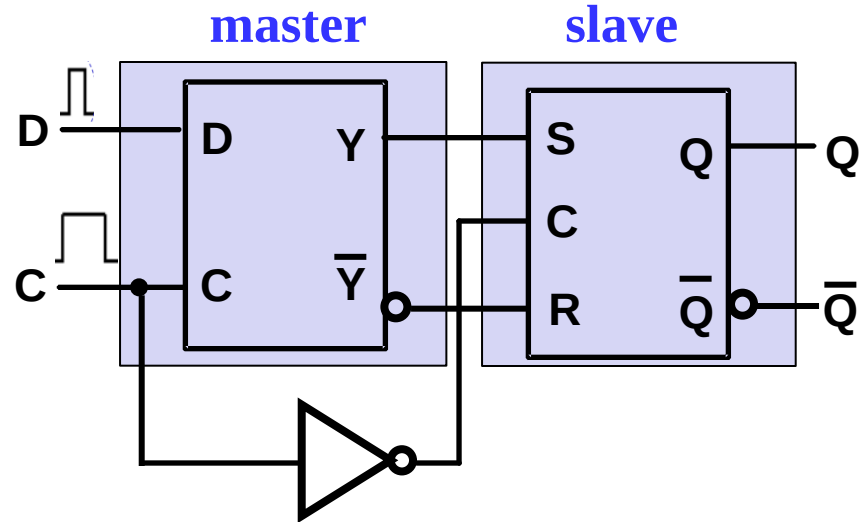


(b) Positive-edge response

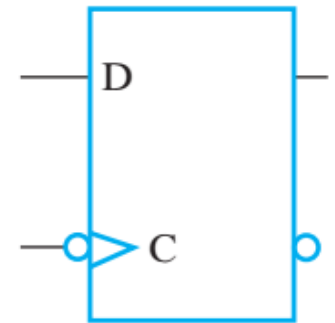
- Solutions for avoiding 1s catching:
 - reducing inputs
 - reducing sampling window
- Unlike a level-triggered flip-flop, an *edge-triggered* flip-flop triggers only on clock **transitions** and ignores the clock when it stays at a constant level.
- Edge-triggered flip-flops can be built directly at the electronic circuit level.

Negative-Edge-Triggered D Flip-Flop

- A D master-slave flip-flop is triggered by the rising or the falling edge of a clock.

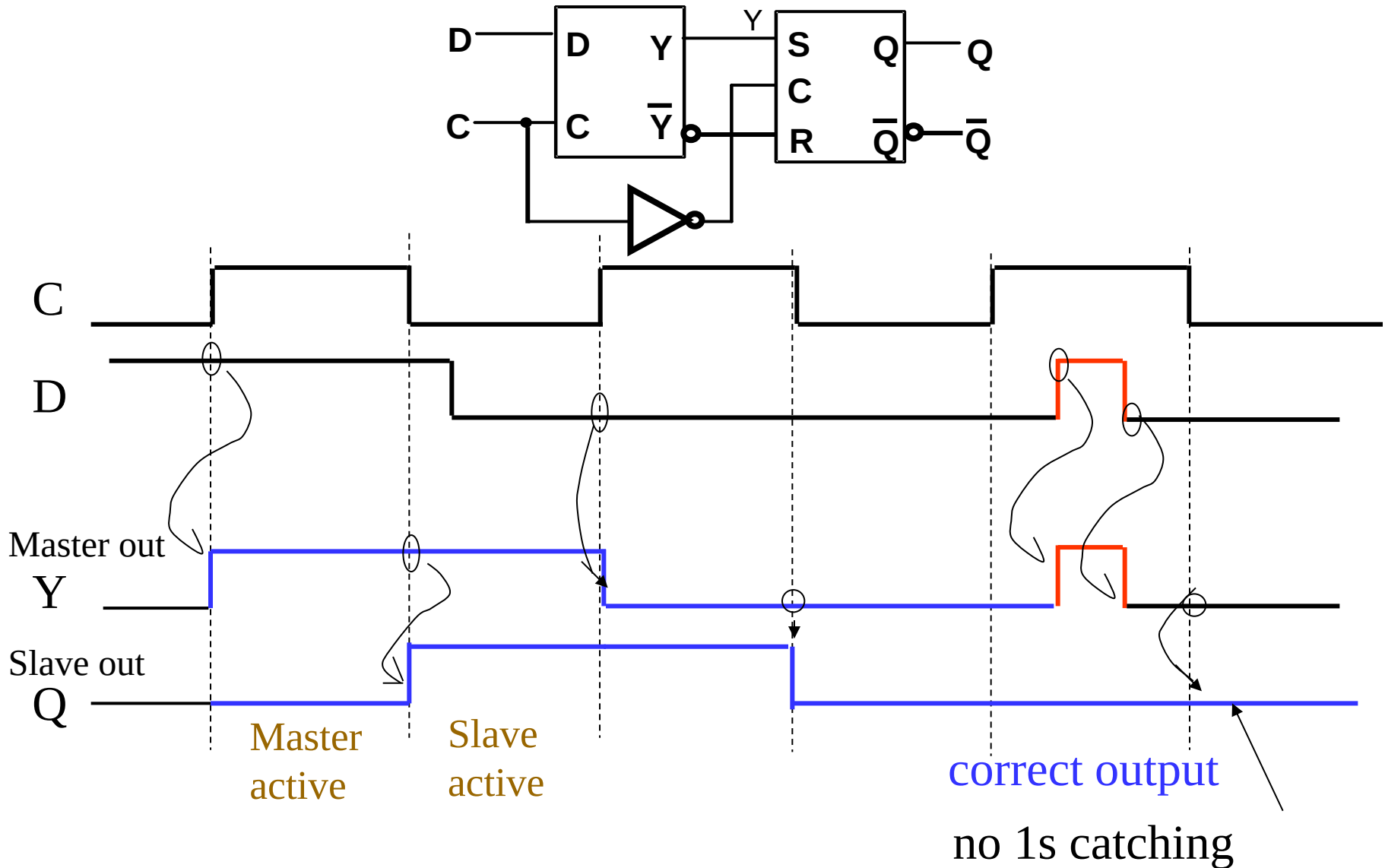


- It can be formed by:
 - Replacing the first S-R latch with a clocked D latch
- The 1s-catching behavior presented in the S-R master-slave flip-flop can be avoided with D replacing S and R inputs.
- The change of the D flip-flop output is associated with the negative edge at the end of the pulse.
- It is called a *negative-edge triggered flip-flop*.



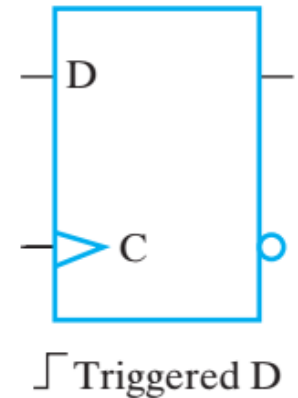
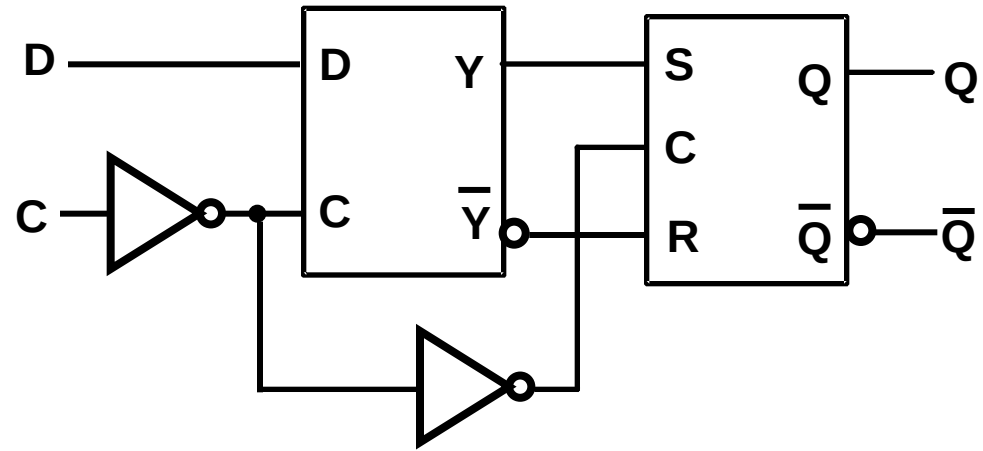
negative-edge
triggered FF

Edge-Triggered D Flip-Flop: No 1s catching



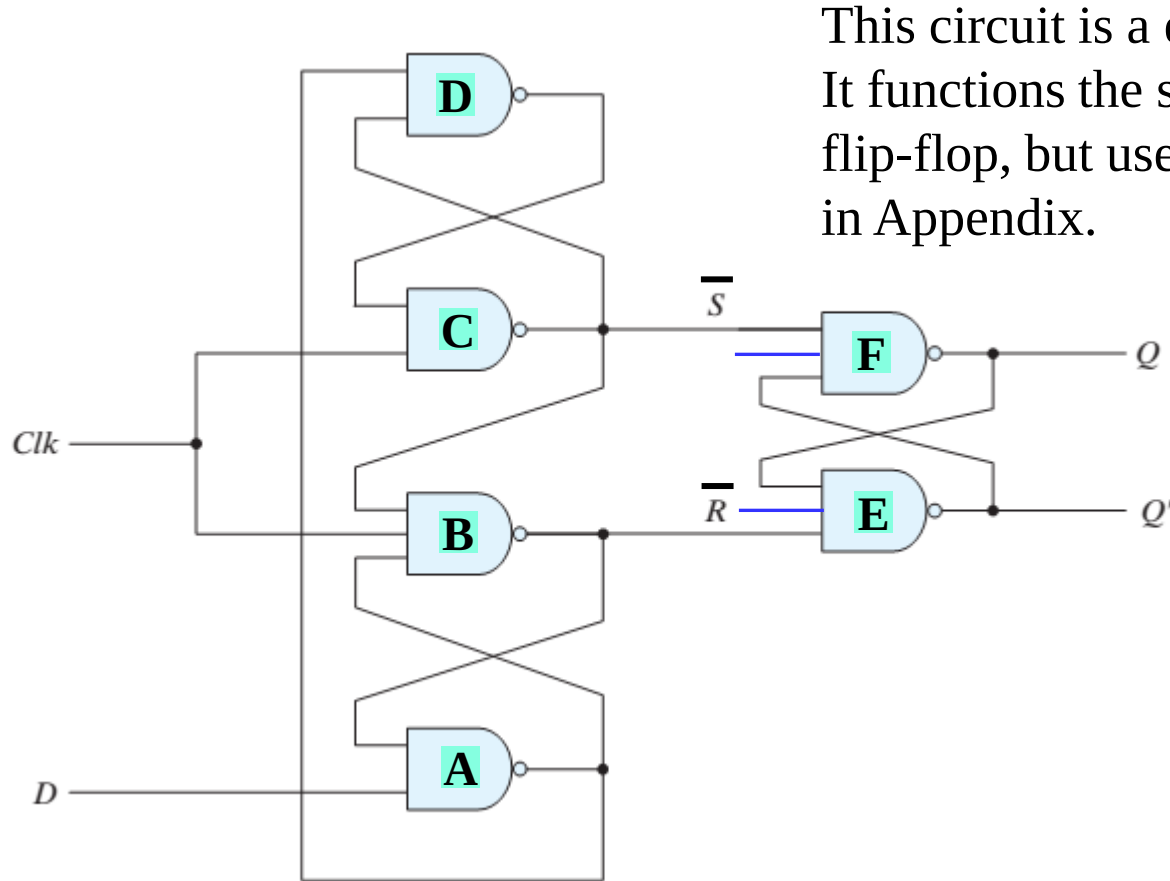
Positive-Edge-Triggered D Flip-Flop

- Formed by adding inverter to clock input
- Q changes to the value on D applied at the positive clock edge within timing constraints to be specified
- Our choice as the standard flip-flop for most sequential circuits



positive-edge
triggered FF

Simpler Implementation of Edge-Triggered D Flip-Flop



This circuit is a edge-triggered D flip-flop. It functions the same as a D master-slave flip-flop, but uses fewer gates. See details in Appendix.

Positive-Edge Triggered D Flip-Flop

Big Picture of Latch and Flip-Flop

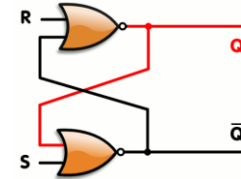
Traditional
logic design



**Combinational
Circuit**

**Problem: can't
retain past inputs**

Solution
→
**cross-coupled
feedback connection**



**Latch or
Clocked Latch**

**oscillation
metastable**

**Problem:
transparent path**

Solution
↓
**alternating
clocks/trigger**

**D Master-Slave
Flip-Flop**

**Edge-Triggered
Flip-Flops**

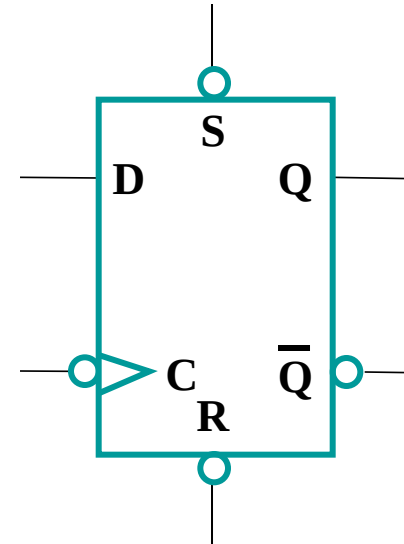
Solution
←
**reducing inputs /
sampling window**

**S-R Master-
Slave Flip-Flop**

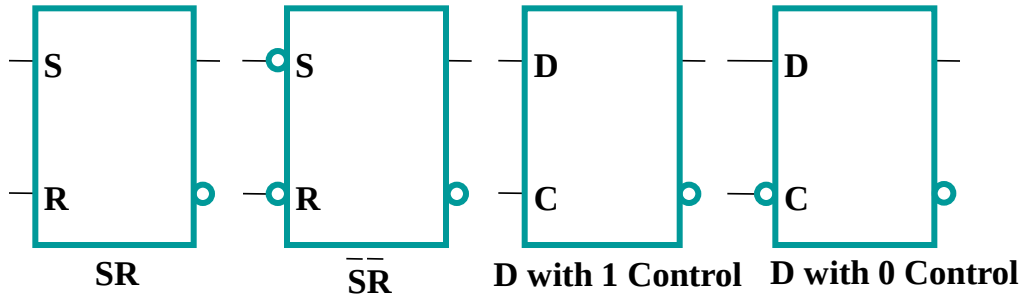
**Problem: catching
glitches (0s or 1s)**

Direct Inputs

- At power up or at reset, all or part of a sequential circuit usually is **initialized to a known state** before it begins operation
- This initialization is often done outside of the clocked behavior of the circuit, i.e., asynchronously.
- Direct R and/or S inputs that control the state of the latches within the flip-flops are used for this initialization.
- For the example flip-flop shown
 - When R is 0, resets the flip-flop to the 0 state
 - When S is 0, sets the flip-flop to the 1 state
 - When R and S are both 1, flip-flop works normally
 - State undefined when R and S are both set to 0



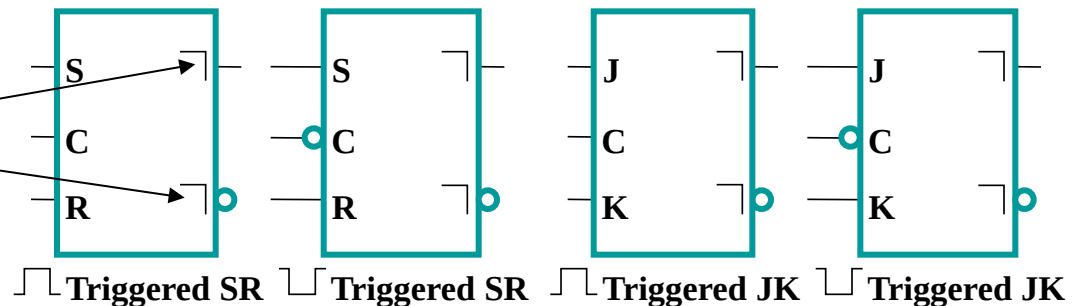
Standard Symbols for Storage Elements



(a) Latches

- **Master-Slave:**

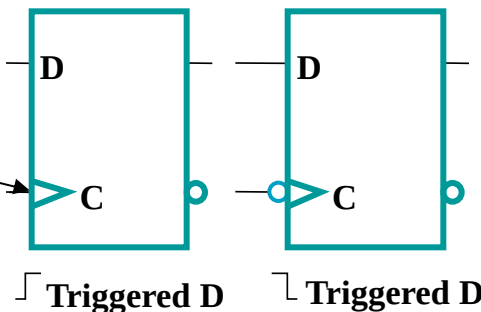
Postponed output indicators



(b) Master-Slave Flip-Flops

- **Edge-Triggered:**

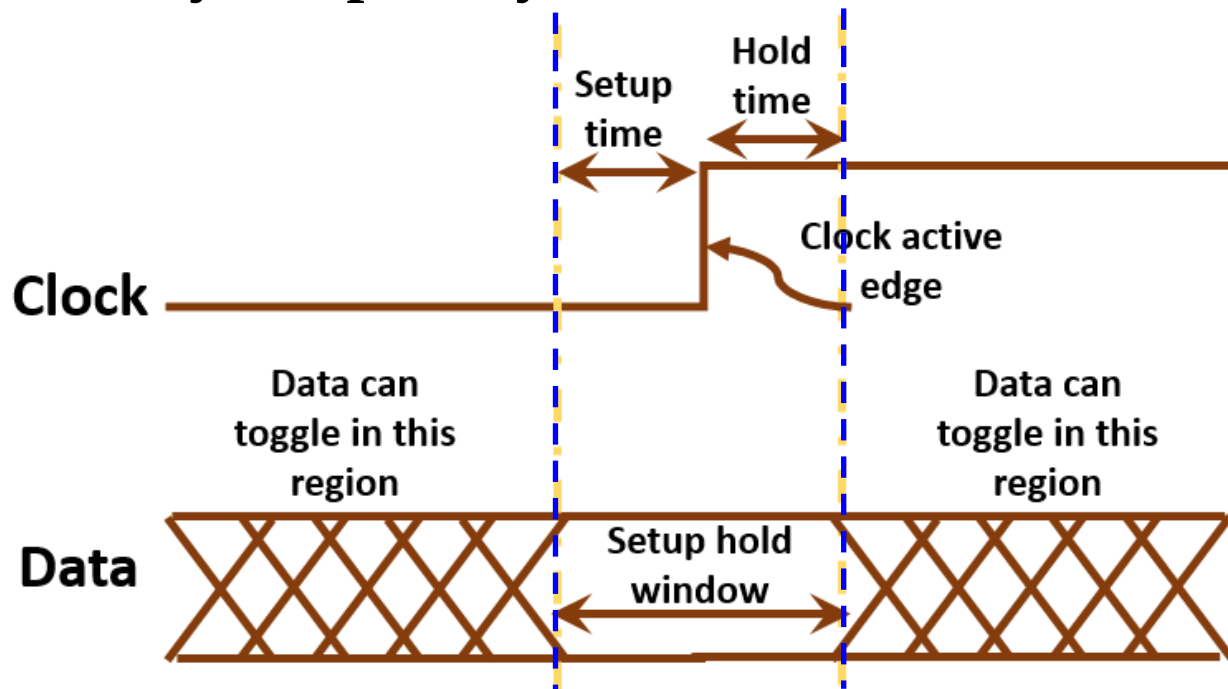
Dynamic indicator



(c) Edge-Triggered Flip-Flops

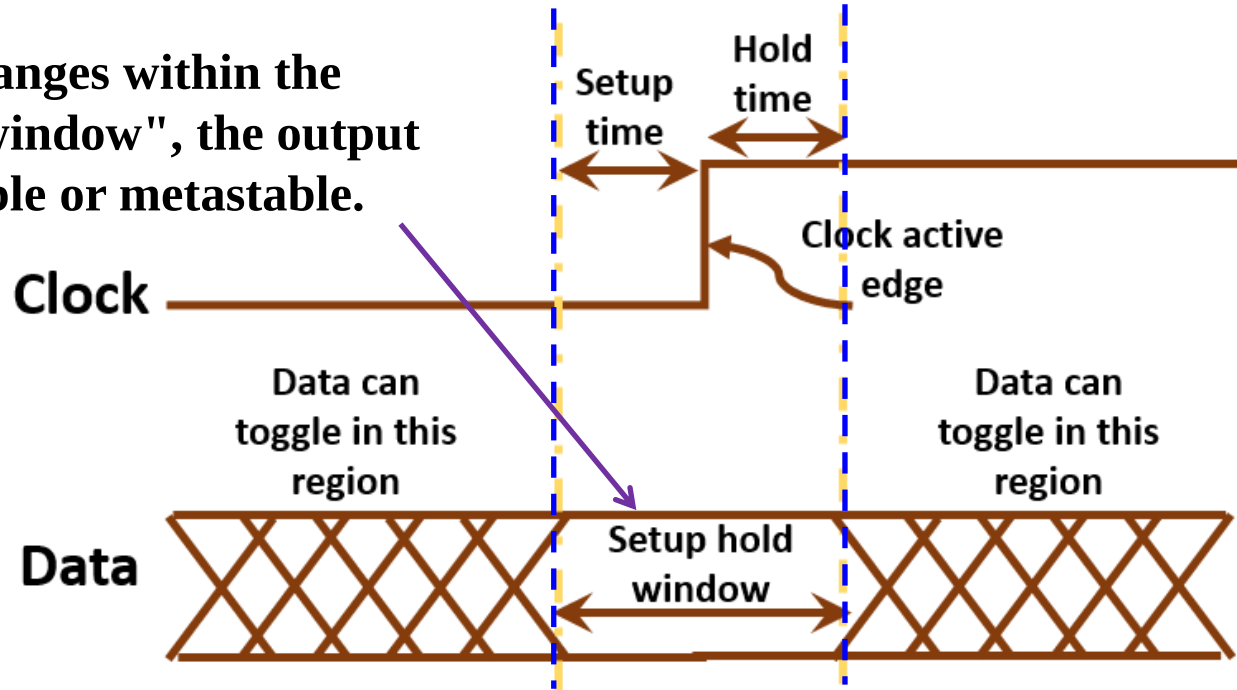
Flip-Flop Timing Parameters

- **Setup time:** The minimum amount of time data input should be held steady before the clock event. This is so that the data can be stored successfully in the flip-flop.
- **Hold time:** The minimum amount of time data input should be held steady after the clock event so that data is reliably sampled by the clock.



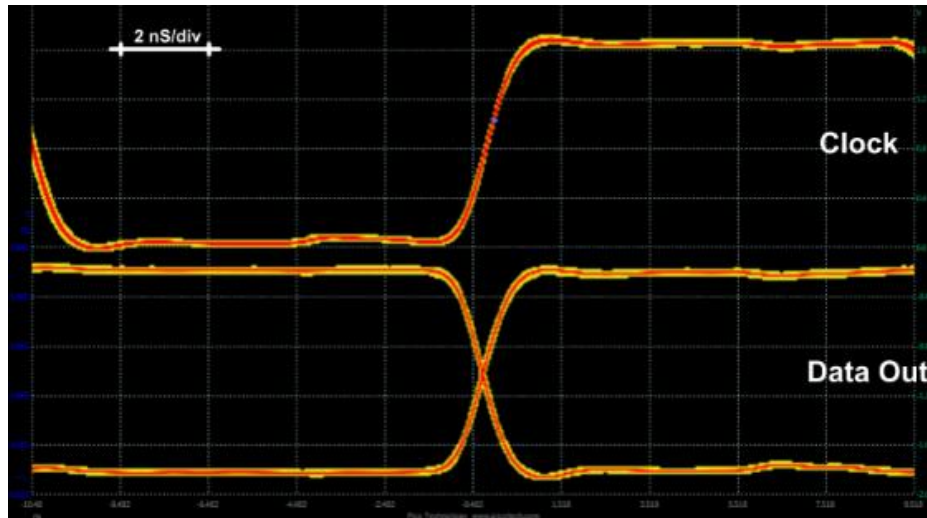
Flip-Flop Timing Parameters (continued)

If the data changes within the "setup-hold-window", the output is unpredictable or metastable.

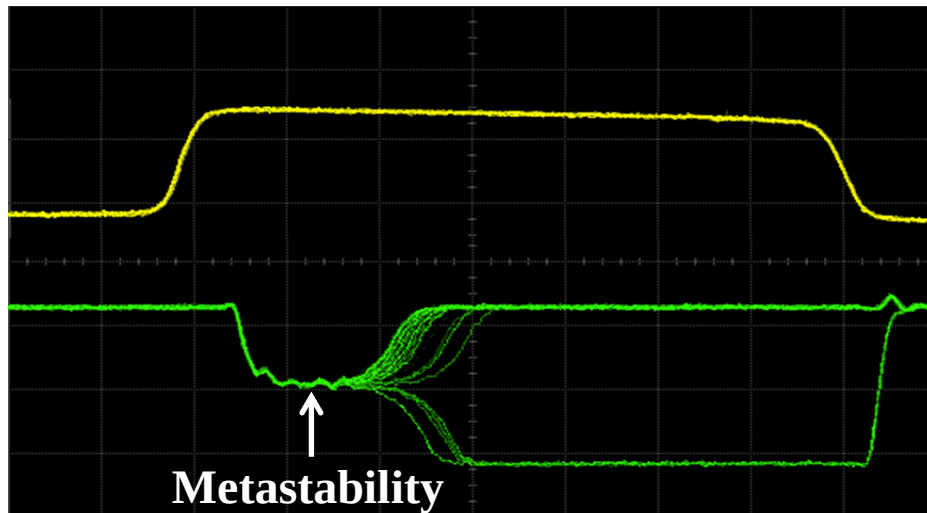


- E.g., if the setup time is 20 ns, it means that data has to be stable at least 20ns before the capturing clock-edge.
- Setup time and hold time together define a "**setup-hold-window**", in which data has to remain stable.

Flip-Flop Timing Parameters (continued)



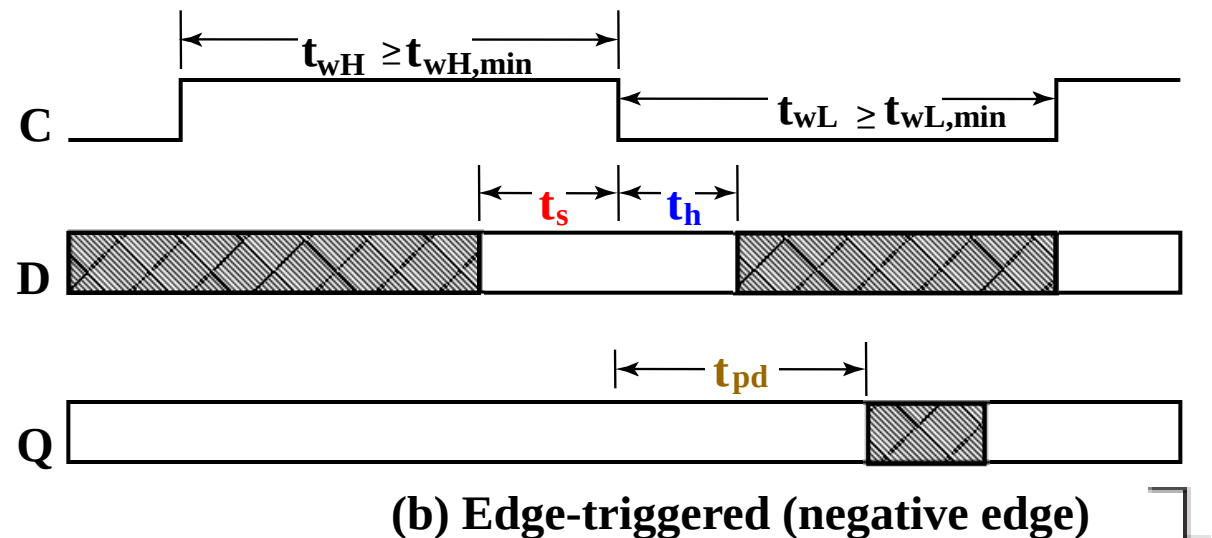
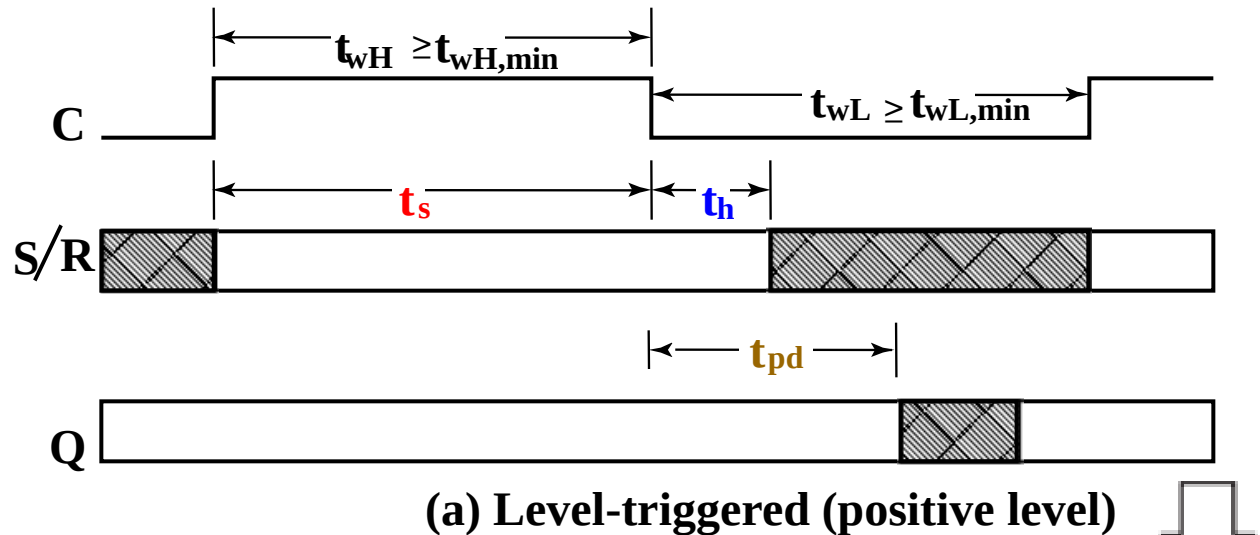
- **No setup time violation**
 - Input data arrives earlier than setup time before the rising edge of Clock.
 - Data out changes cleanly to either 0 or 1.



- **Setup time violation**
 - Input data arrives within the setup time window.
 - Data out becomes undefined (0 or 1 or somewhere in between) for a random period time before settling down to either 0 or 1.

Flip-Flop Timing Parameters (continued)

- t_w - clock pulse width
- t_s - setup time
- t_h - hold time
- t_{px} - propagation delay
 - t_{PHL} - High-to-Low
 - t_{PLH} - Low-to-High
 - $t_{pd} = \max(t_{PHL}, t_{PLH})$



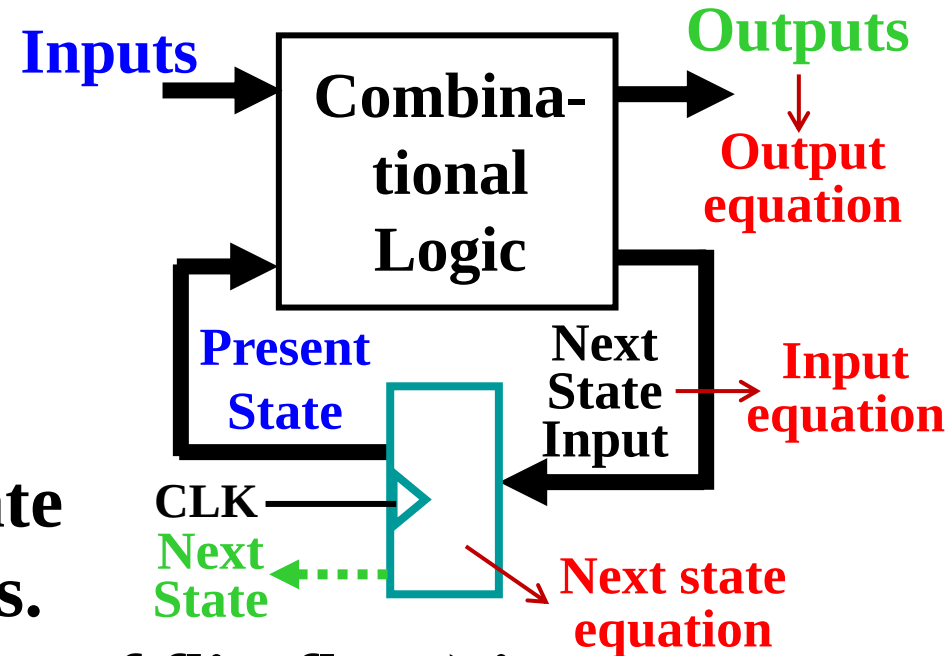
Flip-Flop Timing Parameters (continued)

- **t_s - setup time**
 - Master-slave - Equal to the width of the triggering pulse
 - Edge-triggered - Equal to a time interval that is generally much less than the width of the the triggering pulse
- **t_h - hold time** - Often equal to zero
- **t_{px} - propagation delay**
 - Same parameters as for gates except
 - Measured from clock edge that triggers the output change to the output change

Sequential Circuit Analysis

■ General Model

- **Present State** is stored in the flip-flops.
- **Outputs** are a Boolean function of Present State and (sometimes) Inputs.
- **Next State Input** (Inputs of flip-flops) is a Boolean function of Present State and (sometimes) Inputs.
- **Next State** (Outputs of flip-flops) is a Boolean function of Next State Inputs and the characteristics of the flip-flops.



Sequential Circuit Analysis (continued)

- Analysis of sequential circuits including:
 - **Generating the functionality** of the sequential circuit using state table, state diagram, and input/output Boolean equations.
 - **Determining the timing constraints** that a sequential circuit must be satisfied in order to prevent metastability, which allows the circuit to be used without error.

Sequential Circuit Analysis (continued)

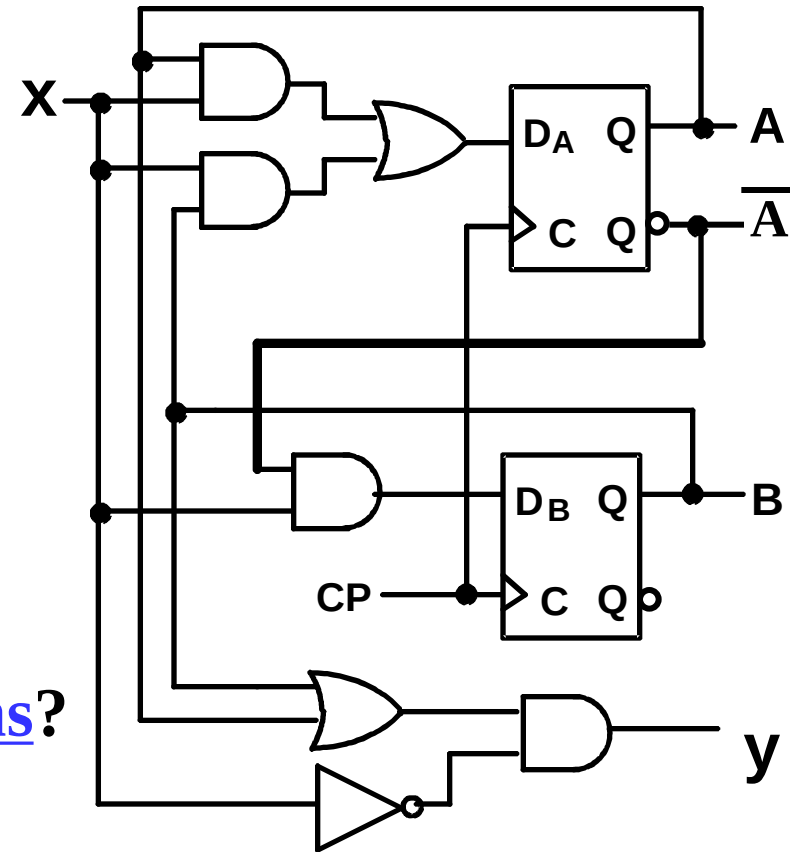
- Sequential Circuit Analysis is a procedure of specifying the logic diagram of a given sequential circuit.
- A **state table** and **state diagram** are presented to describe the behavior of the circuit, demonstrating the time sequence of inputs, outputs and states, and illustrating the functionality of the given circuits.

Sequential Circuit Analysis Procedure

1. **Identify** the inputs, outputs, and internal states
2. **Determine** the **output equations**, inputs and outputs of flip-flops (i.e., **input equations** and **next state equations**)
3. **Derive** the **state table** (truth table with state):
 - Inputs: inputs of circuit, present state of the circuit
 - Outputs: outputs of circuit, next state of all flip-flops
4. **List** the next state of the sequential circuit
5. **Obtain** a **state diagram**
6. **Analyze** the **performance** of the circuit
7. **Verify** the correctness of the circuit, check the **self-recovery capability** and draw the timing parameters

Example 1 (from Fig. 4-13)

- Input: $x(t)$
 - Output: $y(t)$
 - State: $(A(t), B(t))$
- x
- What is the Output Equation?
 - $y =$
 - What is the Input Equations?
 - $D_A =$
 - $D_B =$
 - What is the Next State Equations?
 - $A(t+1) =$
 - $B(t+1) =$



Example 1 (from Fig. 4-13) (continued)

- **Output equation:**

$$y(t) = \bar{x}(t)(A(t) + B(t))$$

- **Input equations:**

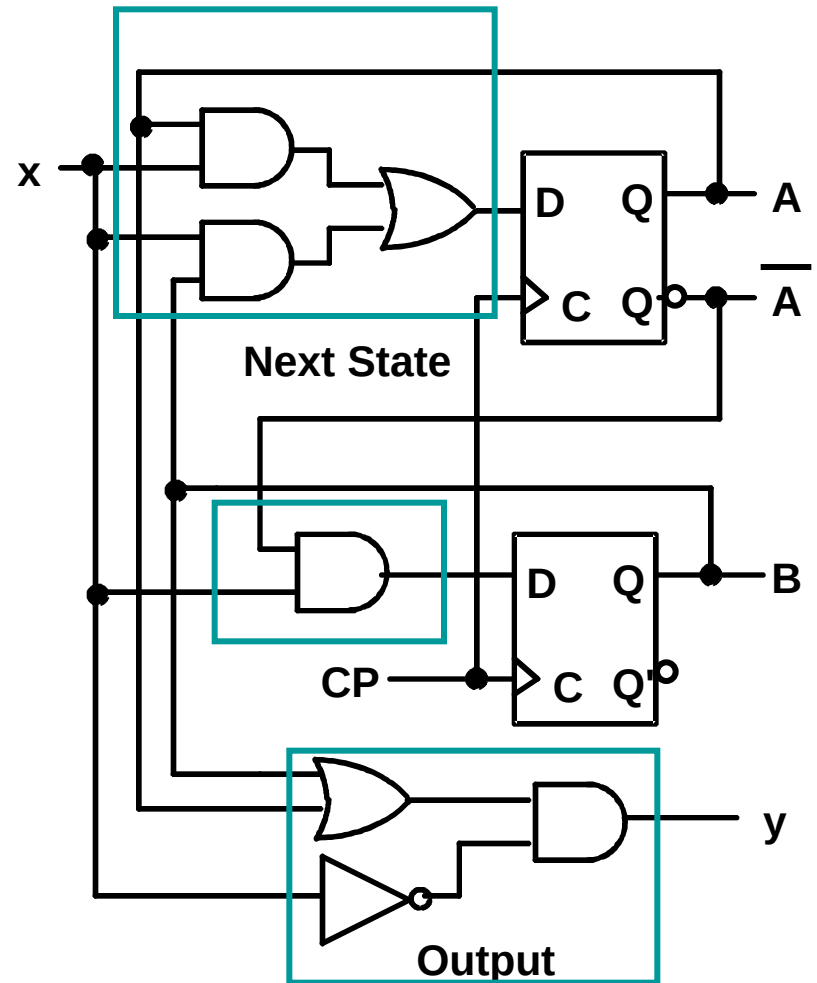
$$D_A = A(t)x(t) + B(t)x(t)$$

$$D_B = \bar{A}(t)x(t)$$

- **Next State equations:**

$$A(t+1) = D_A$$

$$B(t+1) = D_B$$

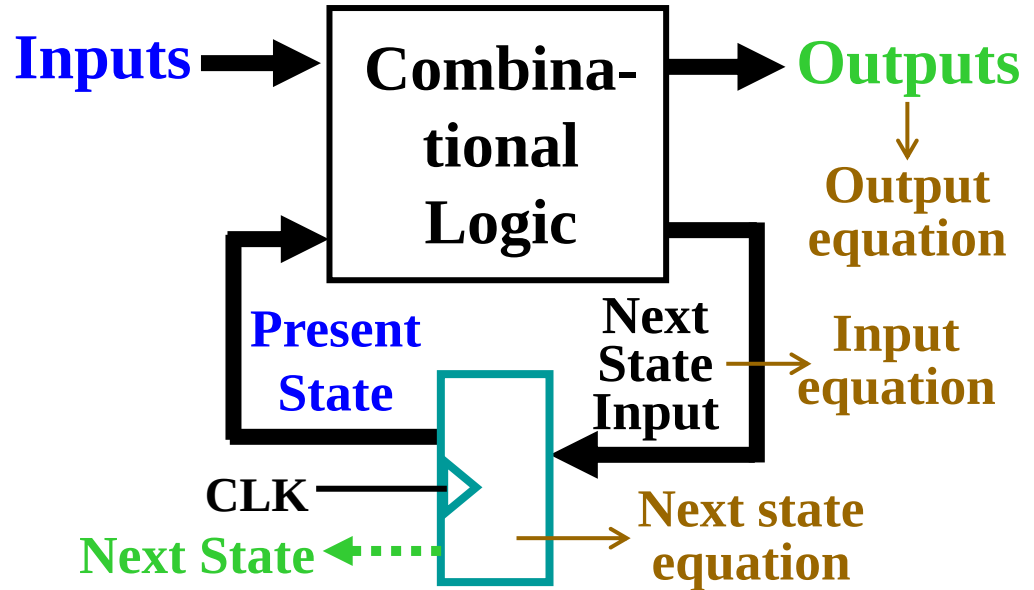


State Table Characteristics

- **State table** – a multiple variable table with the following four sections:
 - *Input* – the input combinations allowed.
 - *Present State* – the values of the state variables for each allowed state.
 - *Next-state* – the value of the state at time $(t+1)$ based on the present state and the input.
 - *Output* – the value of the output as a function of the present state and (sometimes) the input.
- From the viewpoint of a **truth table**:
 - the inputs are *Input, Present State*
 - the outputs are *Output, Next State*

State Table Characteristics

- **State table**
 - the inputs
 - **Input**
 - **Present State**
 - the outputs
 - **Output**
 - **Next State**



- **Outputs** are a Boolean function of Present State and (sometimes) Inputs.
- **Next State** (Outputs of flip-flops) is a Boolean function of Next State Inputs and the characteristics of the flip-flops (Next state equation).

Example 1: State Table (from Fig. 4-13)

- The state table can be filled in using the input, next state and output equations:

- Input** : $D_A = A(t)x(t) + B(t)x(t)$ **Next state:** $A(t+1) = D_A$
 $D_B = \bar{A}(t)x(t)$ $B(t+1) = D_B$

- Output:** $y(t) = \bar{x}(t)(B(t) + A(t))$


Present State	Input	Next State	Output
A(t) B(t)	x(t)	A(t+1)/D _A , B(t+1)/D _B	y(t)
0 0	0	0 0	0
0 0	1	0 1	0
0 1	0	0 0	1
0 1	1	1 1	0
1 0	0	0 0	1
1 0	1	1 0	0
1 1	0	0 0	1
1 1	1	1 0	0

Example 1: Alternate State Table

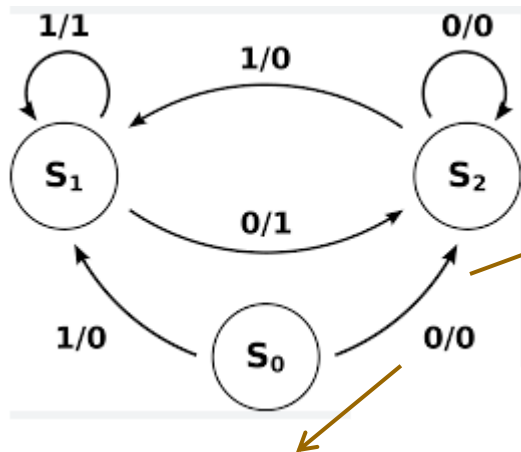
- **2-dimensional table** that matches well to a K-map.
Present state rows and input columns in Gray code order.

- $A(t+1) = A(t)x(t) + B(t)x(t)$
- $B(t+1) = \bar{A}(t)x(t)$
- $y(t) = \bar{x}(t)(B(t) + A(t))$

Present State A(t) B(t)	Next State		Output	
	$x(t)=0$ A(t+1)B(t+1)	$x(t)=1$ A(t+1)B(t+1)	$x(t)=0$ y(t)	$x(t)=1$ y(t)
0 0	0 0	0 1	0	0
0 1	0 0	1 1	1	0
1 1	0 0	1 0	1	0
1 0	0 0	1 0	1	0

State Diagrams

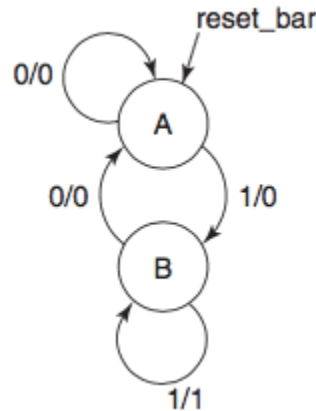
- The sequential circuit function can be represented as a state diagram with the following components:



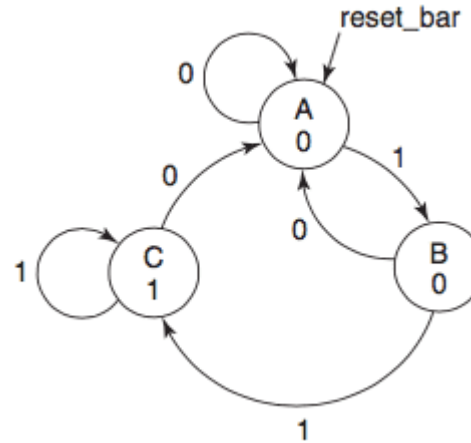
- A circle with the **state name** in it for each state
- A directed arc from the present state to the next state for each state transition
- A **label** on each directed arc with the **input values** which causes the state transition, and
- A **label** for **output**:
 - On each directed arc with the output value, or
 - On each circle with the output value

State Diagrams

Mealy type machine



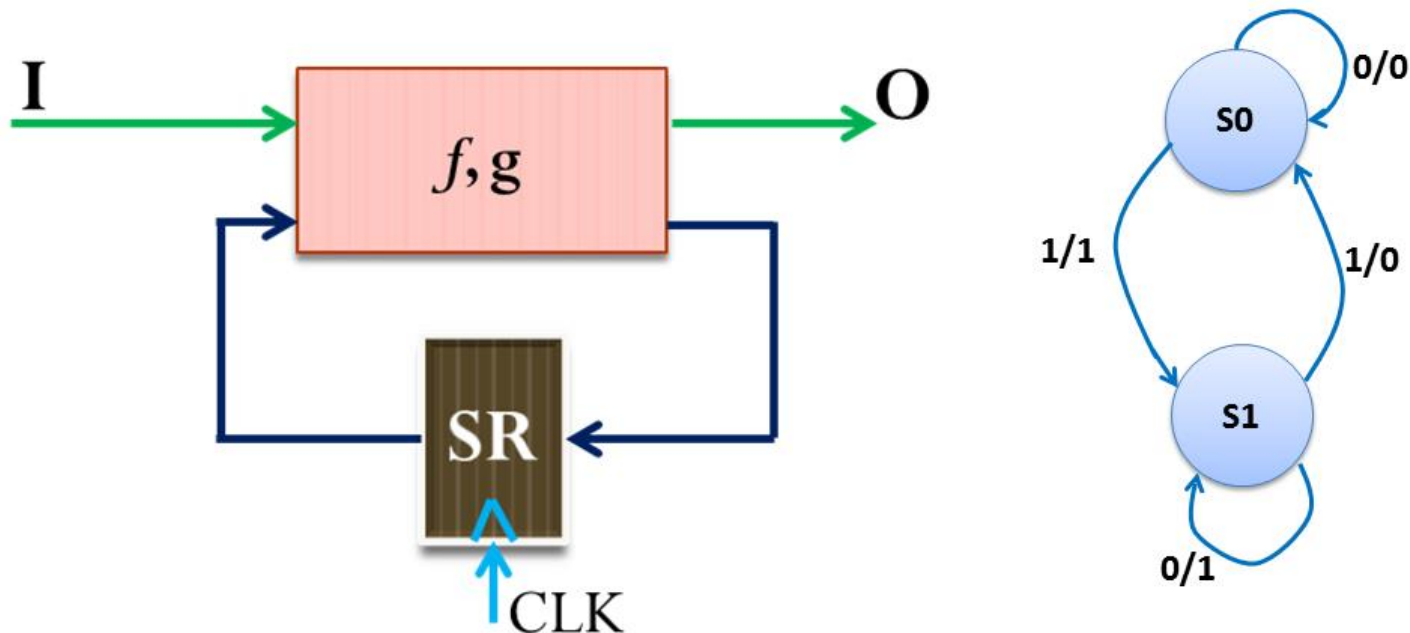
Moore type machine



- **Output label form:**
 - On directed arc with the output value (**Mealy** type):
 - **input/output**
 - output depends on state and input
 - On circle with output value (**Moore** type):
 - **state/output**
 - output depends only on state

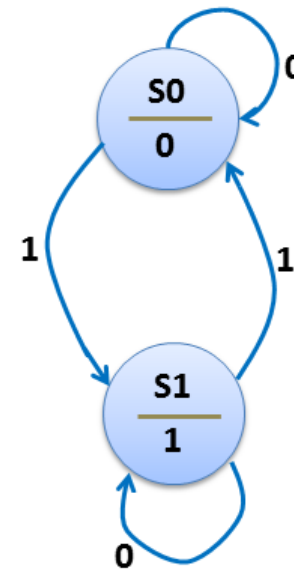
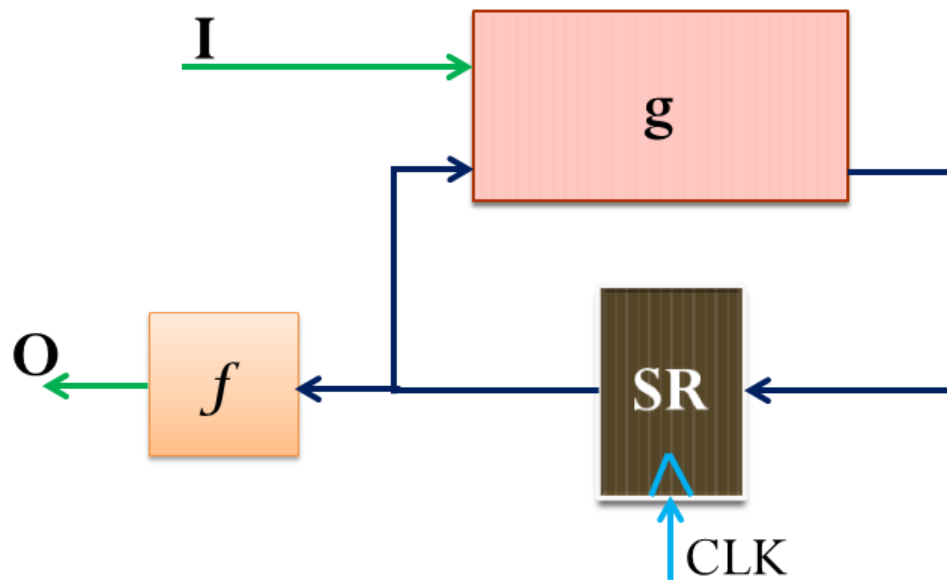
Mealy and Moore Models (continued)

- Sequential circuits are implemented in two different ways: Mealy model and Moore model.
- Mealy Model - named after G. Mealy
 - Outputs are a function of inputs AND states (e.g., $Y = XA$)
 - Usually **specified on the state transition arcs**.



Mealy and Moore Models

- Sequential circuits are implemented in two different ways: Mealy model and Moore model.
- Moore Model - named after E.F. Moore
 - Outputs are a function ONLY of states (e.g., $Y = A + B$)
 - Usually specified on the states.



Bayes Theorem and Moore Model

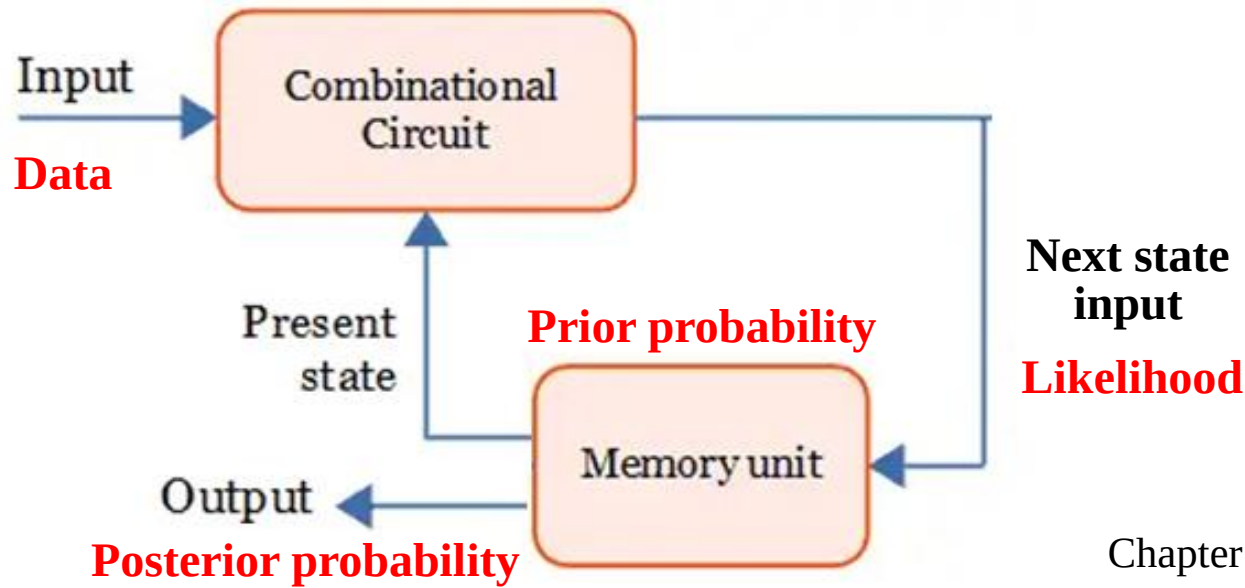
Likelihood

Prior probability

The posterior probability

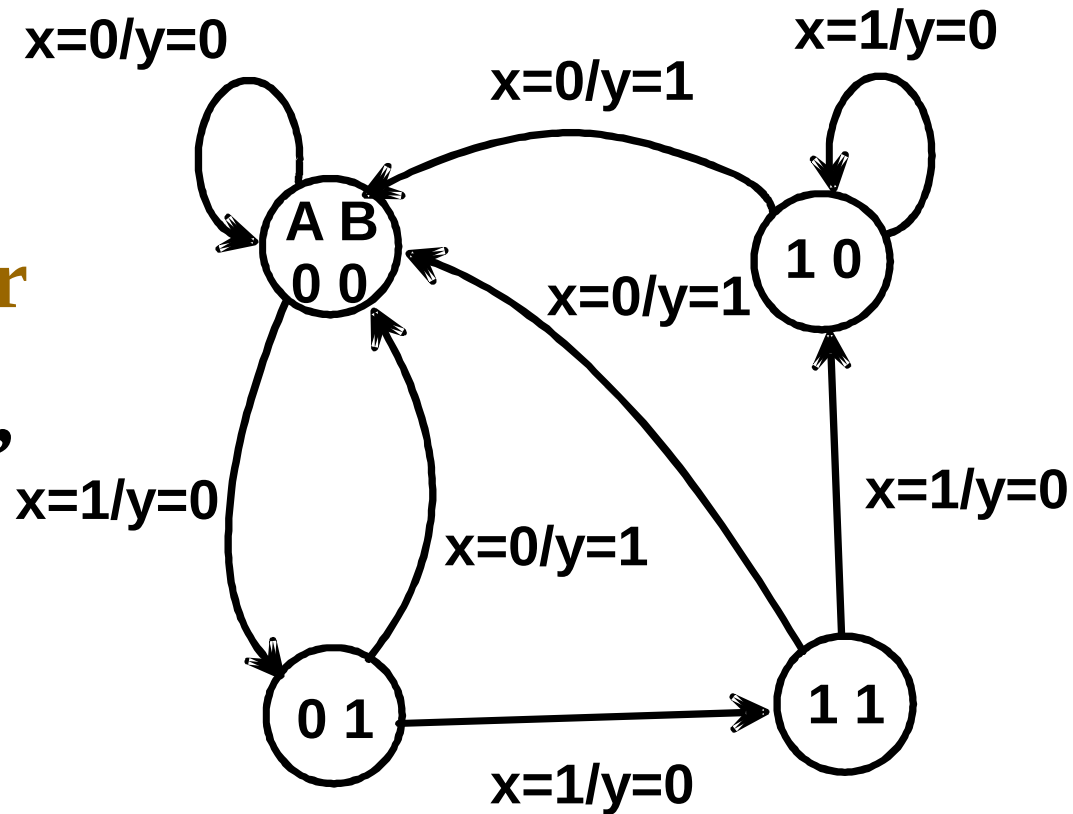
$$P(\text{belief} \mid \text{data}) = \frac{P(\text{data} \mid \text{belief}) P(\text{belief})}{P(\text{data})}$$

Normalizes our probabilities



Example 1: State Diagram

- Which type?
- It is a 2-bit **saturating counter**
- For small circuits, usually easier to understand than the state table



output: $y(t) = \bar{x}(t)(B(t) + A(t))$

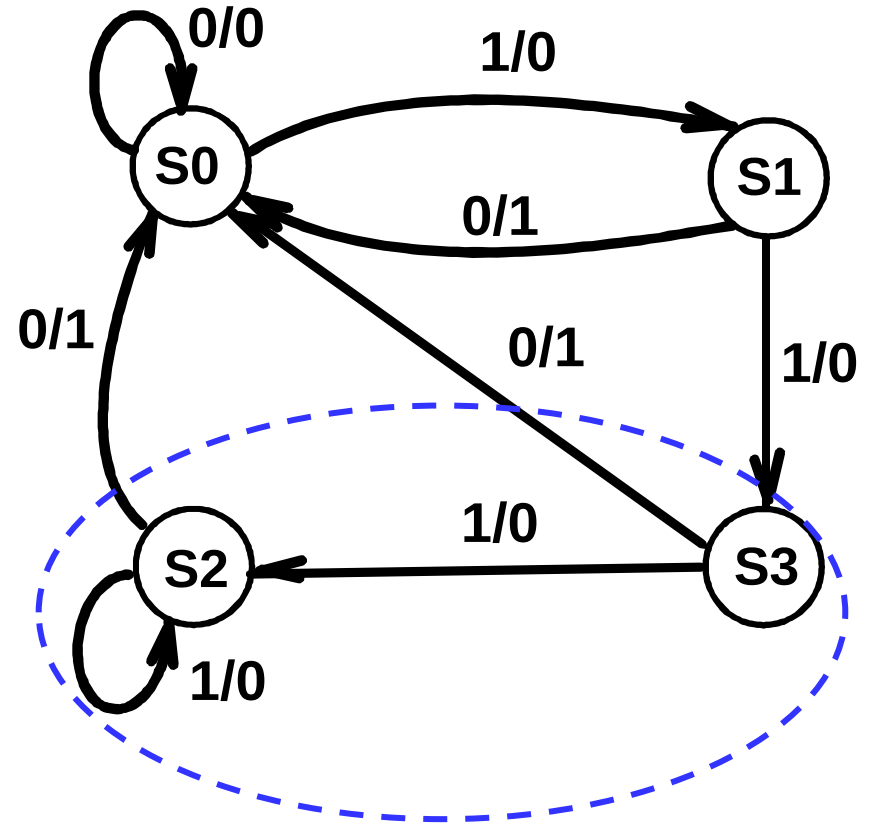
Present State A(t) B(t)	Next State		Output	
	x(t)=0 A(t+1)B(t+1)	x(t)=1 A(t+1)B(t+1)	x(t)=0 y(t)	x(t)=1 y(t)
0 0	0 0	0 1	0	0
0 1	0 0	1 1	1	0
1 1	0 0	1 0	1	0
1 0	0 0	1 0	1	0

Equivalent State Definitions

- Two states are *equivalent* if their response for each possible input sequence is an identical output sequence.
- Alternatively, two states are *equivalent*
 - if their **outputs** produced for each input symbol is identical
 - and their **next states** for each input symbol are the same or equivalent.

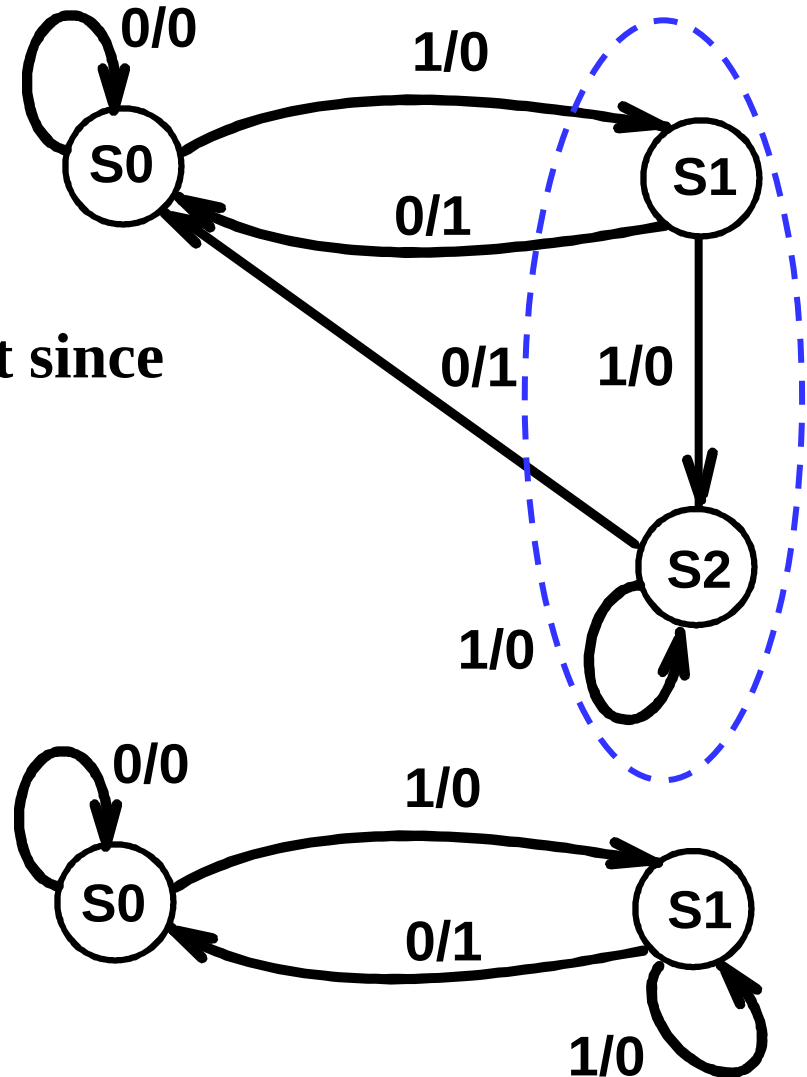
Equivalent State Example

- For states S3 and S2,
 - the **output** for input 0 is 1 and input 1 is 0, and
 - the **next state** for input 0 is S0 and for input 1 is S2.
 - By the alternative definition, states S3 and S2 are equivalent.



Equivalent State Example

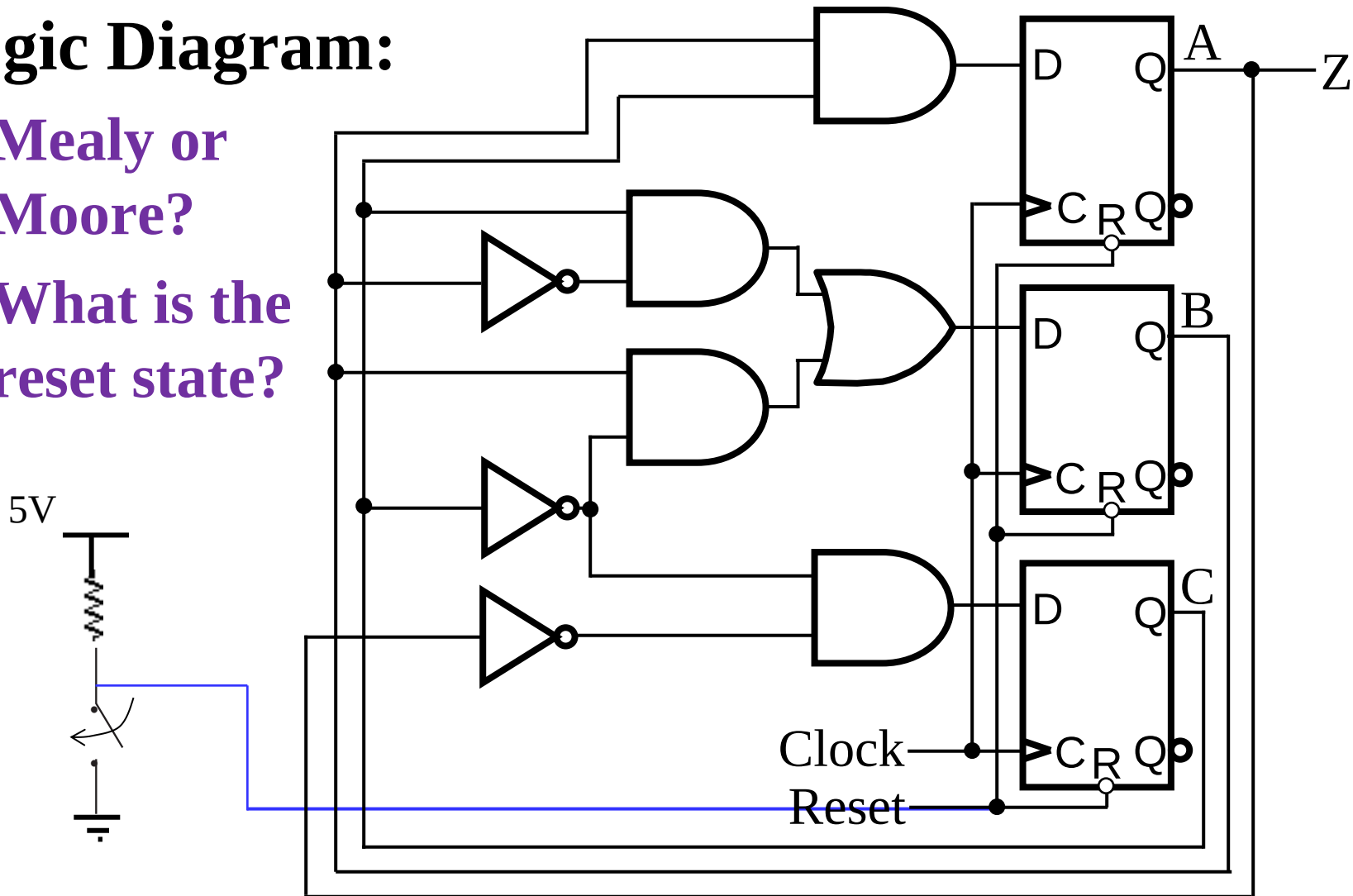
- Replacing S3 and S2 by a single state gives state diagram:
- Examining the new diagram, states S1 and S2 are equivalent since
 - their outputs for input 0 is 1 and input 1 is 0, and
 - their next state for input 0 is S0 and for input 1 is S2,
- Replacing S1 and S2 by a single state gives state diagram:



Example 2: Sequential Circuit Analysis

■ Logic Diagram:

- Mealy or Moore?
- What is the reset state?



Example 2: Flip-Flop Input Equations

■ Variables

- Inputs: None
- Outputs: Z
- State Variables: A, B, C

■ Initialization: Reset to (0,0,0)

■ Input Equations:

$$D_A = B(t)C(t)$$

$$D_B = \overline{B}(t)C(t) + B(t)\overline{C}(t)$$

$$D_C = \overline{A}(t)\overline{C}(t)$$

■ Next State Equations:

$$A(t+1) = D_A$$

$$B(t+1) = D_B$$

$$C(t+1) = D_C$$

■ Output Equation:

$$Z = A(t)$$

Example 2: State Table

$$A' = A(t+1)$$

$$B' = B(t+1)$$

$$C' = C(t+1)$$

$$A(t+1) = B(t)C(t)$$

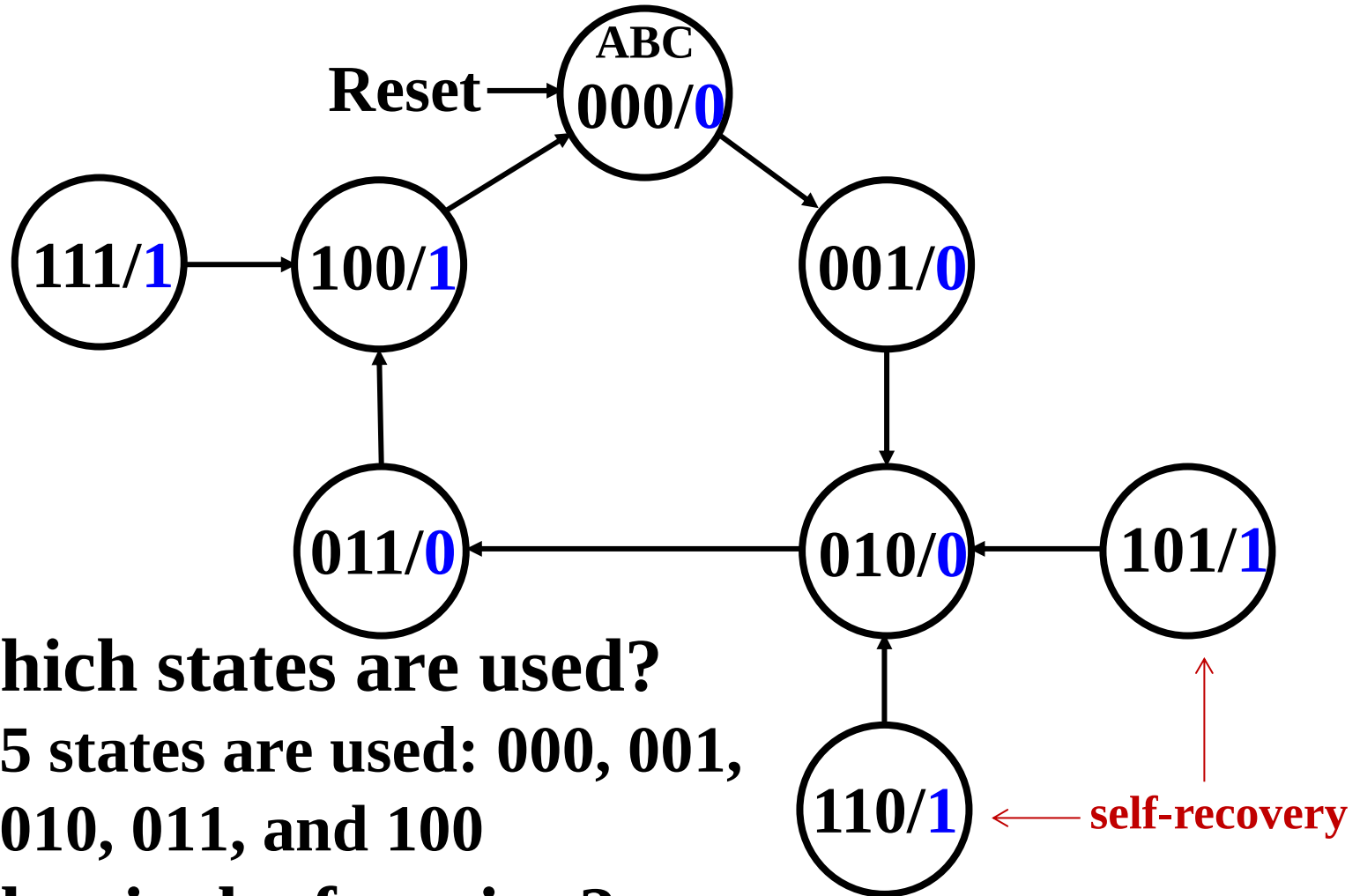
$$B(t+1) = \overline{B}(t)C(t) + B(t)\overline{C}(t)$$

$$C(t+1) = \overline{A}(t)\overline{C}(t)$$

$$Z = A(t)$$

present state	next state	output
A B C	A'B'C'	Z
0 0 0	0 0 1	0
0 0 1	0 1 0	0
0 1 0	0 1 1	0
0 1 1	1 0 0	0
1 0 0	0 0 0	1
1 0 1	0 1 0	1
1 1 0	0 1 0	1
1 1 1	1 0 0	1

Example 2: State Diagram



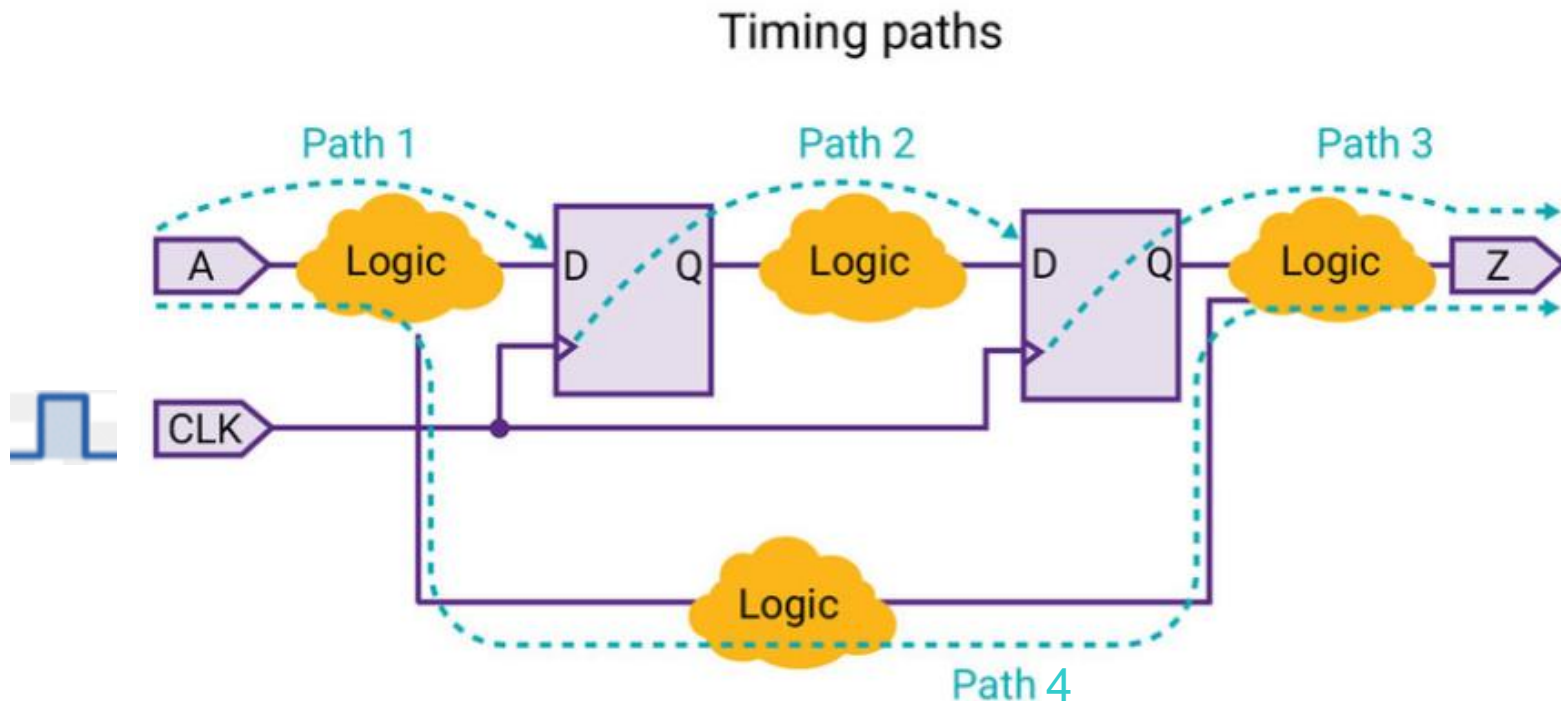
- Which states are used?
 - 5 states are used: 000, 001, 010, 011, and 100
- What is the function?
 - A **non-saturating counter**

Sequential Circuit Analysis

- Analysis of sequential circuits including:
 - **Generating the functionality** of the sequential circuit using state table, state diagram, and input/output Boolean equations.
 - **Determining the timing constraints** that a sequential circuit must be satisfied in order to prevent metastability, which allows the circuit to be used without error.

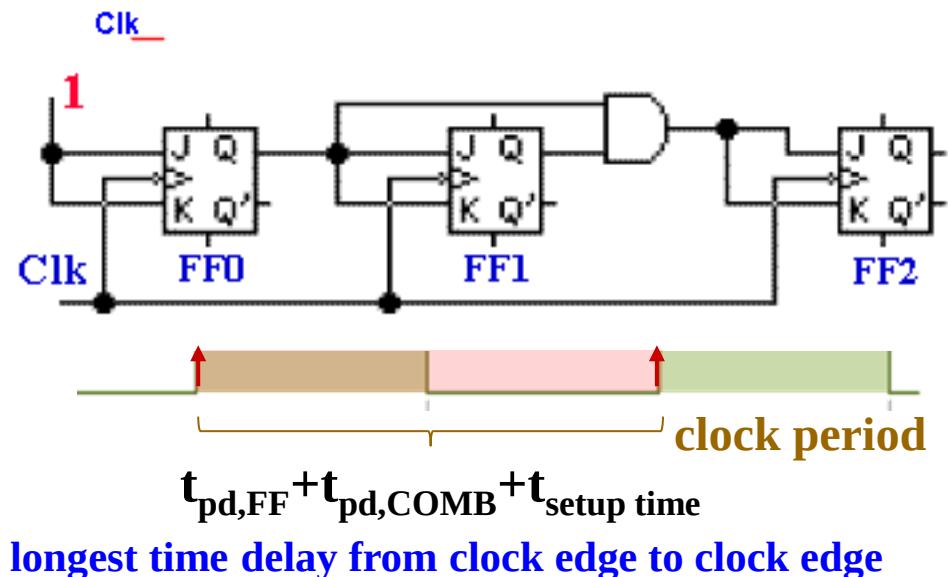
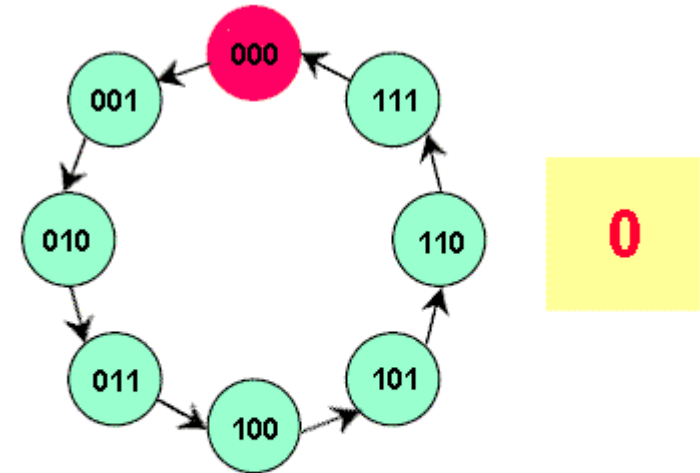
Timing Analysis of Sequential Circuits

- It is important to analyze the timing behavior of a sequential circuit.
- The ultimate goal of **timing analysis** is to determine the **maximum clock frequency** of the circuit.



Timing Analysis of Sequential Circuits (continued)

- Consider a 3-bit binary counter.
- If the clock period is too short, data changes may not be able to propagate through the circuit to flip-flop inputs before the setup time interval begins.



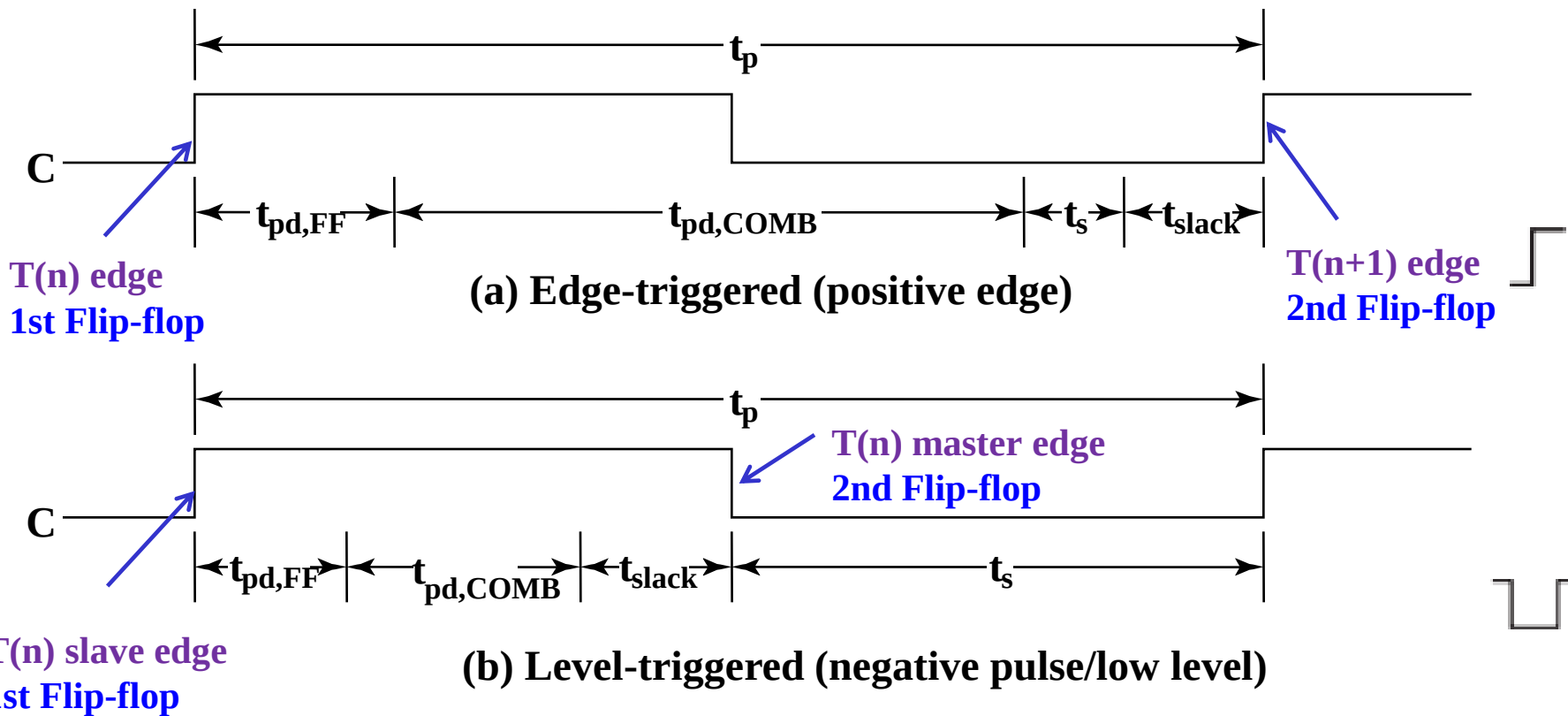
Timing Analysis of Sequential Circuits (continued)

■ Timing Constraints Components

- t_p - **clock period** - The interval between occurrences of a specific clock edge in a periodic clock
 - $t_{pd,FF}$ - **flip-flop propagation delay** - The amount of time from clock edge to when the flip-flop output becomes stable
 - $t_{pd,COMB}$ - **combinational logic delay** – The total delay of combinational logic along the path from flip-flop output to flip-flop input
 - t_s – **flip-flop setup time** - The amount of time data input should be held steady before the clock event.
 - t_{slack} - **extra time in the clock period**
- time delays along the path

Timing Analysis of Sequential Circuits (continued)

- Timing components along a path from flip-flop to flip-flop



Timing Analysis of Sequential Circuits (continued)

- **Timing Equations**

$$t_p \geq t_{\text{slack}} + (t_{\text{pd,FF}} + t_{\text{pd,COMB}} + t_s) \quad \longleftarrow \text{for every Flip-flop}$$

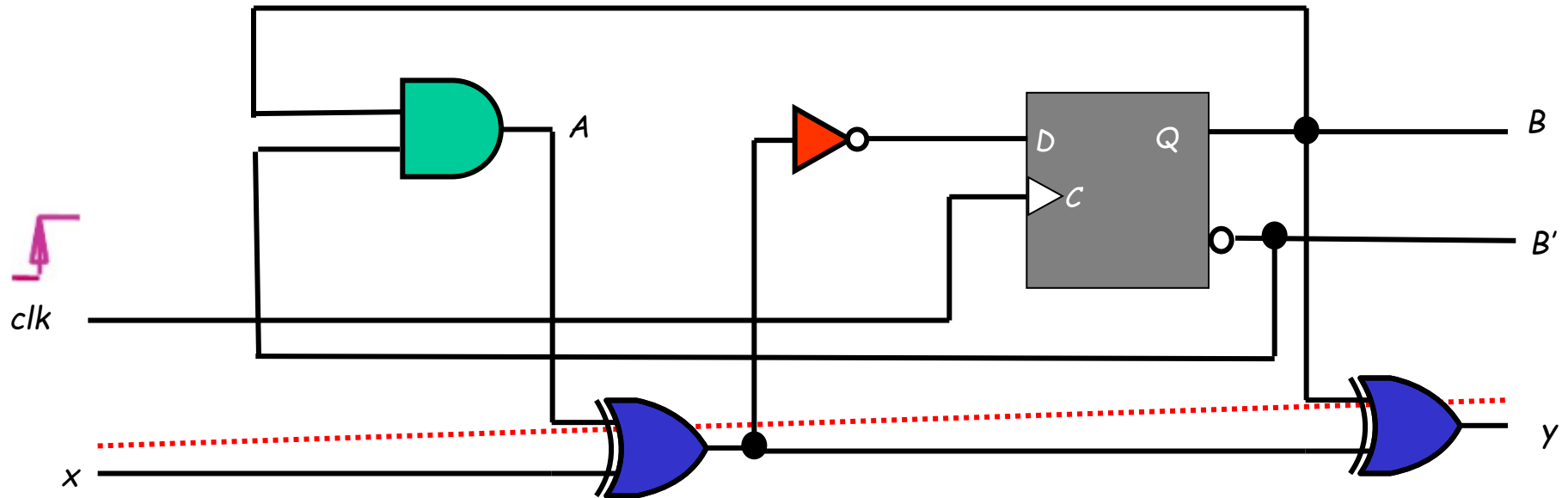
- For t_{slack} greater than or equal to zero,

$$t_p \geq \max (t_{\text{pd,FF}} + t_{\text{pd,COMB}} + t_s) \quad \longleftarrow \text{for all Flip-flops}$$

for all paths from flip-flop output to flip-flop input

- Can be calculated more precisely by using t_{PHL} and t_{PLH} values instead of t_{pd} values, but requires consideration of inversions on paths

Timing Analysis Example (1/5)



$$t_{pd,NOT} = 0.5 \text{ ns} \quad t_{pd,FF} = 2.0 \text{ ns}$$

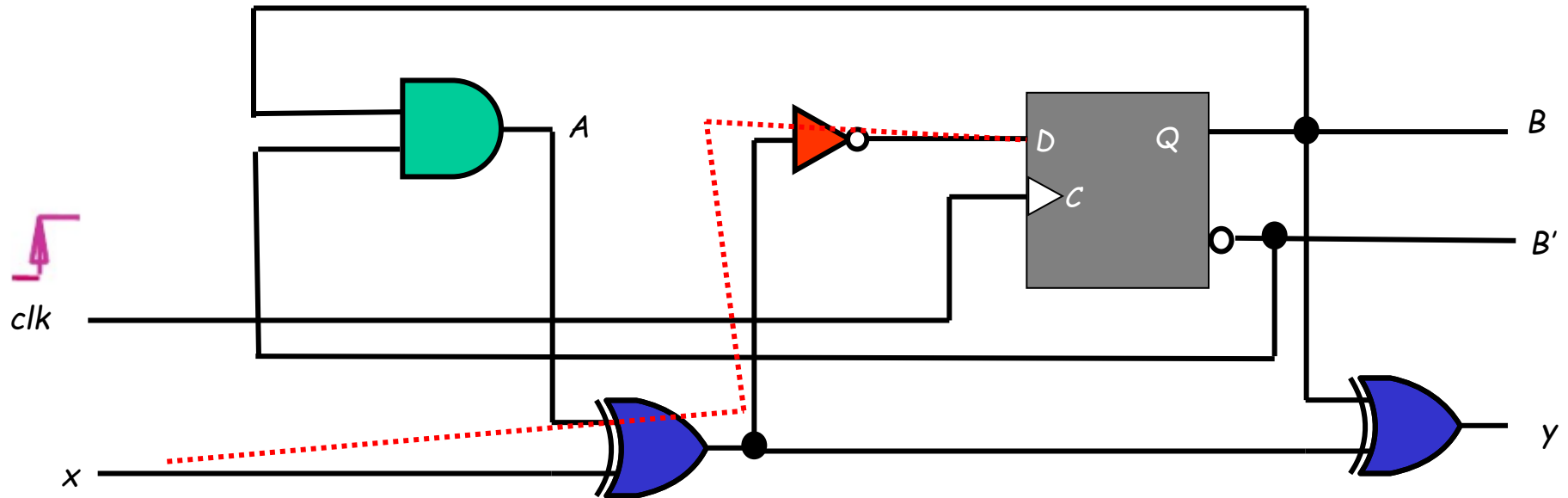
$$t_{pd,XOR} = 2.0 \text{ ns} \quad t_s = 1.0 \text{ ns}$$

$$t_{pd,AND} = 1.0 \text{ ns} \quad t_h = 0.25 \text{ ns}$$

- Find the longest path delay **from external input passing through gates only to the output.**

$$t_{pd,XOR} + t_{pd,XOR} = 2.0 + 2.0 = 4.0 \text{ ns}$$

Timing Analysis Example (2/5)



$$t_{pd,NOT} = 0.5 \text{ ns} \quad t_{pd,FF} = 2.0 \text{ ns}$$

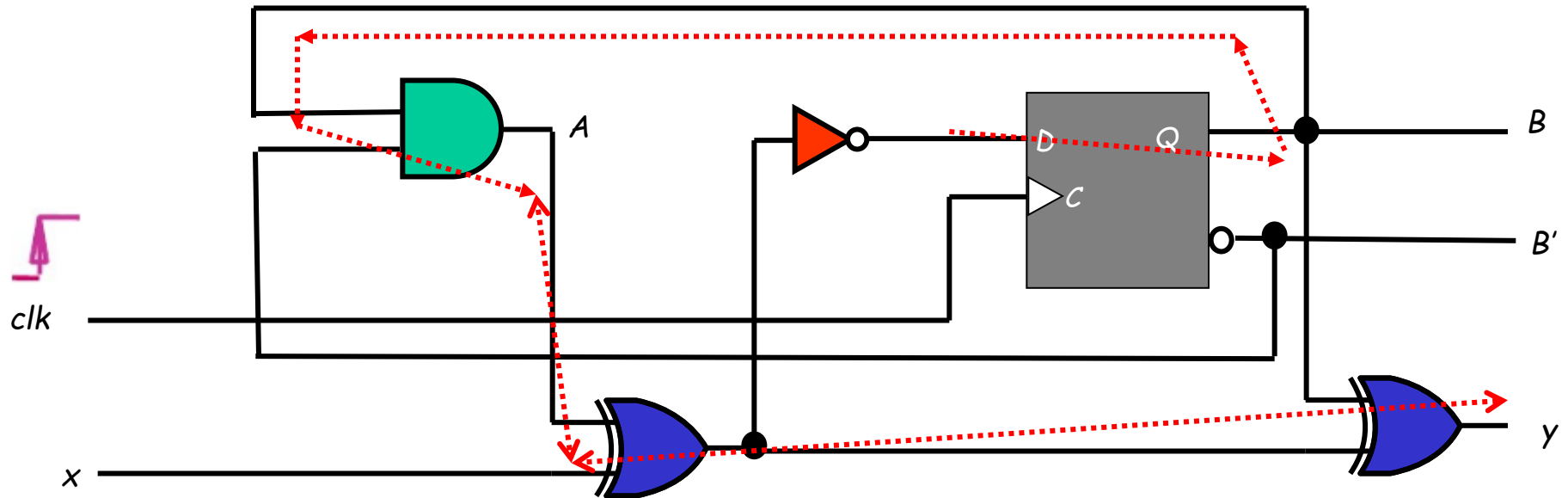
$$t_{pd,XOR} = 2.0 \text{ ns} \quad t_s = 1.0 \text{ ns}$$

$$t_{pd,AND} = 1.0 \text{ ns} \quad t_h = 0.25 \text{ ns}$$

- Find the longest path delay in the circuit **from external input to positive clock edge**.

$$\begin{aligned} & t_{pd,XOR} + t_{pd,NOT} + t_s \\ &= 2.0 + 0.5 + 1.0 = 3.5 \text{ ns} \end{aligned}$$

Timing Analysis Example (3/5)



$$t_{pd,NOT} = 0.5 \text{ ns} \quad t_{pd,FF} = 2.0 \text{ ns}$$

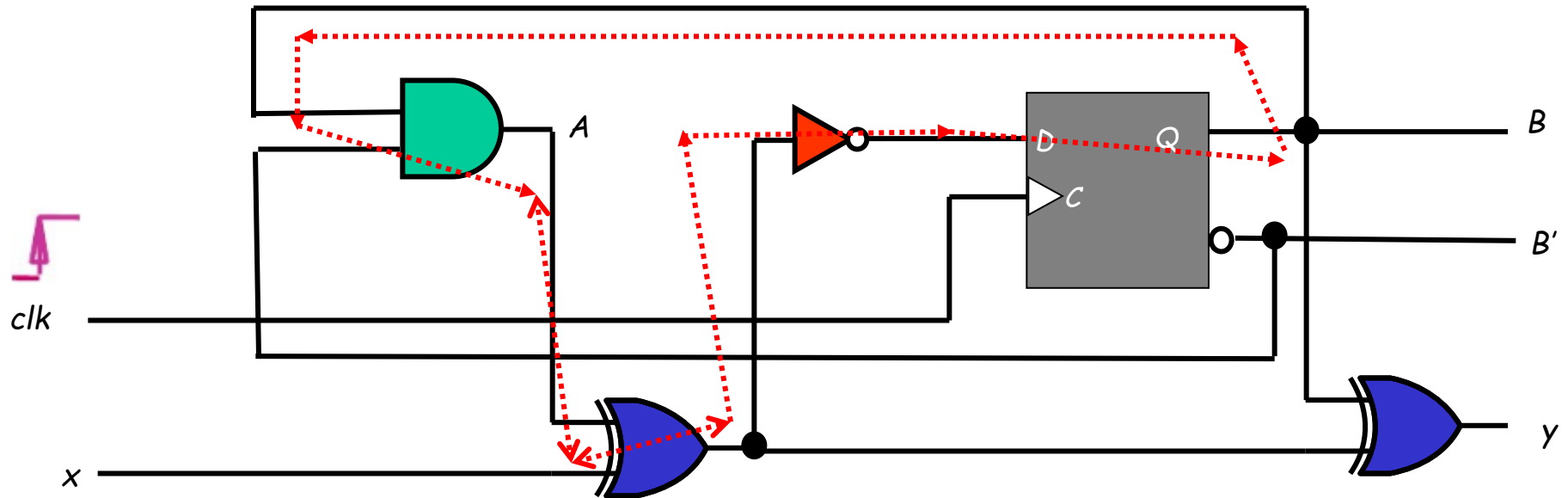
$$t_{pd,XOR} = 2.0 \text{ ns} \quad t_s = 1.0 \text{ ns}$$

$$t_{pd,AND} = 1.0 \text{ ns} \quad t_h = 0.25 \text{ ns}$$

- Find the longest path delay **from positive clock edge to output.**

$$t_{pd,FF} + t_{pd,AND} + t_{pd,XOR} + t_{pd,XOR} \\ = 2.0 + 1.0 + 2.0 + 2.0 = 7 \text{ ns}$$

Timing Analysis Example (4/5)



$$t_{pd,NOT} = 0.5 \text{ ns} \quad t_{pd,FF} = 2.0 \text{ ns}$$

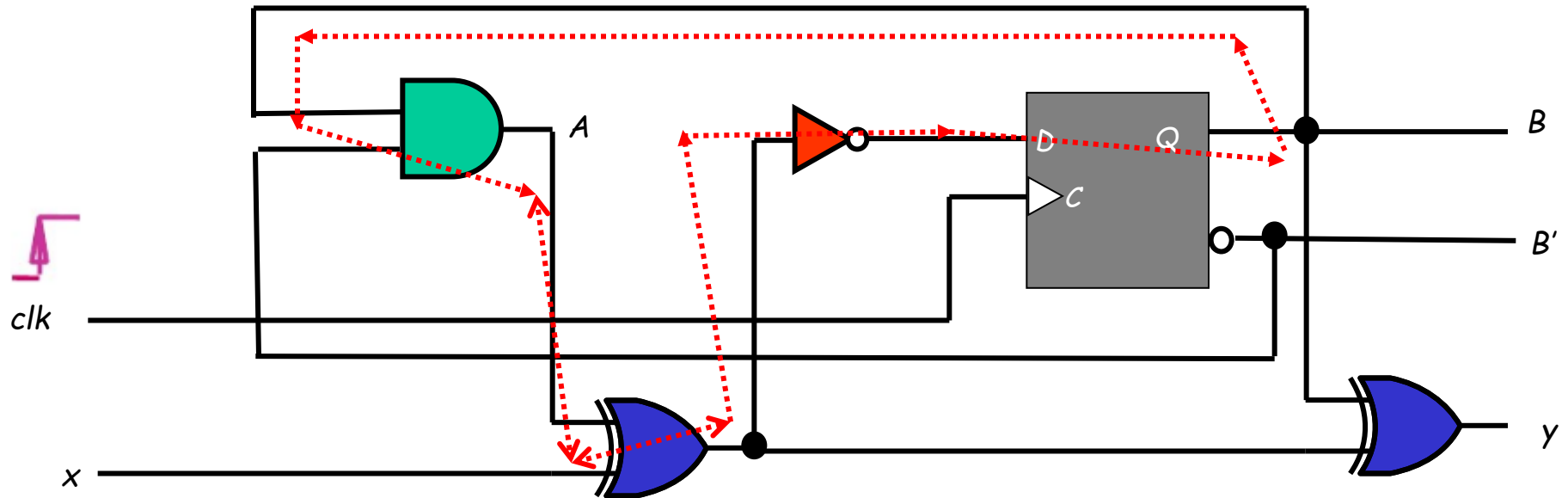
$$t_{pd,XOR} = 2.0 \text{ ns} \quad t_s = 1.0 \text{ ns}$$

$$t_{pd,AND} = 1.0 \text{ ns} \quad t_h = 0.25 \text{ ns}$$

- Find the longest path delay **from positive clock edge to the positive clock edge**.

$$t_{pd,FF} + t_{pd,AND} + t_{pd,XOR} + t_{pd,NOT} + t_s \\ = 2.0 + 1.0 + 2.0 + 0.5 + 1.0 = 6.5 \text{ ns}$$

Timing Analysis Example (5/5)



$$t_{pd,NOT} = 0.5 \text{ ns} \quad t_{pd,FF} = 2.0 \text{ ns}$$

$$t_{pd,XOR} = 2.0 \text{ ns} \quad t_s = 1.0 \text{ ns}$$

$$t_{pd,AND} = 1.0 \text{ ns} \quad t_h = 0.25 \text{ ns}$$

- Determine the **maximum frequency** of the circuit in megahertz (MHz).

$$t_{pd,FF} + t_{pd,AND} + t_{pd,XOR} + t_{pd,NOT} + t_s \\ = 2.0 + 1.0 + 2.0 + 0.5 + 1.0 = 6.5 \text{ ns}$$

$$f_{\max} = 1/(6.5 \times 10^{-9}) \approx 154 \text{ MHz}$$

Assignments

Reading:

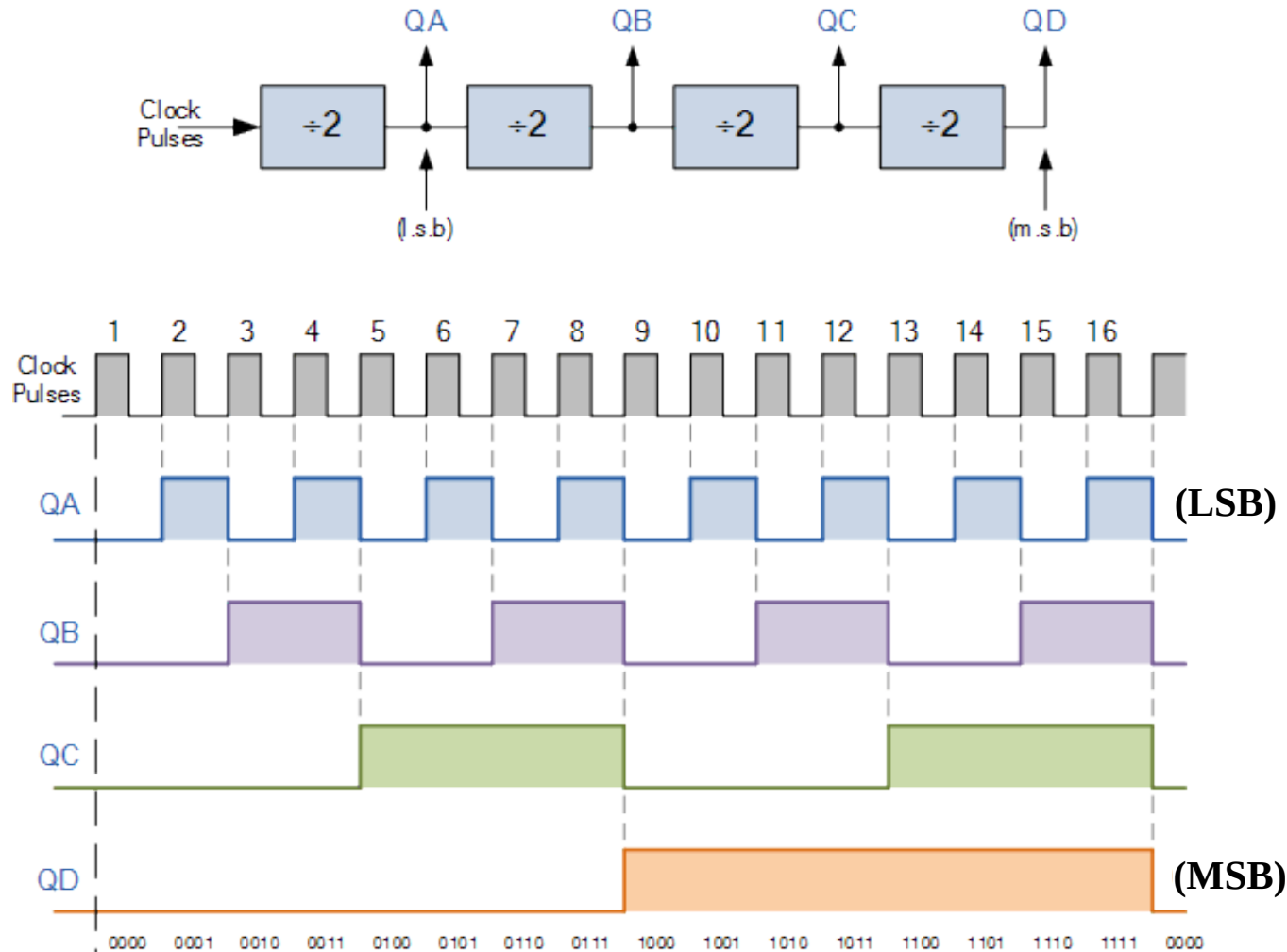
- 4.1-4.4, 4.9-4.10

Problem assignment:

- 4-7; 4-9; 4-12(b); 4-58; 4-59

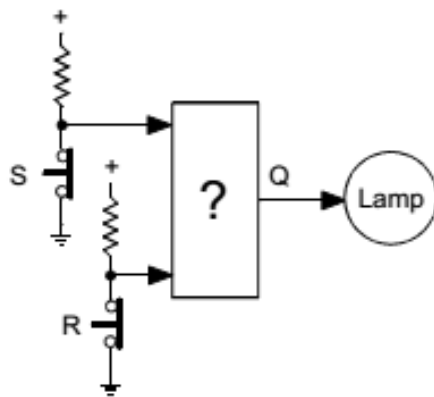
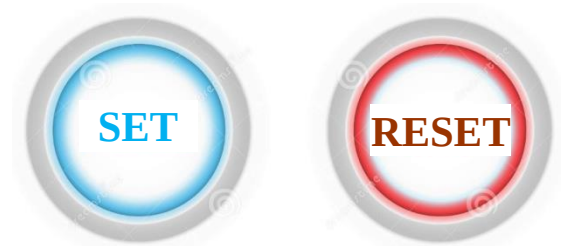
The Latch Timing Problem (continued)

- Consider the following circuit known as a binary counter

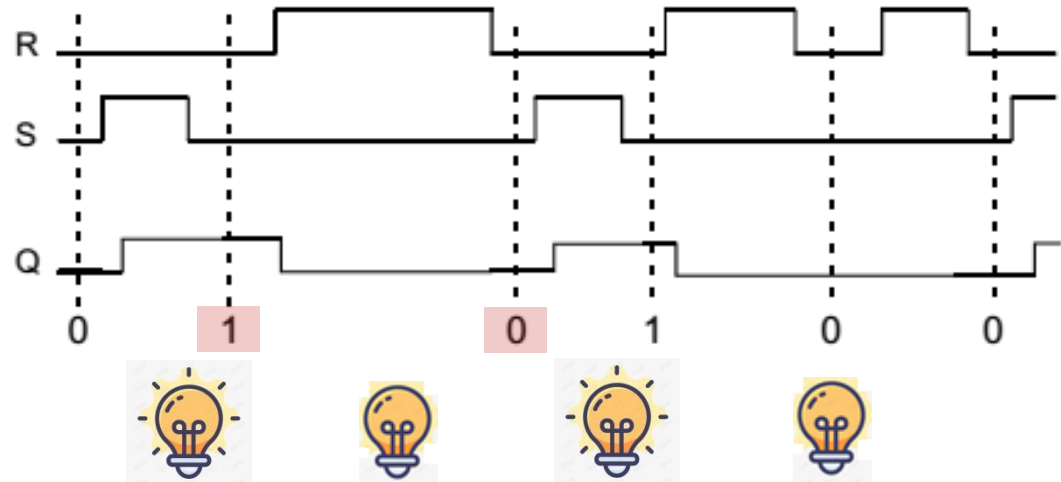


Going Beyond Combinational Logic

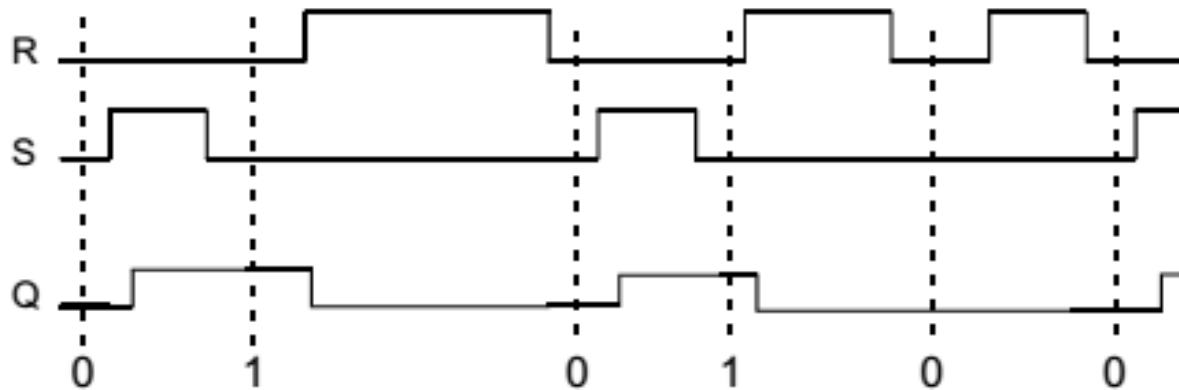
- **Problem:** Design a circuit to control a lamp by two switches **S** and **R**. Assume that S and R are not pushed simultaneously.
- 1) if $R = 1$, then the lamp should turn off
- 2) if $R = 0$, then the lamp should stay off
- 3) if $S = 1$, then the lamp should turn on
- 4) if $S = 0$, then the lamp should stay on



delayed switch



Going Beyond Combinational Logic (continued)



Truth Table

R	S	Q
0	0	?
0	1	1
1	0	0
1	1	?

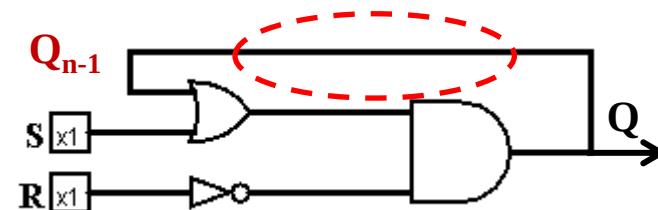
R	S	Q_{n-1}	Q
0	0		Q_{n-1}
0	1		1
1	0		0
1	1		?

Boolean Function

$$Q = \overline{R} \overline{S} Q_{n-1} + \overline{R} S = \overline{R} (\overline{S} Q_{n-1} + S)$$

$$= \overline{R} (Q_{n-1} + S)$$

Logic Circuit

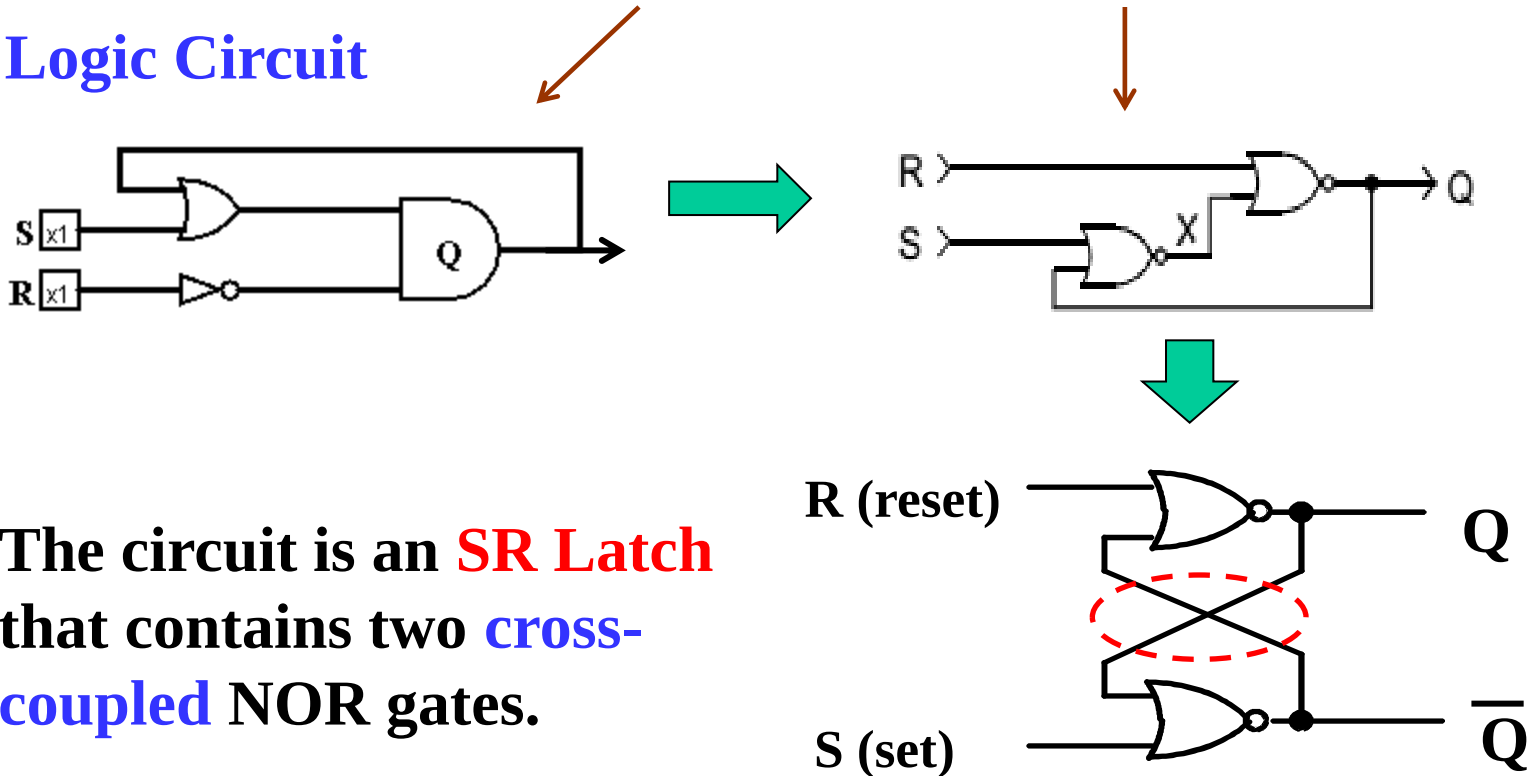


Going Beyond Combinational Logic (continued)

Boolean Function

$$Q = \overline{R} \overline{S} Q_{n-1} + \overline{R} S = \overline{R} (Q_{n-1} + S) = \overline{R + (\overline{Q_{n-1}} + S)}$$

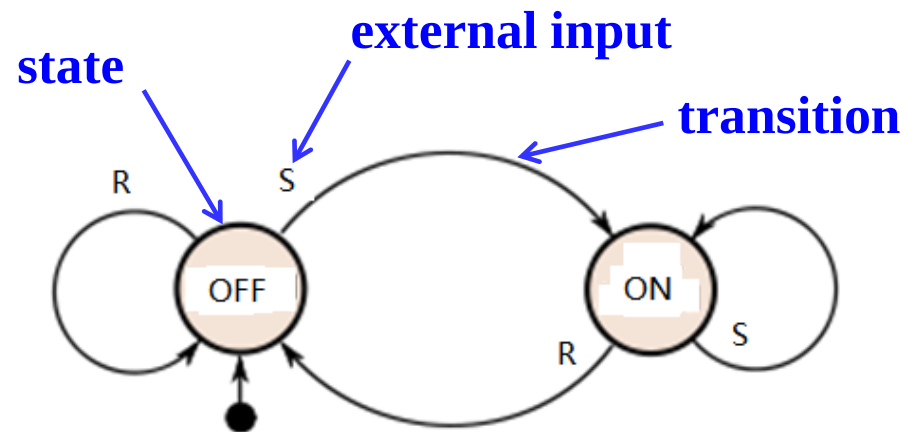
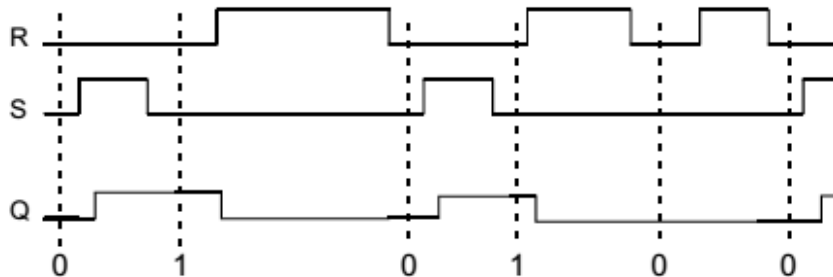
Logic Circuit



The circuit is an **SR Latch** that contains two **cross-coupled** NOR gates.

Going Beyond Combinational Logic (continued)

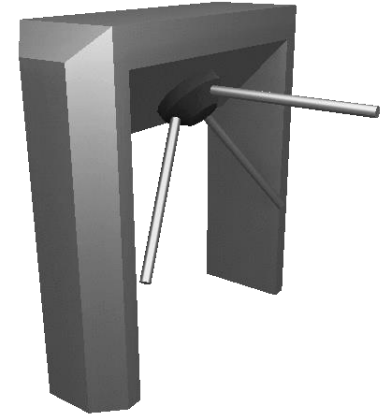
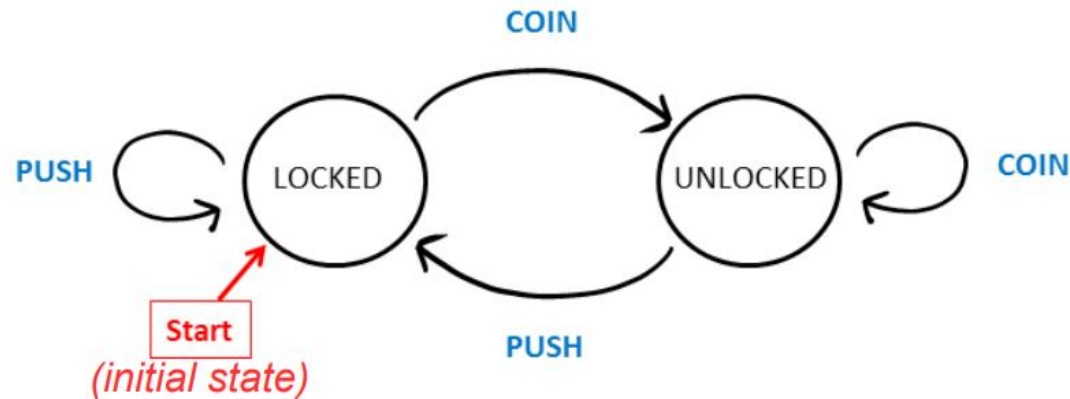
- A circuit whose output depends not only on the present input but also on the history of the input is called a **sequential circuit**.
- A sequential circuit can be described by a state diagram, which consists of a finite number of states at any given time. It can change from one state to another in response to external inputs.



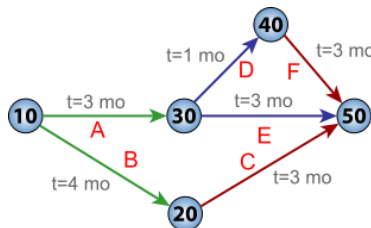
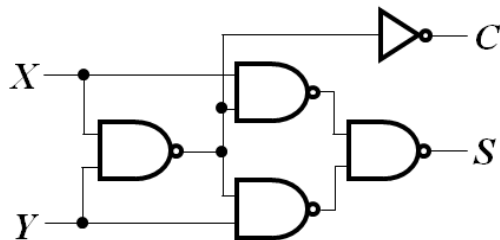
state diagram for a delayed switch

Going Beyond Combinational Logic (continued)

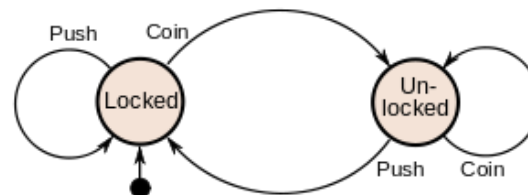
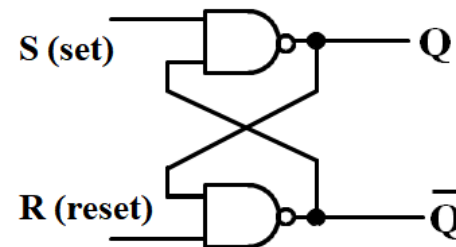
- Another example: turnstile



- Combinational circuits vs. Sequential circuits



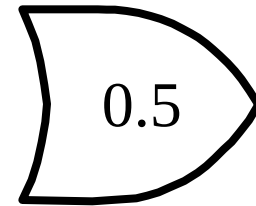
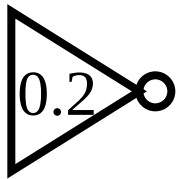
Combinational circuits



Sequential circuits

Gate Delay Models

- Suppose gates with delay n ns are represented for $n = 0.2$ ns, $n = 0.4$ ns, $n = 0.5$ ns, respectively:

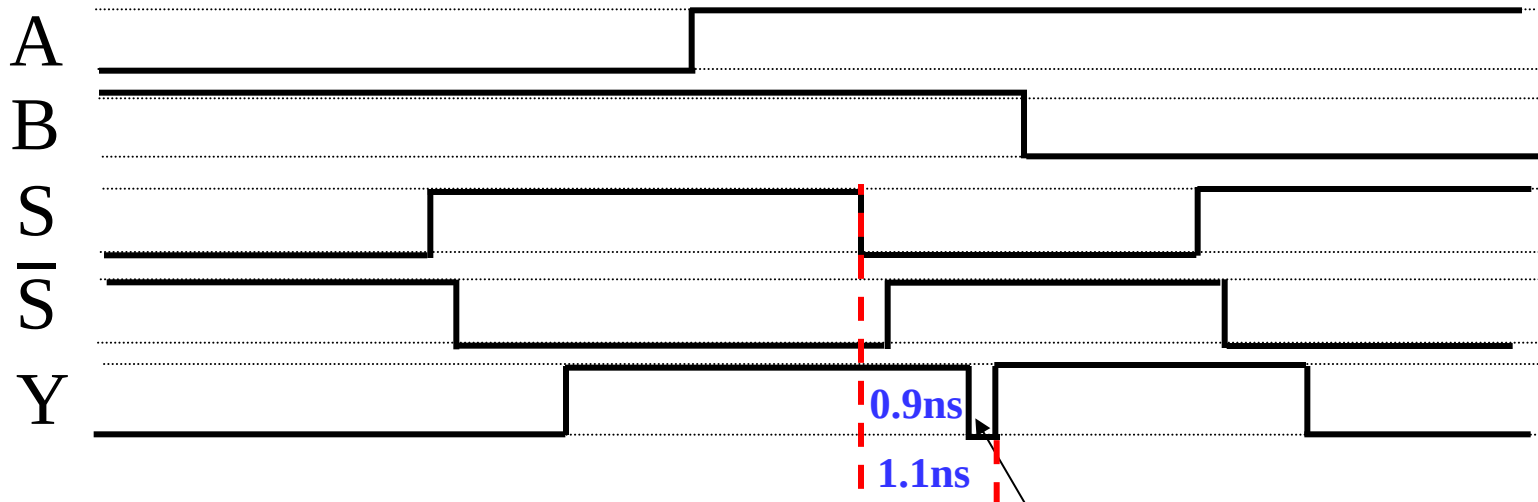
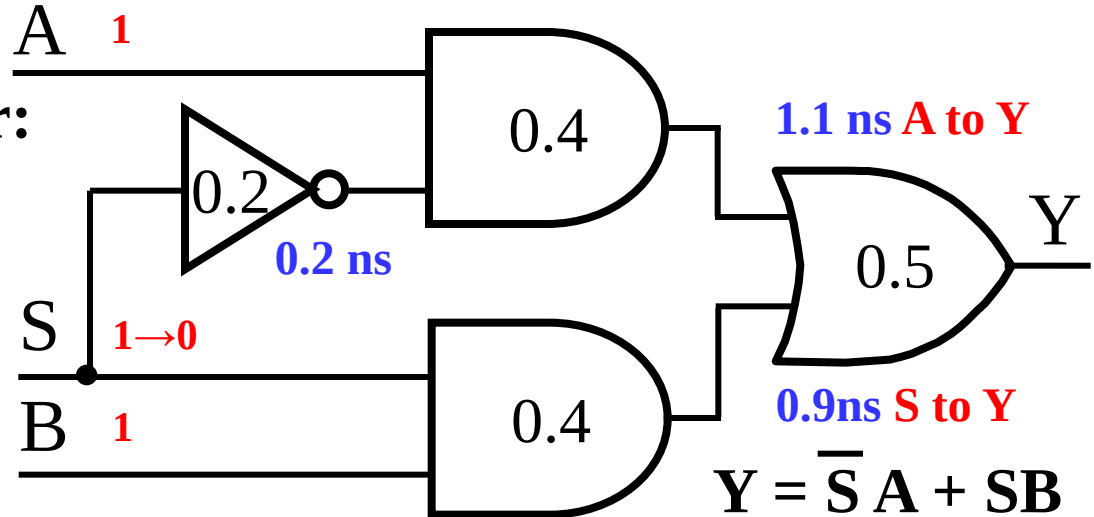


Circuit Delay Model

- Consider a simple 2-input multiplexer:

- With function:

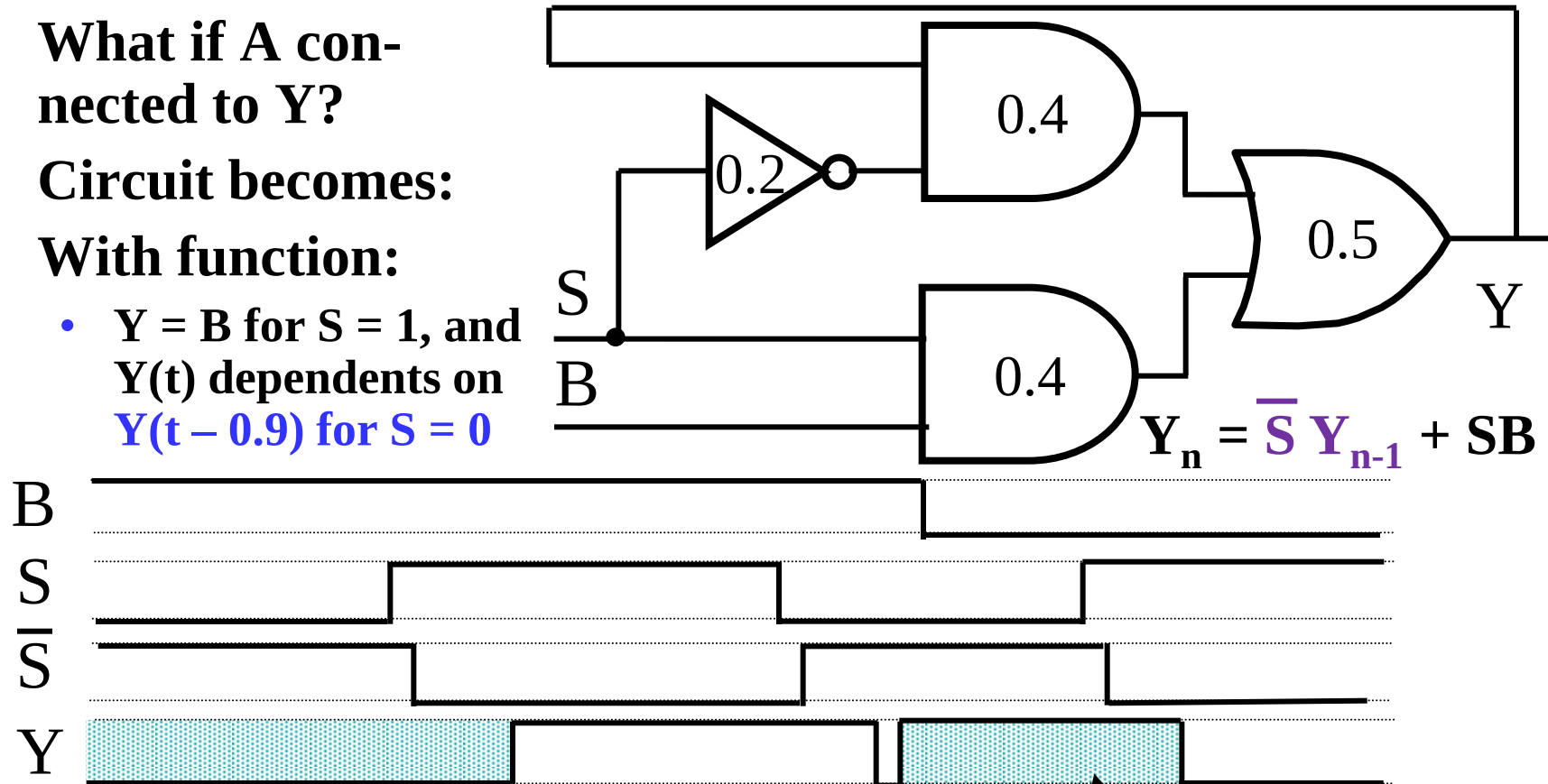
- $Y = A$ for $S = 0$
- $Y = B$ for $S = 1$



- “Glitch” is due to delay of inverter

Storing State

- What if A connected to Y?
- Circuit becomes:
- With function:
 - $Y = B$ for $S = 1$, and $Y(t)$ depends on $Y(t - 0.9)$ for $S = 0$



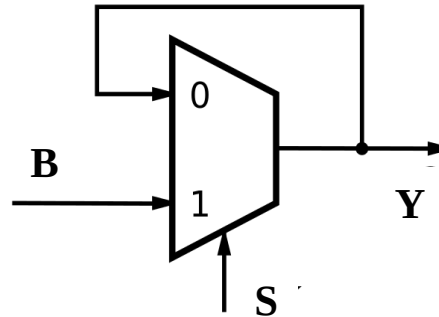
- The simple combinational circuit has now become a sequential circuit because its output is a function of a time sequence of input signals!

Y is stored value in shaded area

Storing State (Continued)

- Simulation example as input signals change with time. Changes occur every 100 ns, so that the tenths of ns delays are negligible.

$$Y_n = \overline{S} Y_{n-1} + SB$$

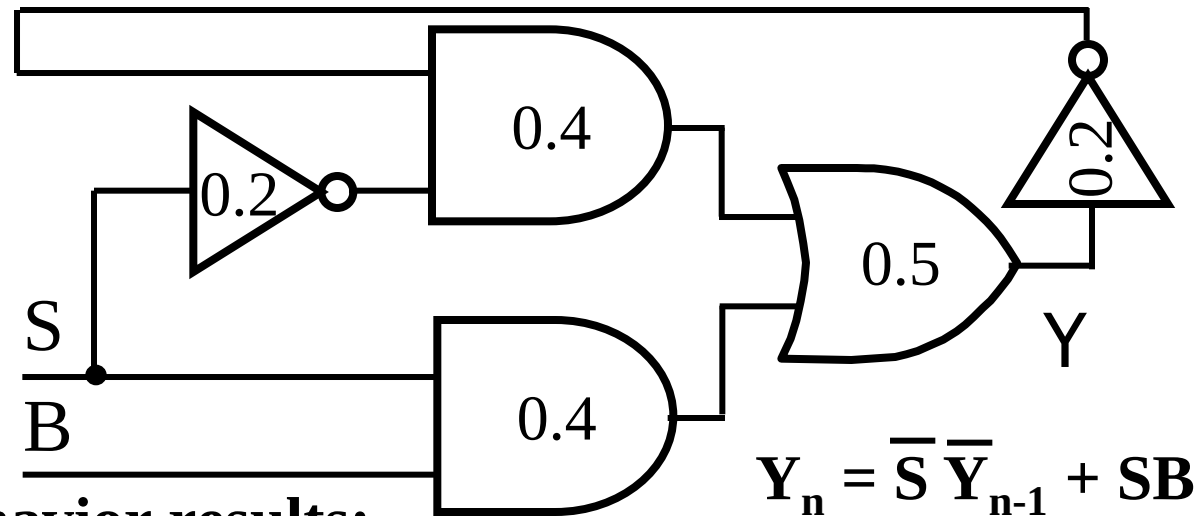


Time	B	S	Y	Comment
↓	1	0	0	Y “remembers” 0
	1	1	1	Y = B when S = 1
	1	0	1	Now Y “remembers” B = 1 for S = 0
	0	0	1	No change in Y when B changes
	0	1	0	Y = B when S = 1
	0	0	0	Y “remembers” B = 0 for S = 0
	1	0	0	No change in Y when B changes

- Y represents the state of the circuit, not just an output.

Storing State (Continued)

- Suppose we place an inverter in the “feedback path.”

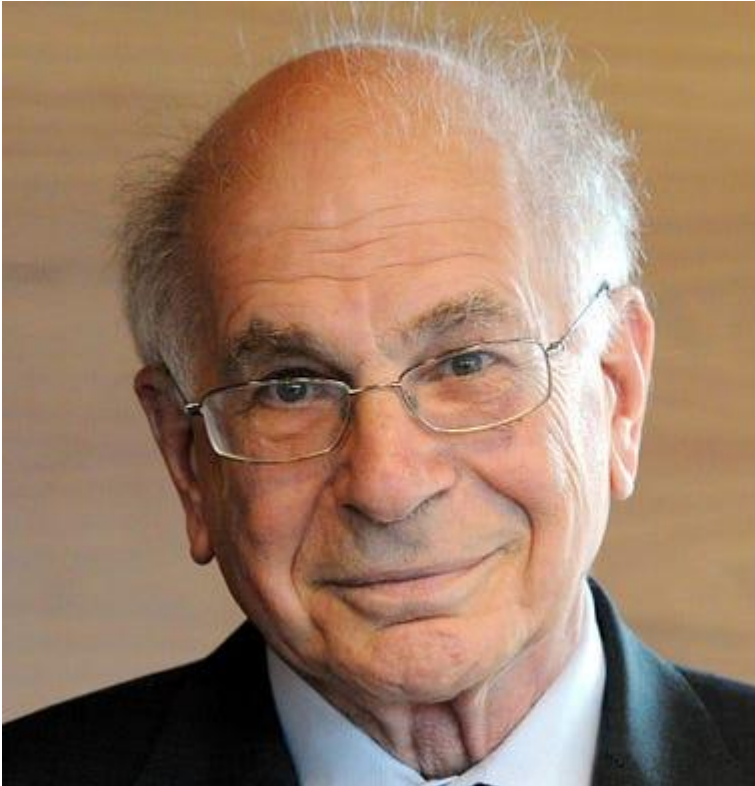


- The following behavior results:

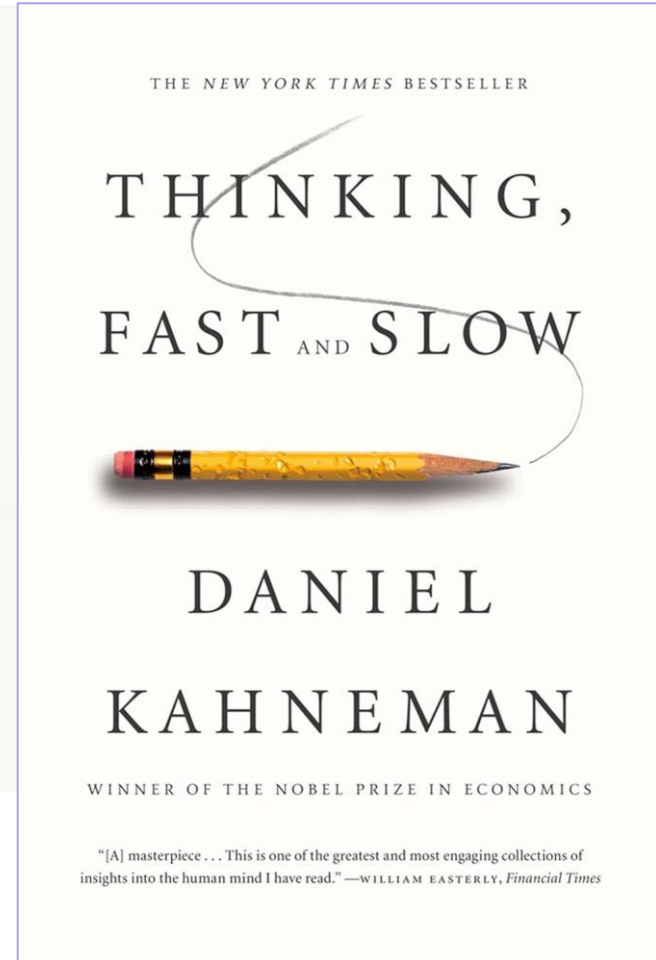
- The circuit is said to be unstable.
- For $S = 0$, the circuit has become what is called an *oscillator*. Can be used as crude clock.

B	S	Y	Comment
0	1	0	$Y = B$ when $S = 1$
1	1	1	
1	0	1	Now Y “remembers” A
1	0	0	Y, 1.1 ns later
1	0	1	Y, 1.1 ns later
1	0	0	Y, 1.1 ns later

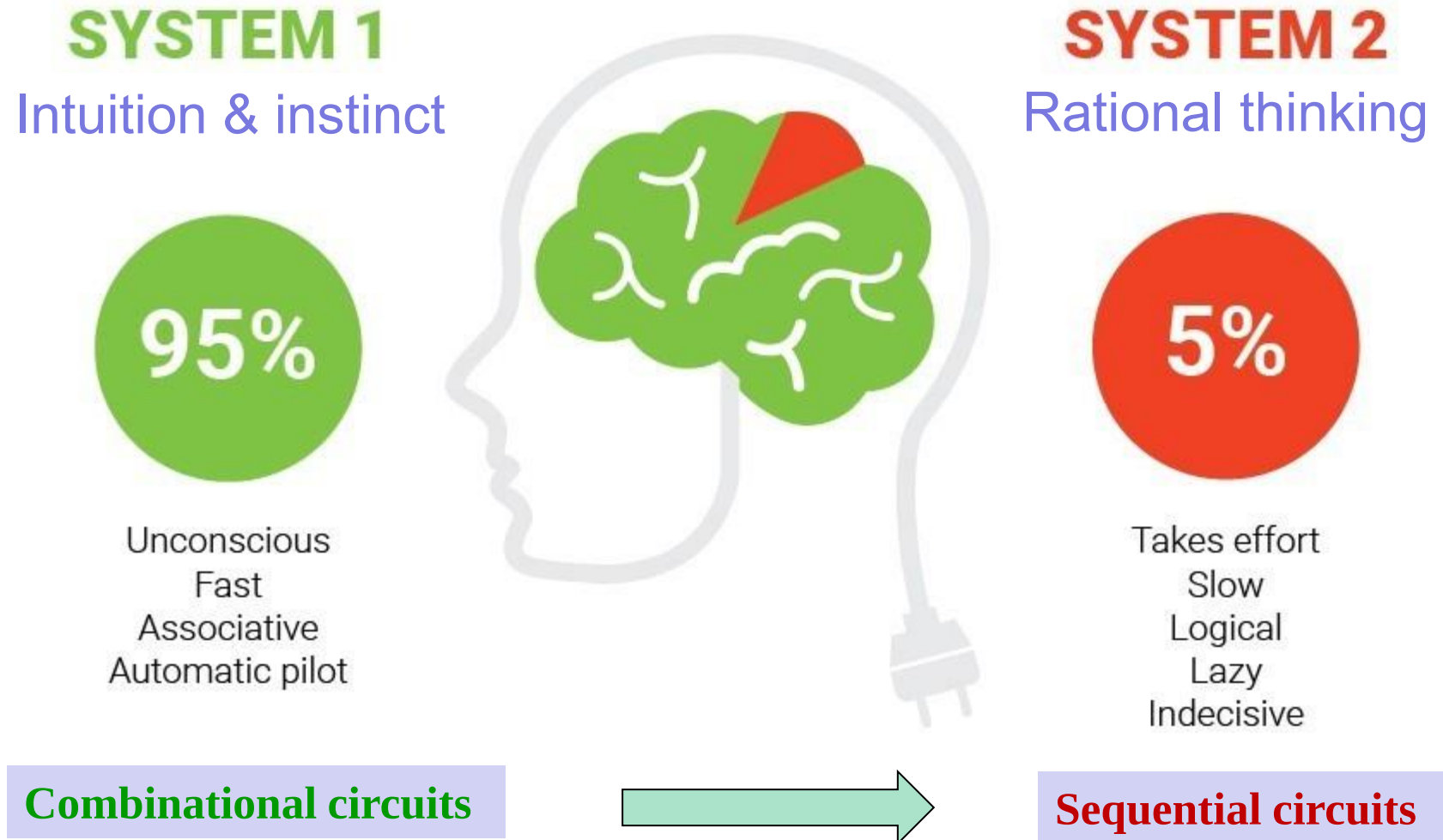
Going Beyond Combinational Logic (continued)



Daniel Kahneman
1934-2024

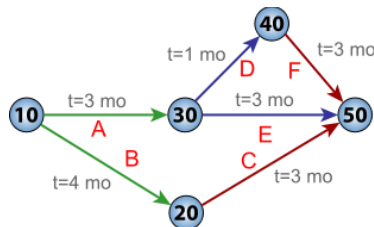
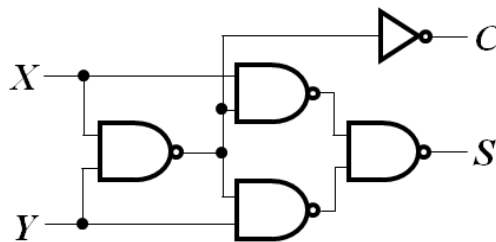


Going Beyond Combinational Logic (continued)

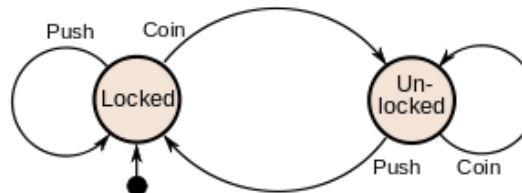
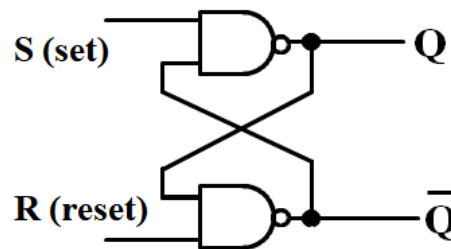


Appendix A: Going Beyond Combinational Logic (continued)

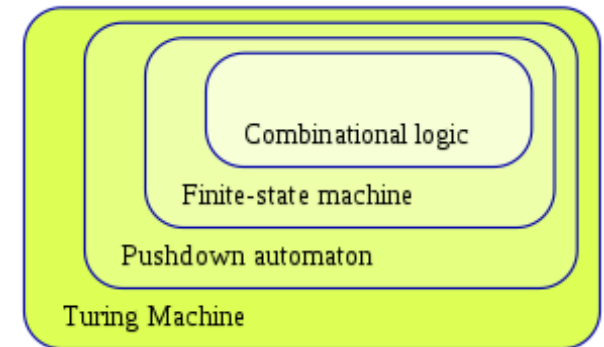
- **Automata theory** is the study of abstract machines and the computational problems.
- **Classes of automata theory:**
 - **Combinational logic** (time-independent logic) is defined as a directed acyclic graph
 - **Finite state machine** (directed graph) is introduced for modelling time-dependent logic.



Combinational circuit

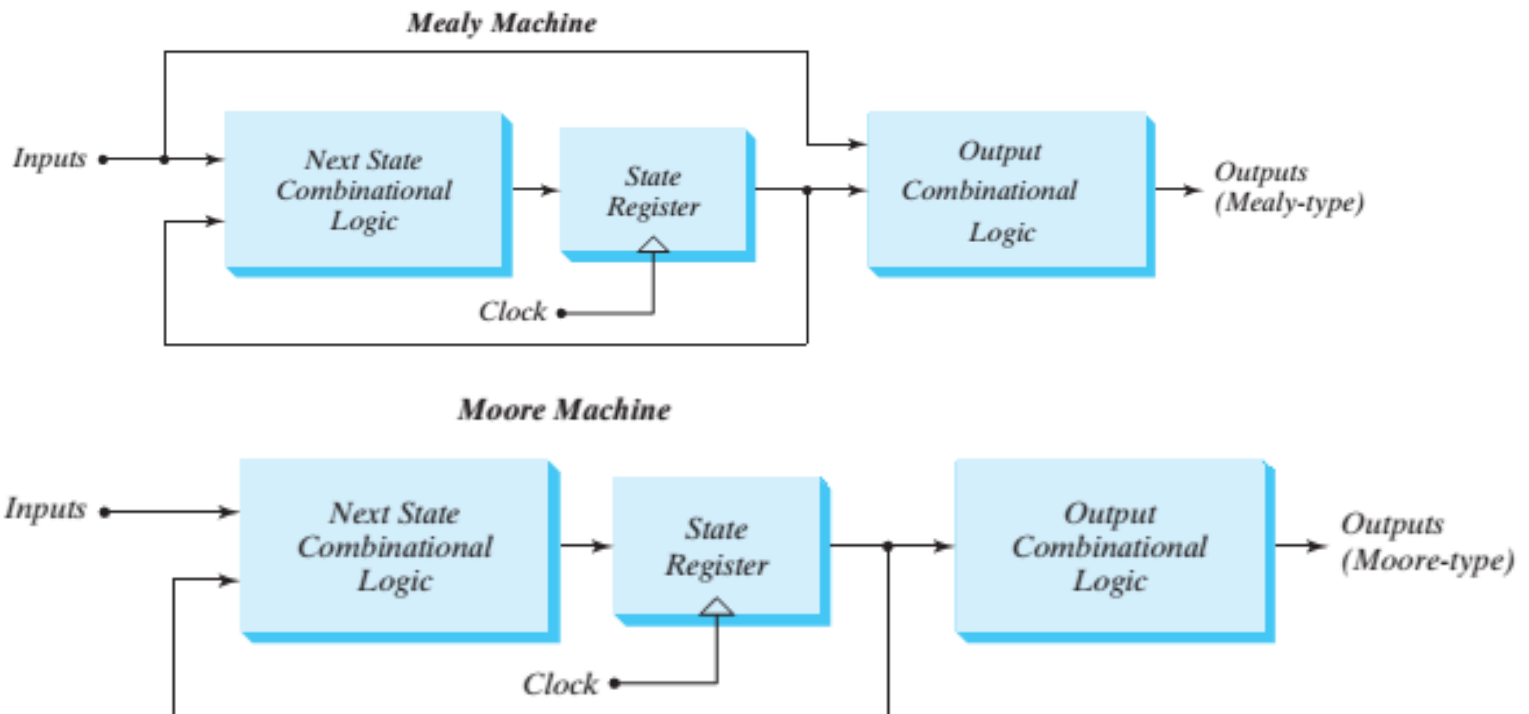


Sequential circuit



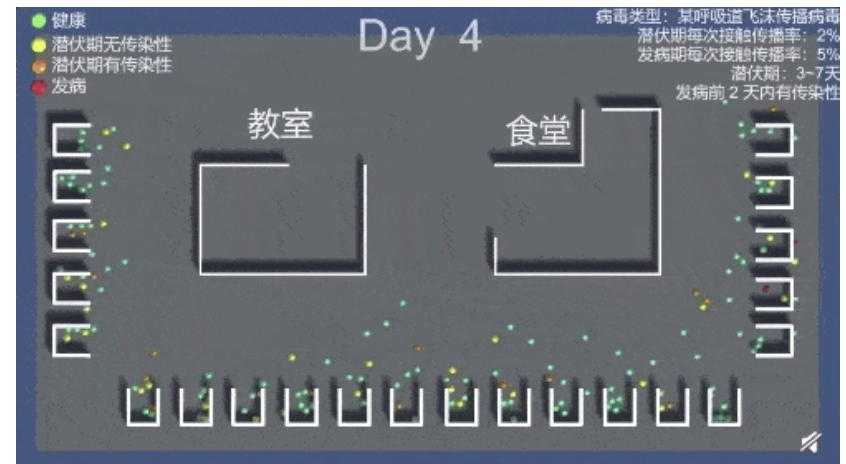
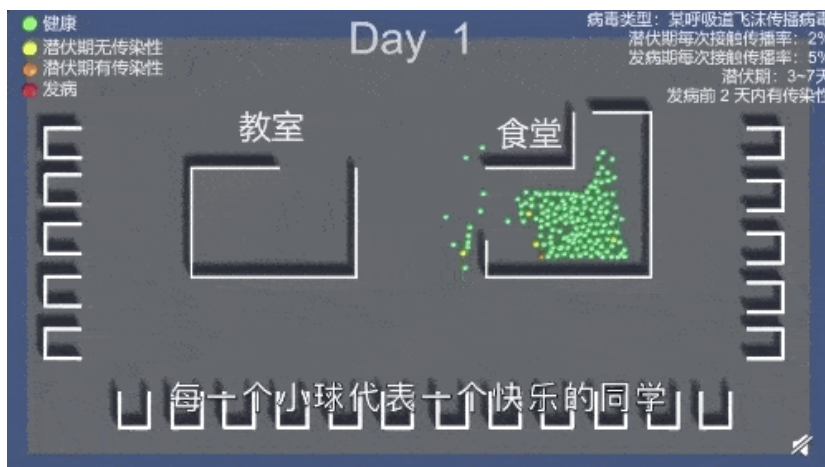
Introduction to Sequential Circuits

- **Combinatorial Logic**
 - *Next state function*: $\text{Next State} = f(\text{Inputs, State})$
 - *Output function (Mealy)*: $\text{Outputs} = g(\text{Inputs, State})$
 - *Output function (Moore)*: $\text{Outputs} = h(\text{State})$
- **Output function type depends on specification and affects the design significantly**



Discrete Event Simulation (1/2)

- In order to understand the time behavior of a sequential circuit we use discrete event simulation to analyze system dynamics.



Day 1——Day 3



Day 4——Day 10

Example: simulation of spread of COVID-19 in the campus

Discrete Event Simulation (2/2)

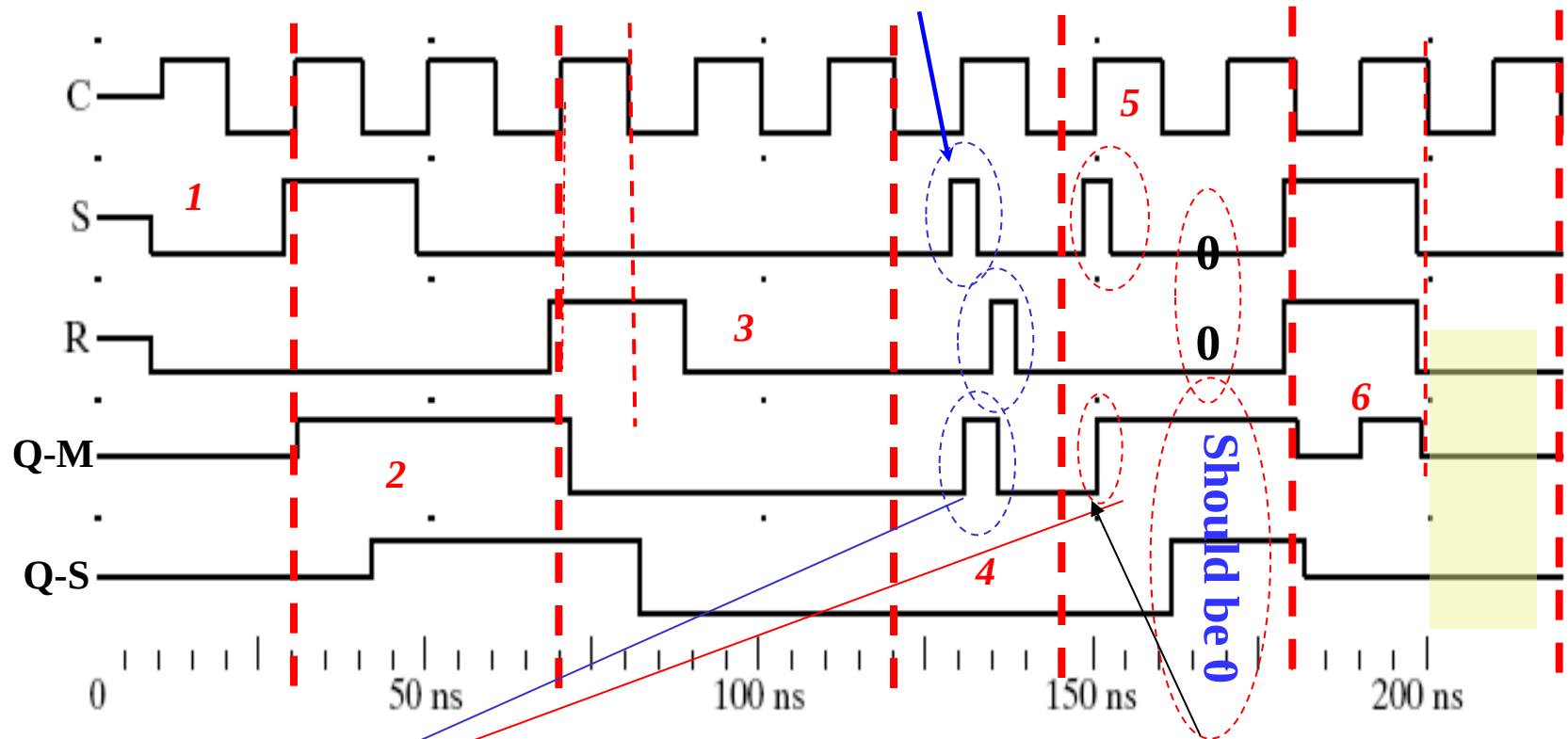


Example: Output waveform of D Flip Flop with reset input

- **Rules of simulation for digital circuits:**
 - Any **change in input values** is evaluated to see if it causes a **change in output value**
 - Gates modeled as an **ideal** circuit with a **fixed gate delay**
 - Changes in output values are scheduled for the fixed gate delay after the input change
 - At the time for a scheduled output change, the output value is changed along with any inputs it drives

S-R Master-Slave Flip-Flop Timing

0-1-0 glitch



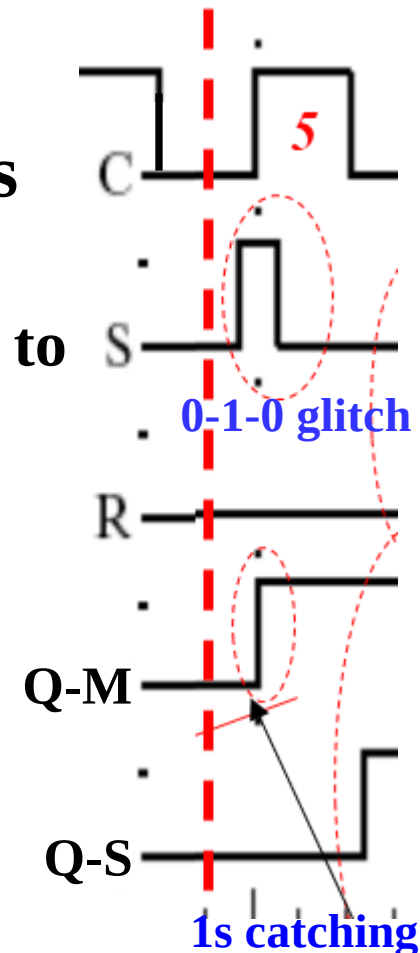
**Disposable sampling
(1s catching)**

**Before the arrival of pulse: Q=0
Before the end of the pulse:
RS=00, Q should keep "0"**

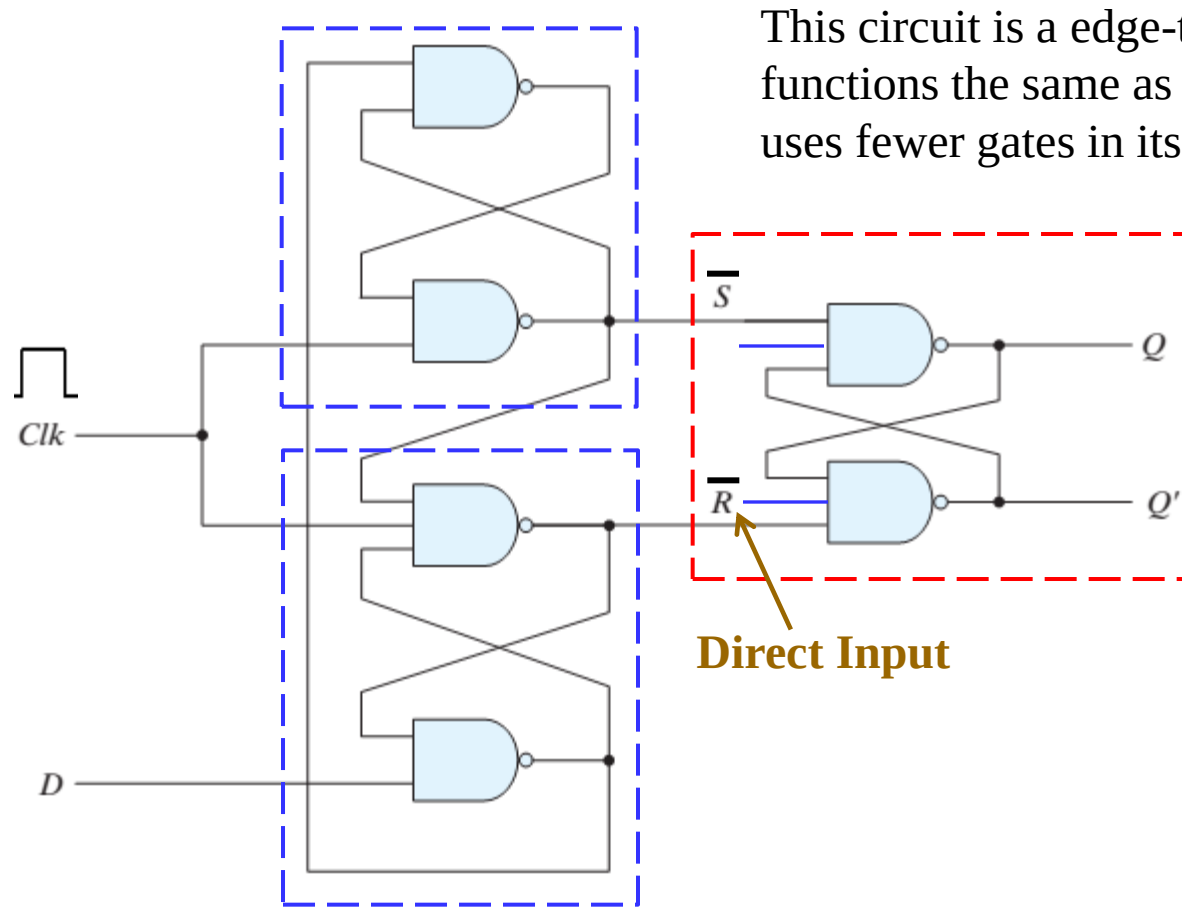
**SR=11, input state
is illegal**

S-R Master-Slave Flip-Flop Problem

- The change in the flip-flop output is delayed by the pulse width which makes the circuit slower.
- **0-1-0 glitch** on either R or S while clock is high will be “caught” by master stage:
 - Suppose $Q = 0$ and S goes to 1 and then back to 0 with R remaining at 0
 - The master latch sets to 1
 - A 1 is transferred to the slave
 - Suppose $Q = 0$ and S goes to 1 and back to 0 and R goes to 1 and back to 0
 - The master latch sets and then resets
 - A 0 is transferred to the slave
 - This behavior is called **1s catching**.



Appendix B: Simpler Implementation of Edge-Triggered D Flip-Flop



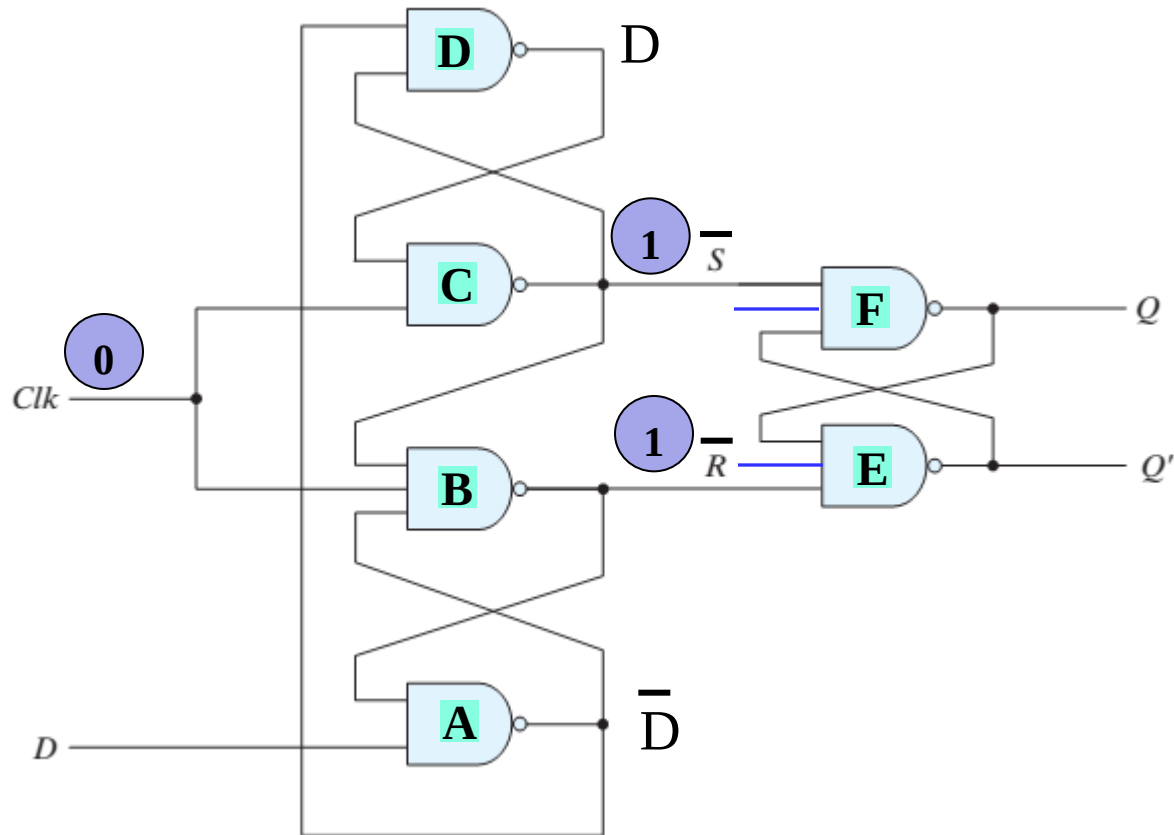
This circuit is a edge-triggered D flip-flop. It functions the same as a master-slave flip-flop, but uses fewer gates in its design.

Function Table

Asynchronous		Positive-Edge-Triggered			
$\overline{R}$	$\overline{S}$	C_p	D	Q	$\overline{Q}$
0	1	X	X	0	1
1	0	X	X	1	0
1	1	↑	0	0	1
1	1	↑	1	1	0

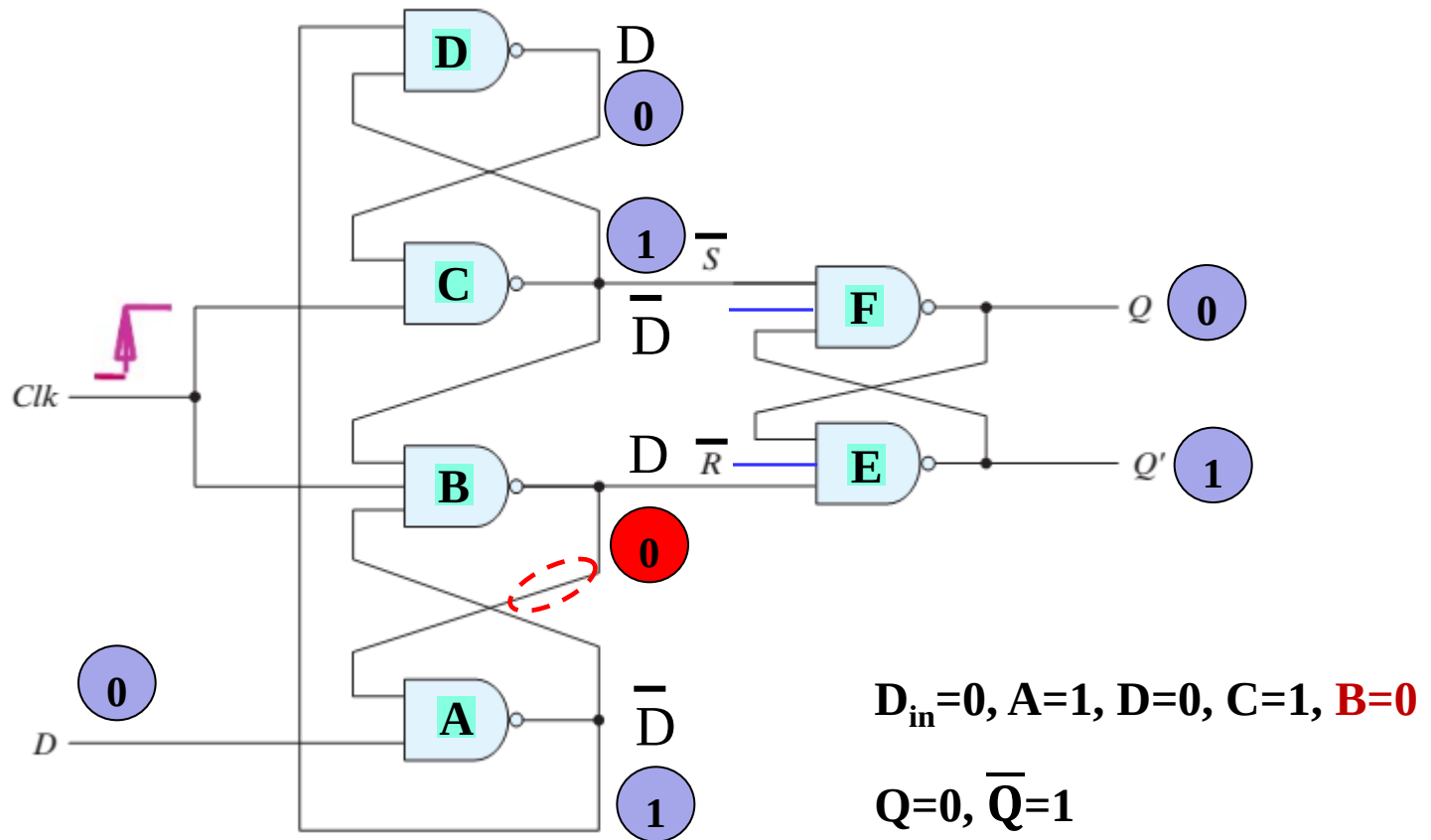
Positive-Edge Triggered D Flip-Flop

Simpler Implementation of Edge-Triggered D Flip-Flop (continued)



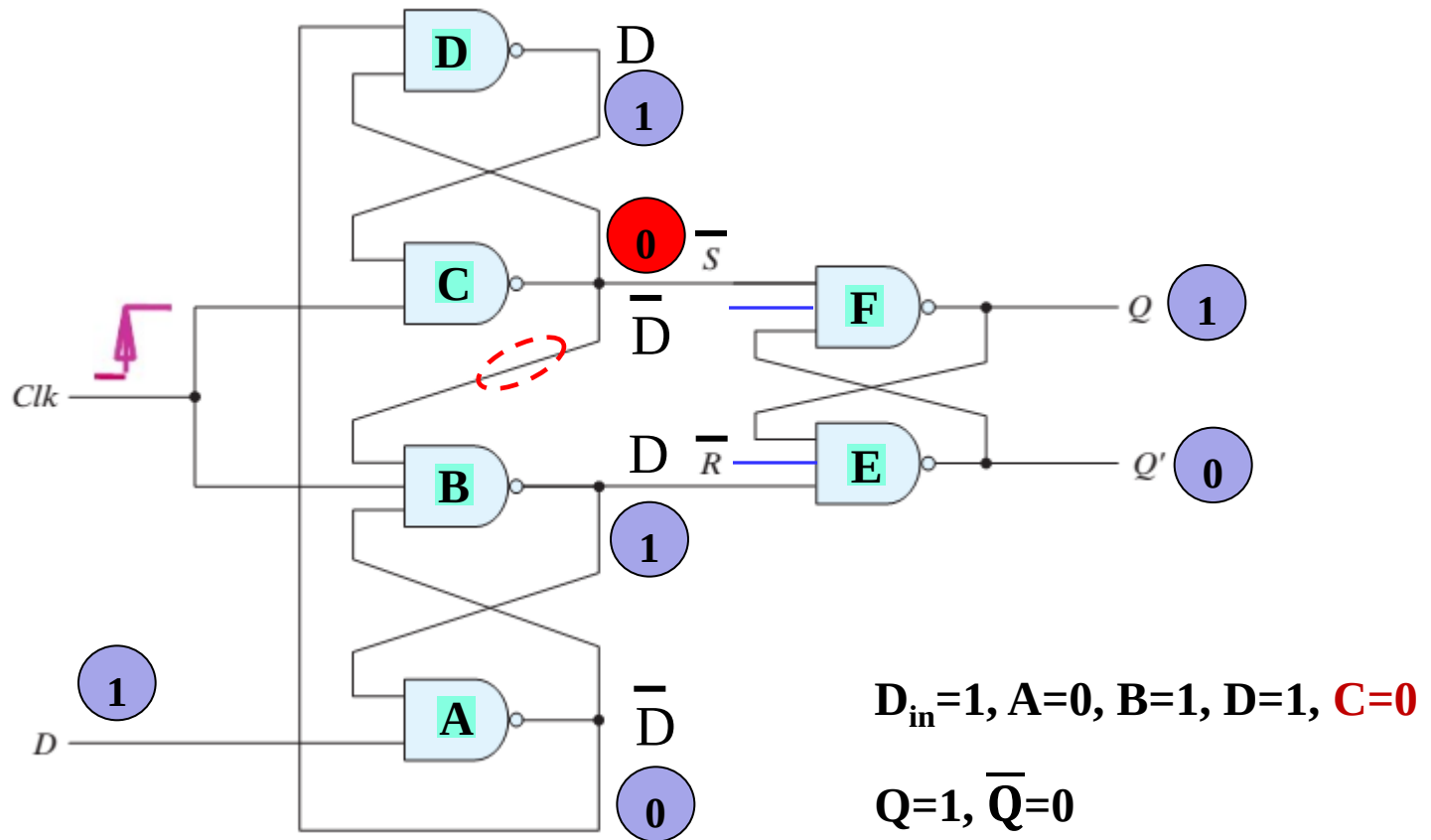
Positive-Edge Triggered D Flip-Flop

Simpler Implementation of Edge-Triggered D Flip-Flop (continued)



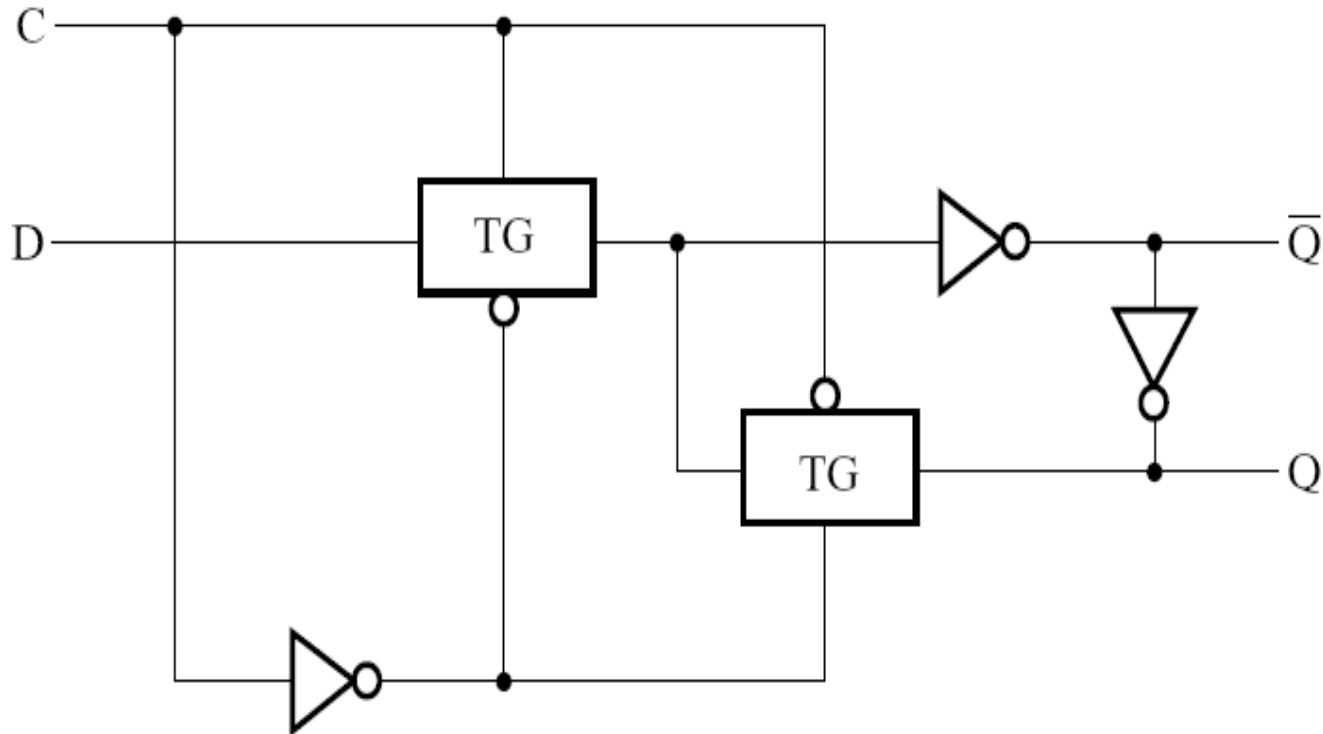
Positive-Edge Triggered D Flip-Flop

Simpler Implementation of Edge-Triggered D Flip-Flop (continued)

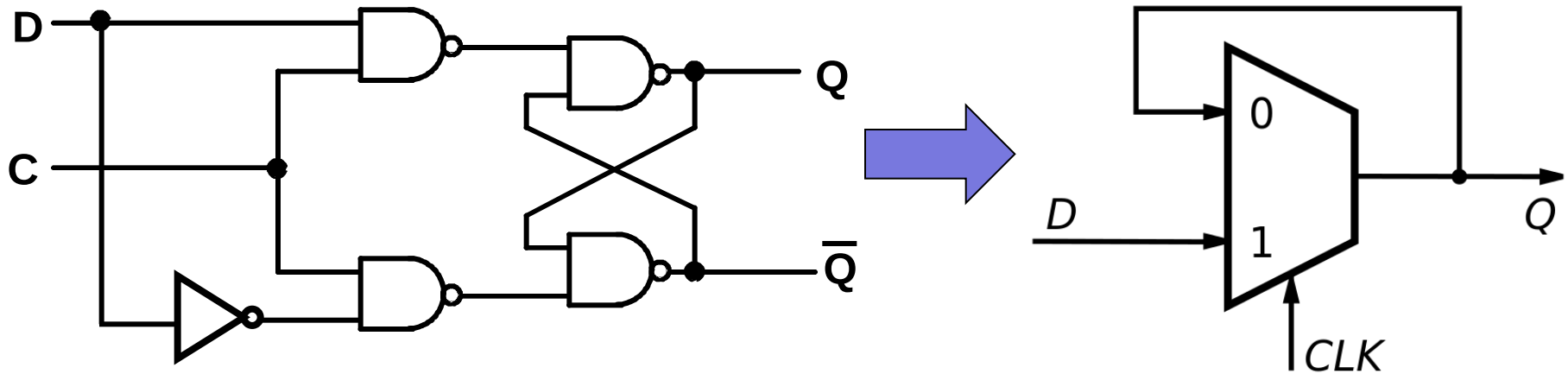


Positive-Edge Triggered D Flip-Flop

Appendix C: D Latch with Transmission Gates

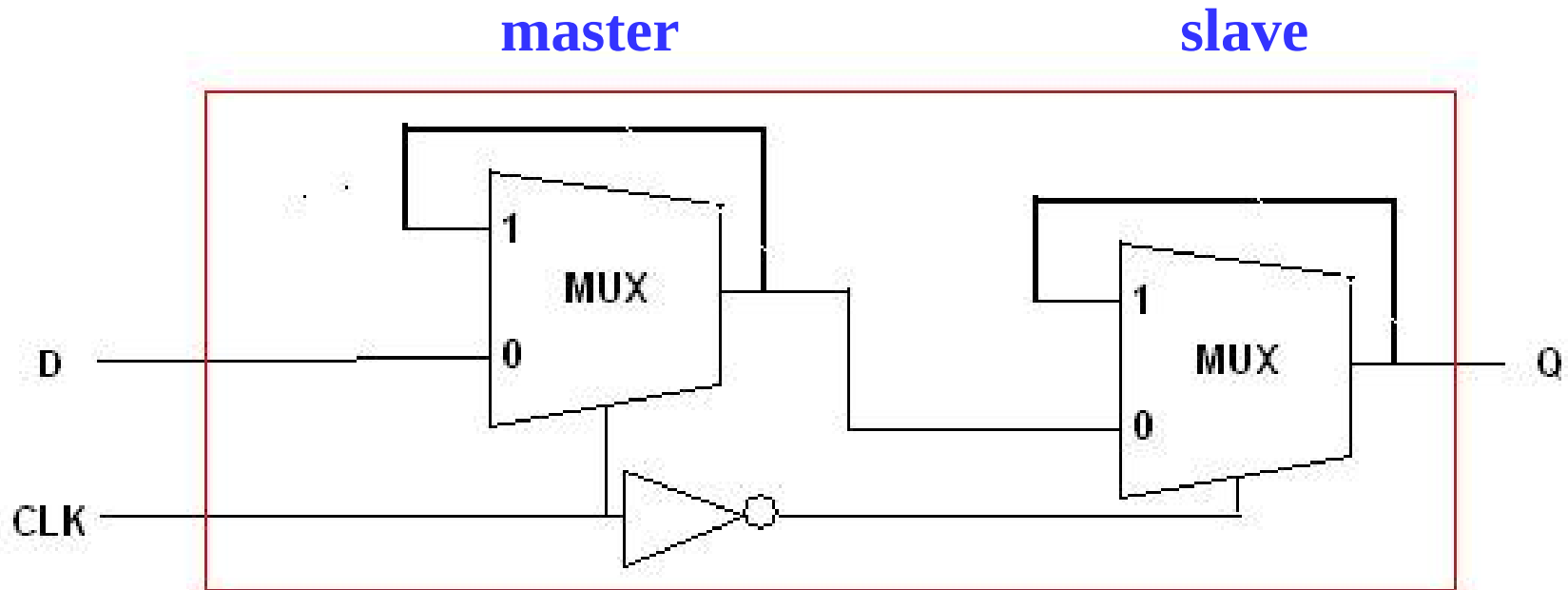


D Latch with MUX

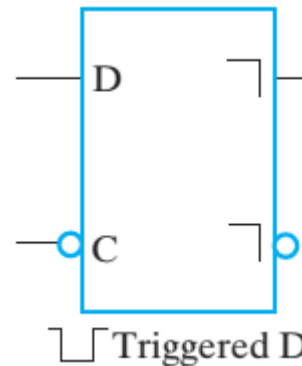


Positive level triggered D Latch

D Flip-Flop with MUXs



C	D	Q(t + 1)
0	X	No change
1	0	0: Clear Q
1	1	1: Set Q

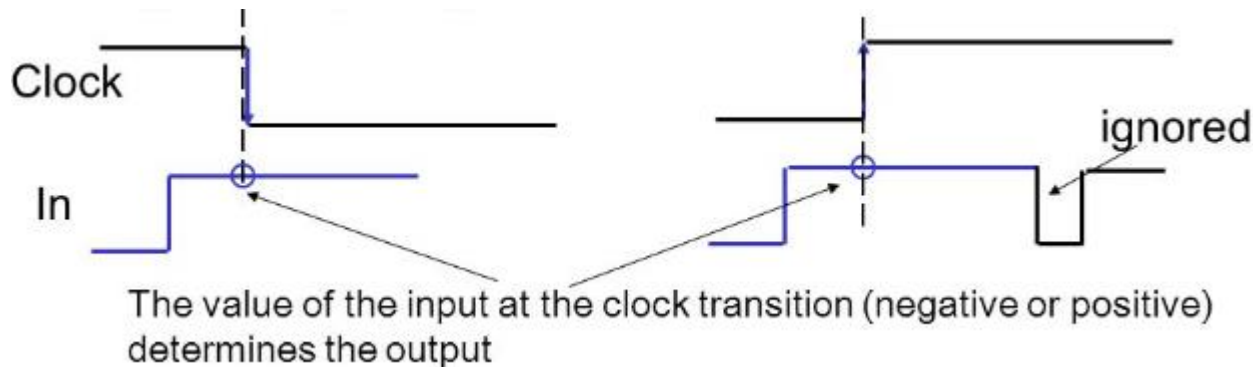


Appendix D: Summary

- **Difference between a Latch and a Flip-Flop**
 - A latch is **transparent**. Its output can change as soon as the inputs do. In a flip-flop, the path from its inputs to its outputs is broken.
 - A latch is **asynchronous**, whereas flip-flop is a combination of a clock and a latch, and its output is changed according to the clock.
 - Latch is a **level sensitive** device while flip-flop is an **edge sensitive** device.
 - Latch is sensitive to **glitches** on enable pin, whereas flip-flop is immune to glitches.
 - Latches take **less gates** (also less power) to implement than flip-flops.
 - Latches are **faster** than flip-flops.

Summary (continued)

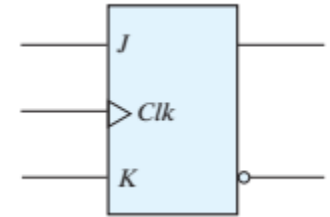
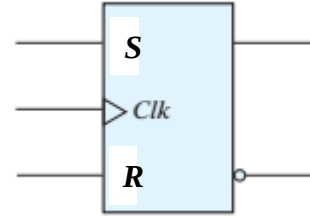
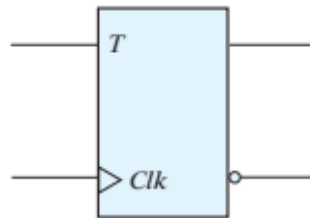
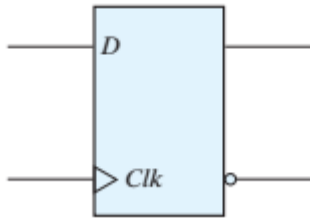
- Master-slave FFs use **alternating clocks** to break the path from input to output.
- The behavior of “catching” **glitches** (0-1-0/1-0-1) by master stage is called **1s catching**.
- Solutions for solving 1s catching problem:
 - **D master-slave FFs** and **edge-triggered FFs**
- An **edge-triggered** flip-flop responds to its input at a well-defined moment (at the **clock-transition**).



Summary (continued)

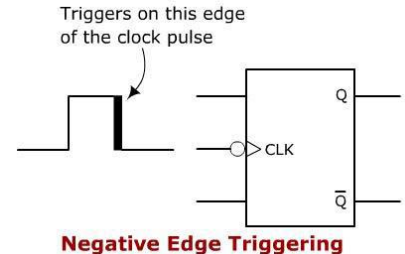
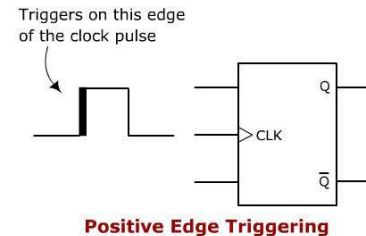
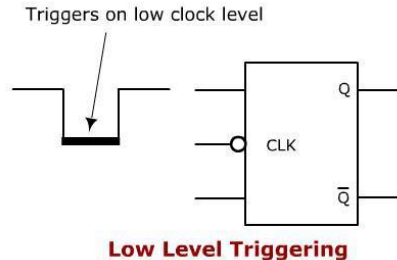
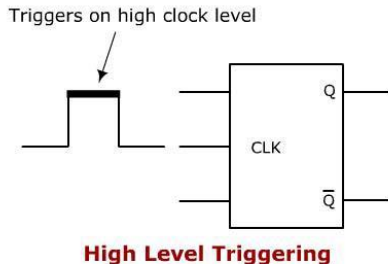
■ Four types of latches and flip-flops:

- D-type (Data or Delay)
- T-type (Toggle)
- SR-type (S-Set, R-Reset)
- JK-type (J-Set, K-Reset)



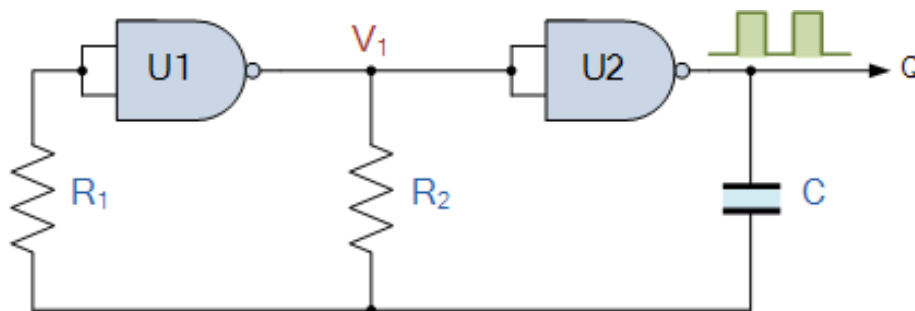
■ Four types of **pulse-triggering** methods:

- High Level Triggering
- Low Level Triggering
- Positive Edge Triggering
- Negative Edge Triggering

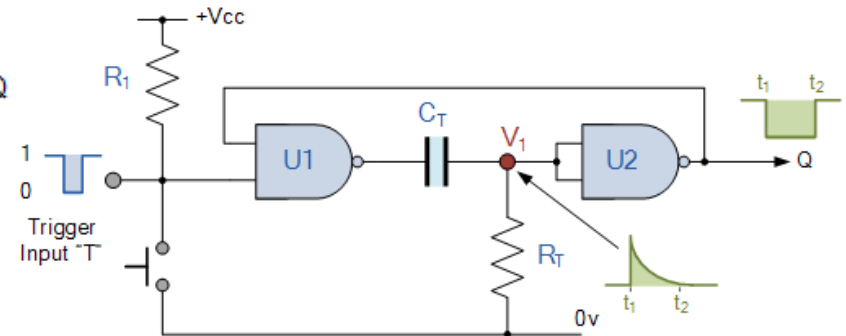


Summary (continued)

- Both latch and flip-flop are a kind of **multivibrators** that operate between two states (0, 1).
- Three multivibrator types
 - **Astable** multivibrator has **NO stable** states.
 - **Monostable** multivibrator has only **ONE stable** state. By default it will stay in the stable state, but when triggered it will switch to unstable state (quasi-stable state)
 - **Bistable** multivibrator has **TWO stable** states.



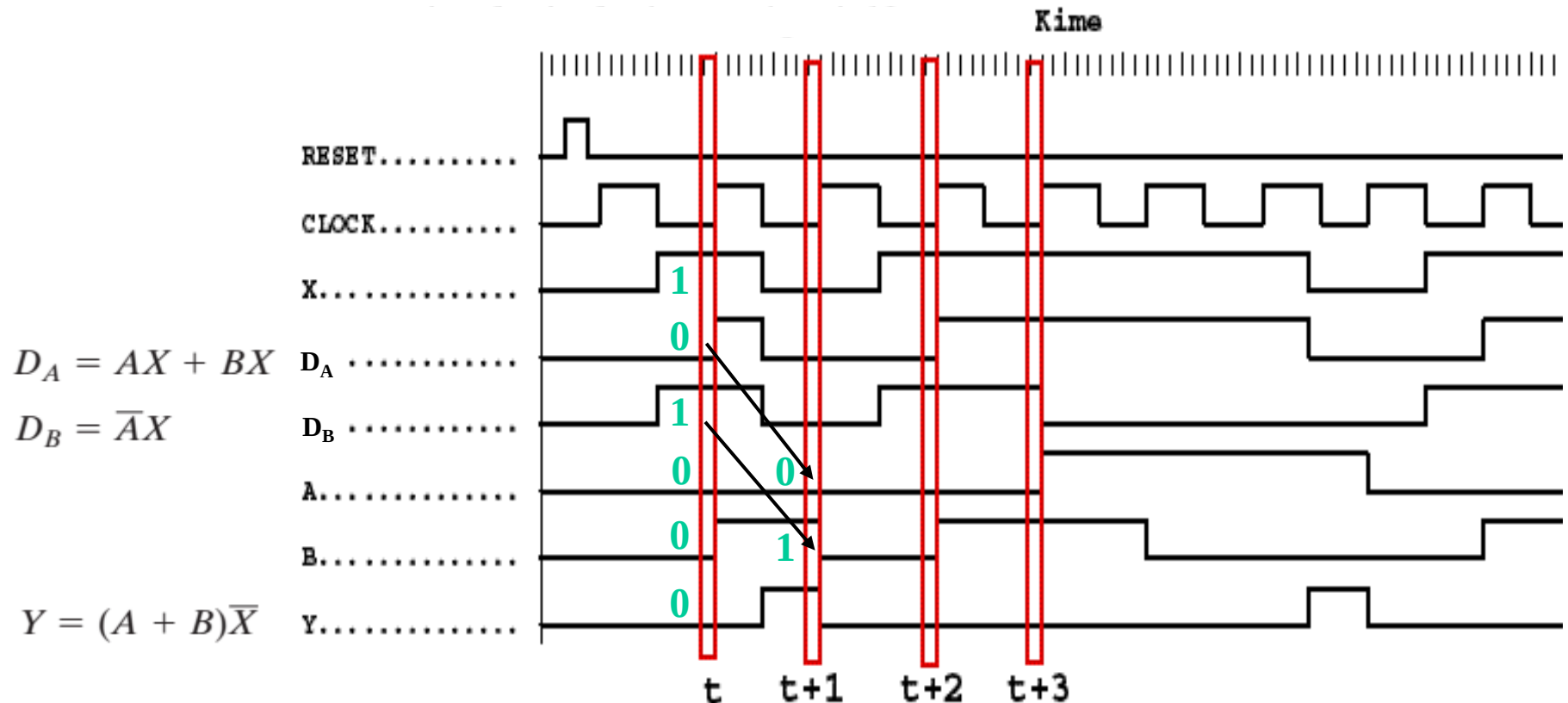
Astable multivibrator



Monostable multivibrator

Example 1 (from Fig. 4-13) (continued)

- Where in time are inputs, outputs and states defined?

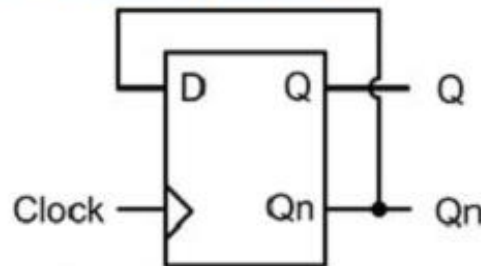


Appendix E: Circuits Based on Sequential Circuit

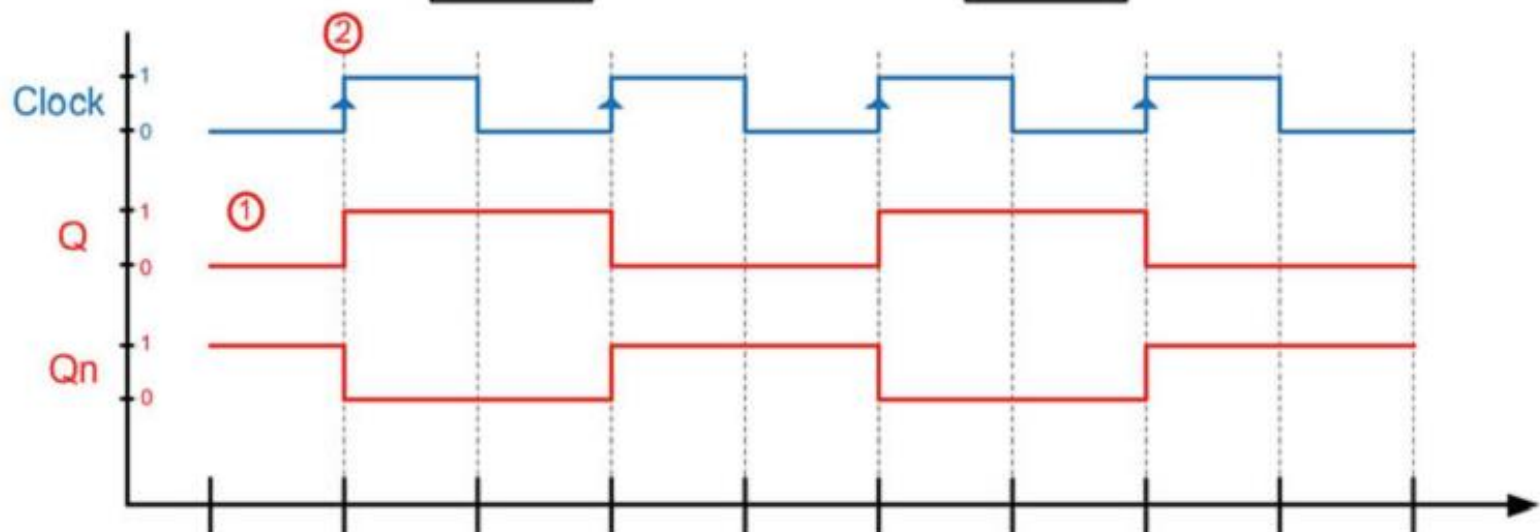
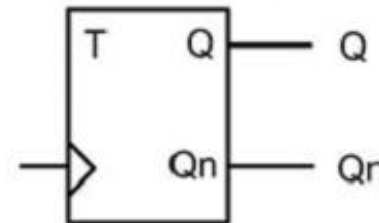
■ Clock Divider

- A D Flip-Flop is configured with its Qn output wired back to its D, which produces outputs with **half the frequency of the incoming clock**.

Toggle Flop Clock Frequency Divider



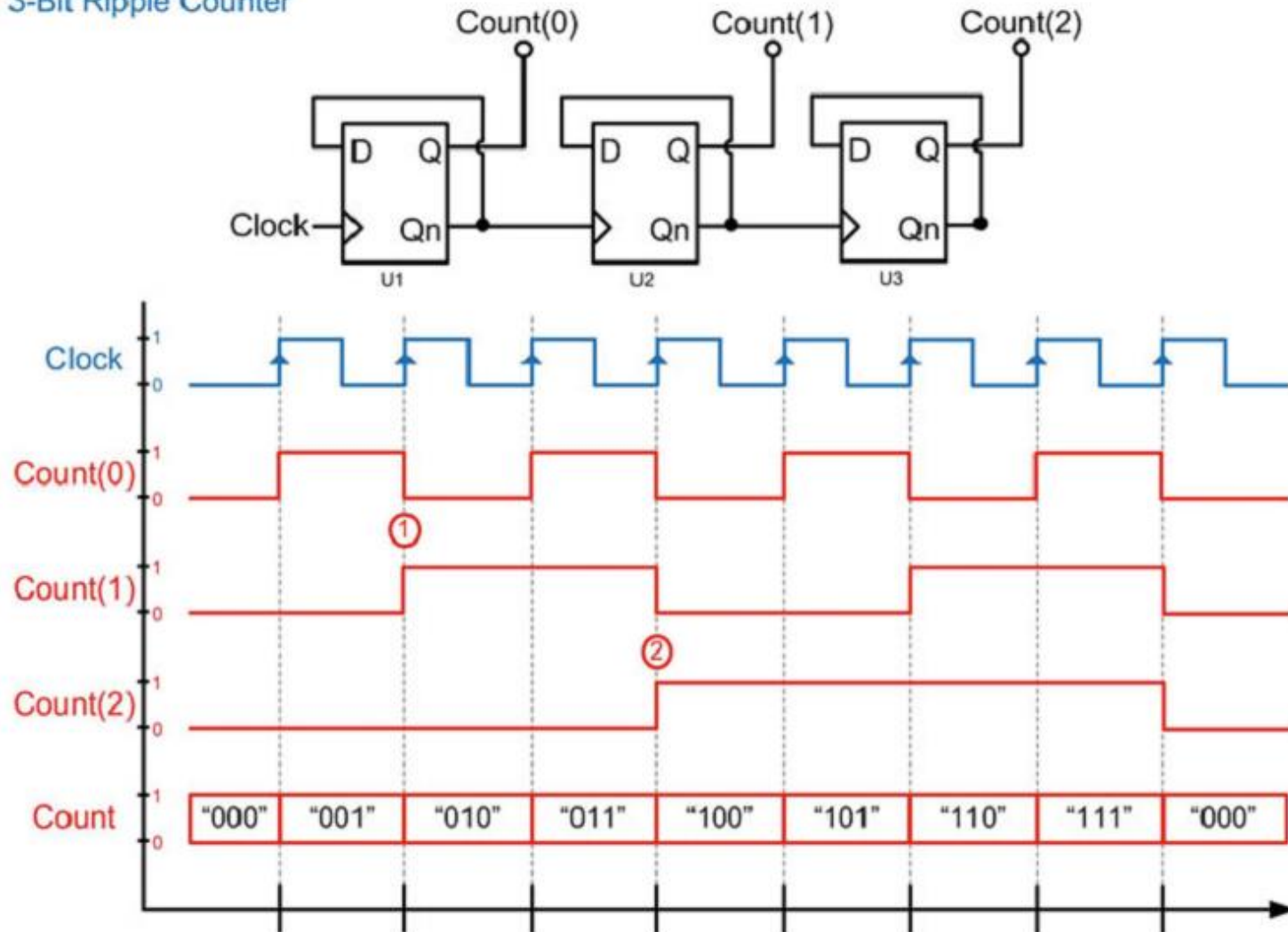
Optional Symbol for a Toggle-Flop or "T-Flip-Flop"



Circuits Based on Sequential Circuit (continued)

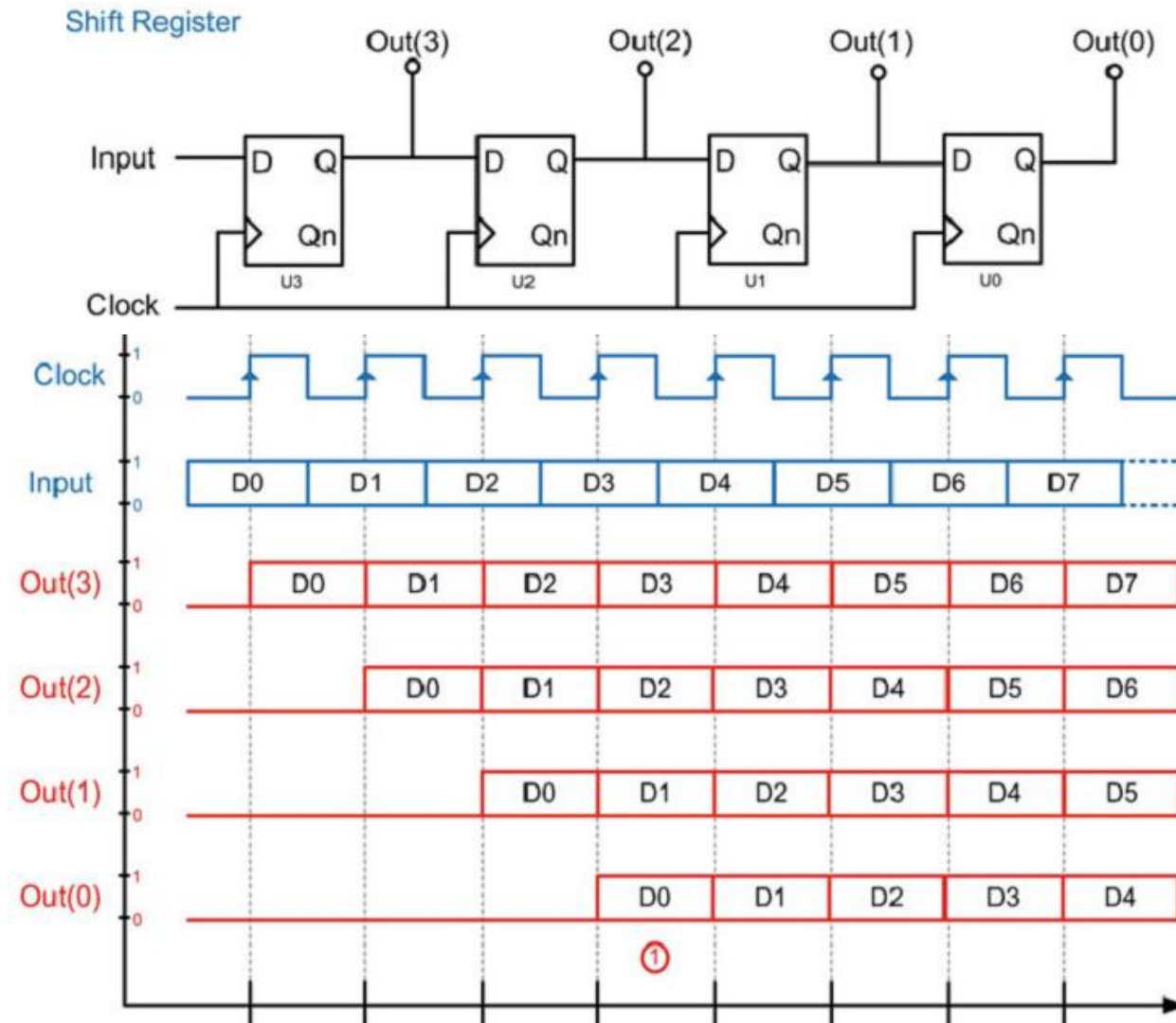
- **Ripple Counter (行波计数器)**

3-Bit Ripple Counter



Circuits Based on Sequential Circuit (continued)

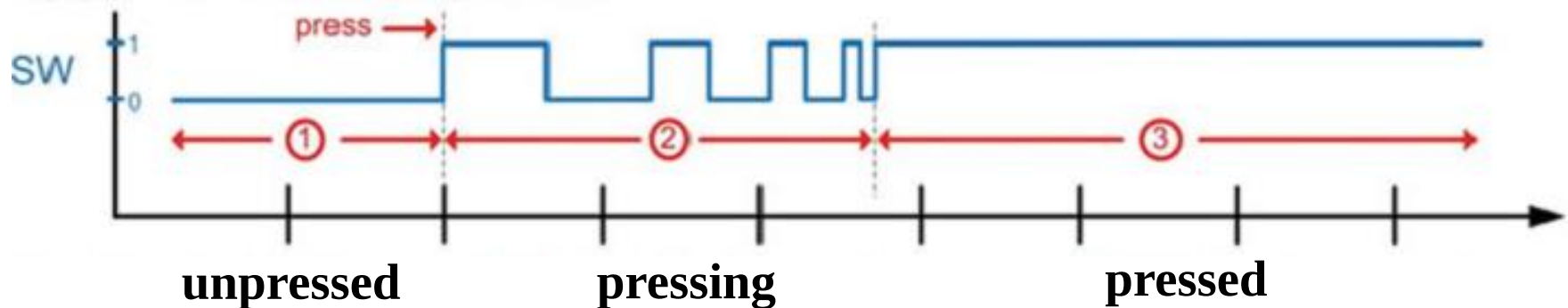
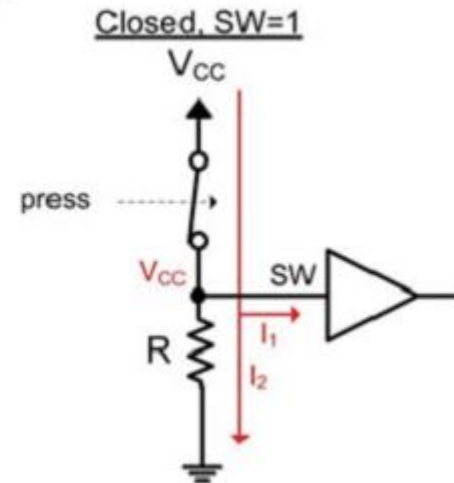
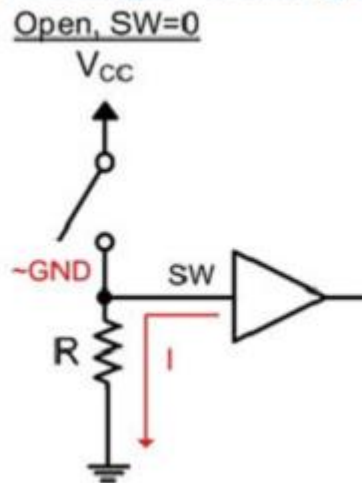
- Shift Registers



Circuits Based on Sequential Circuit (continued)

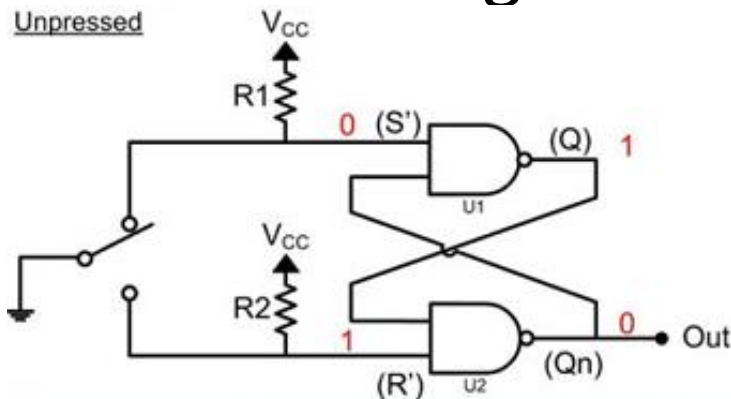
- **Switch Debouncing**

Switch Bouncing in a Single Pole, Single Throw Switch



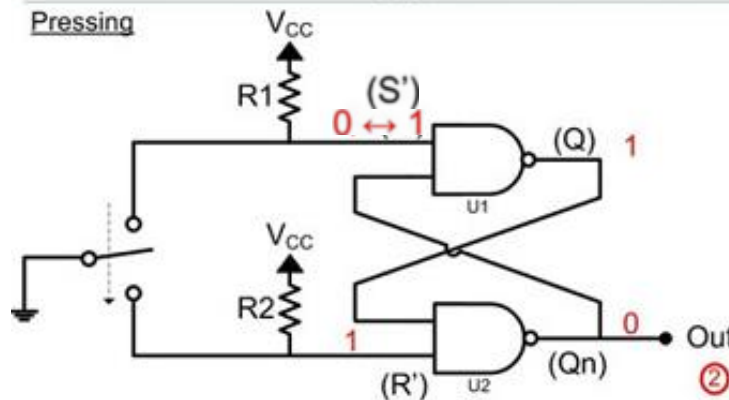
Circuits Based on Sequential Circuit (continued)

■ Switch Debouncing



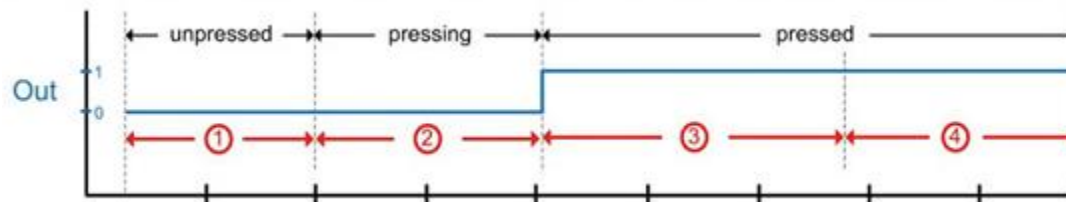
S'	R'	Q	Out Qn
0	0	1	1
0	1	1	0
1	0	0	1
1	1	Last Q	Last Qn

- ① The switch connects S' to GND and R2 pulls R' to V_{CC}, thus creating a solid Out=0.

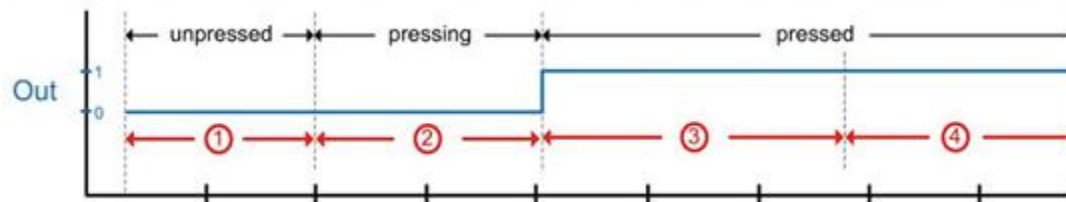
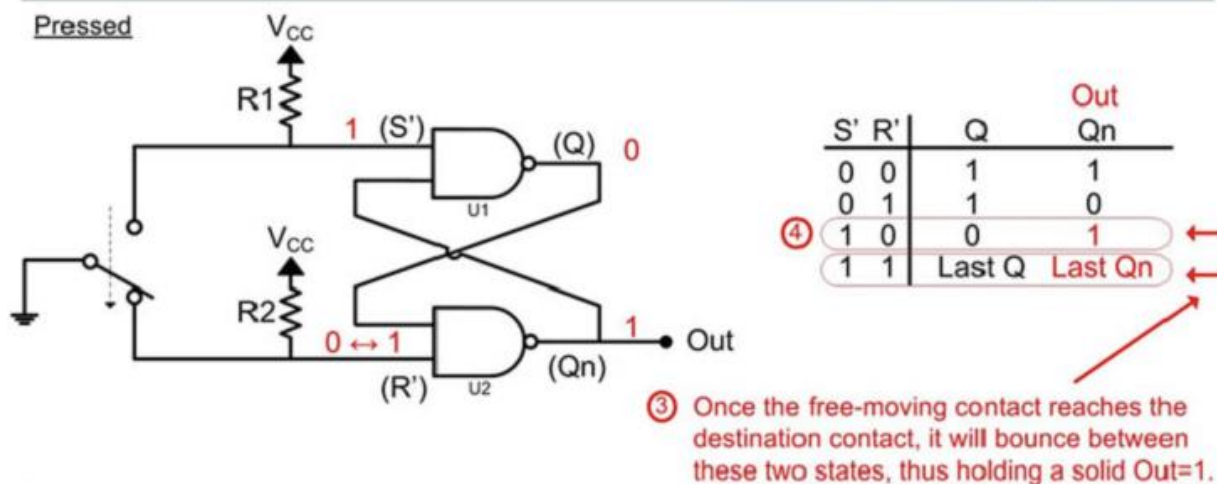
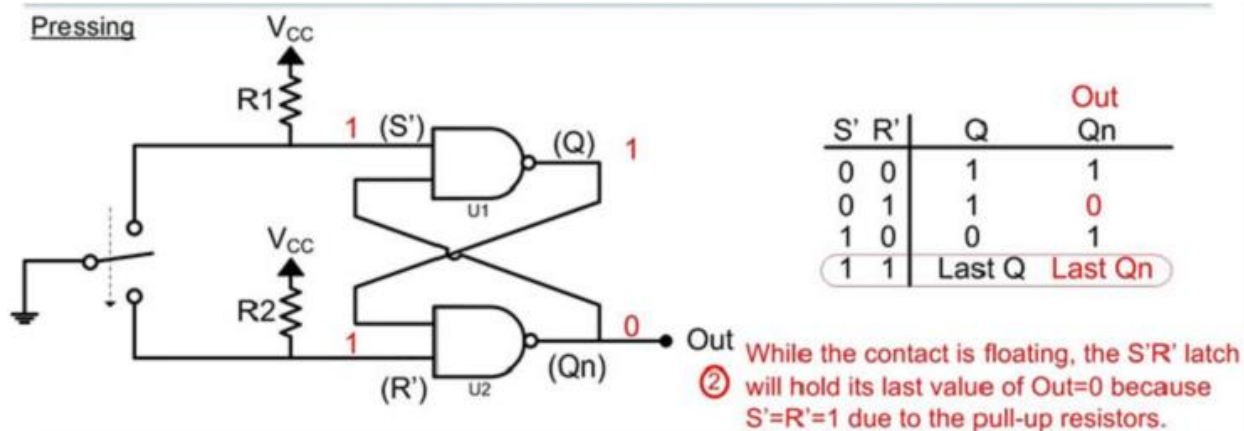


S'	R'	Q	Out Qn
0	0	1	1
0	1	1	0
1	0	0	1
1	1	Last Q	Last Qn

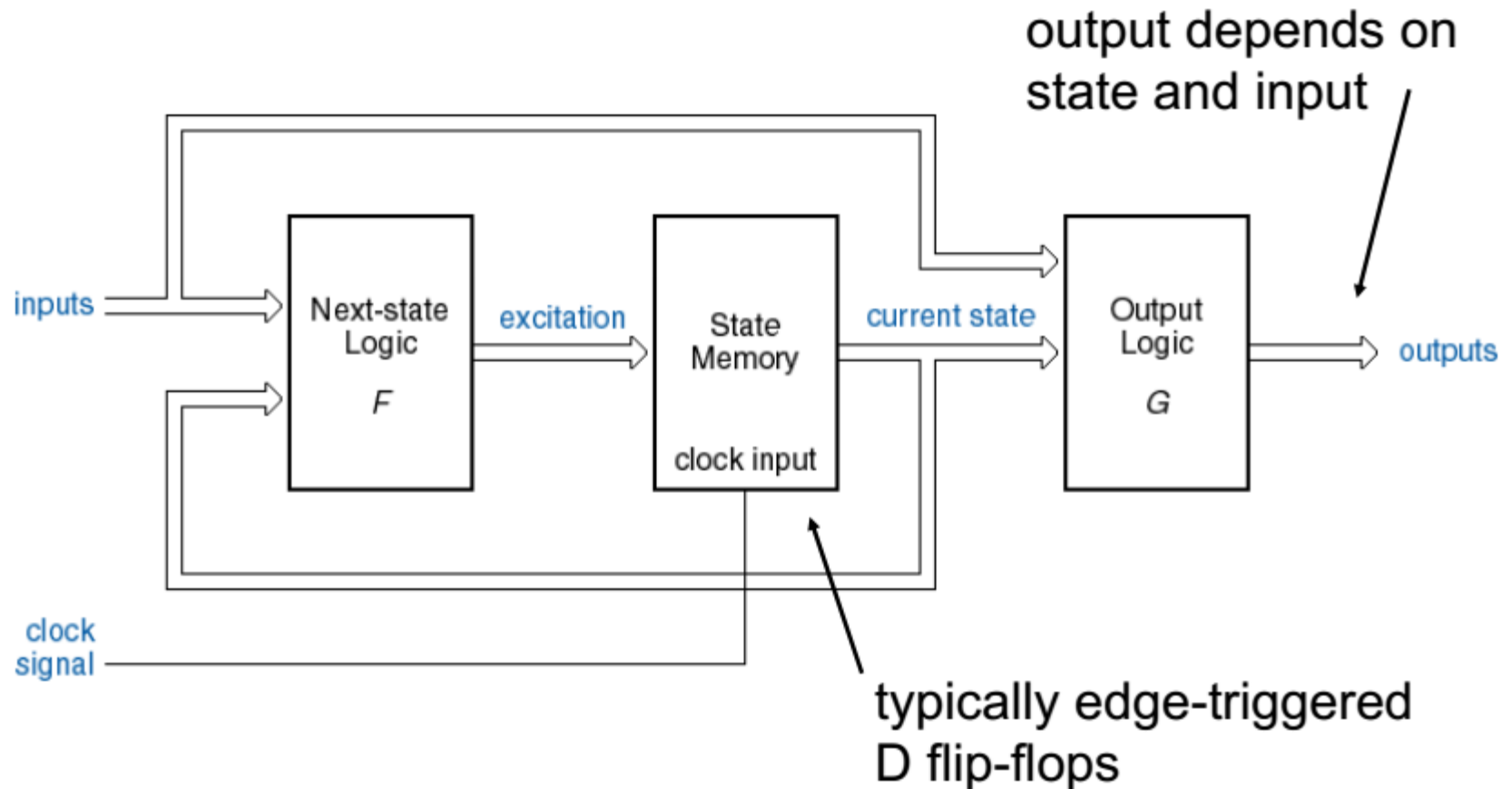
- ② While the contact is floating, the S'R' latch will hold its last value of Out=0 because S'=R'=1 due to the pull-up resistors.



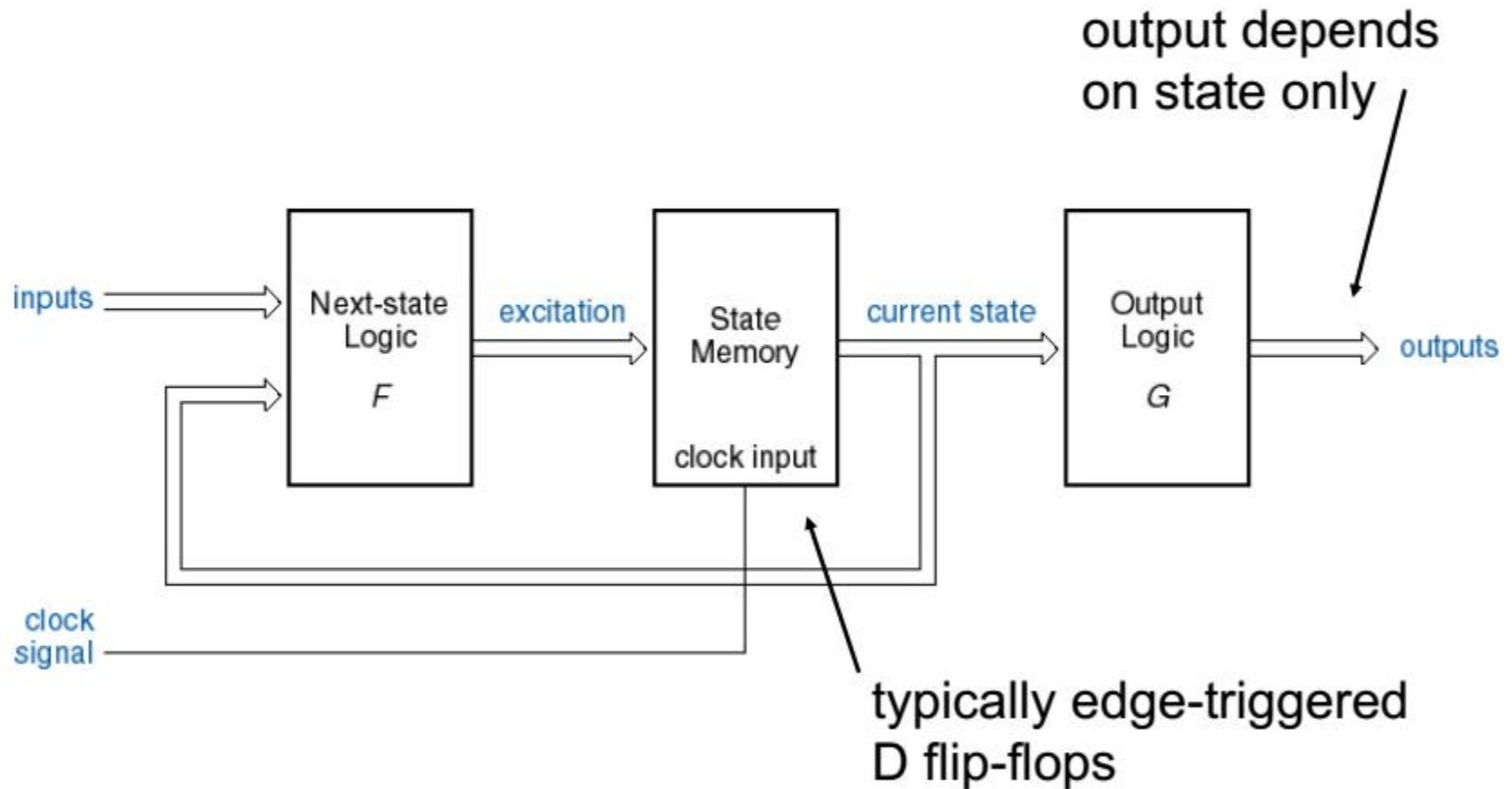
Circuits Based on Sequential Circuit (continued)



Appendix F: State Machine Structure (Mealy)



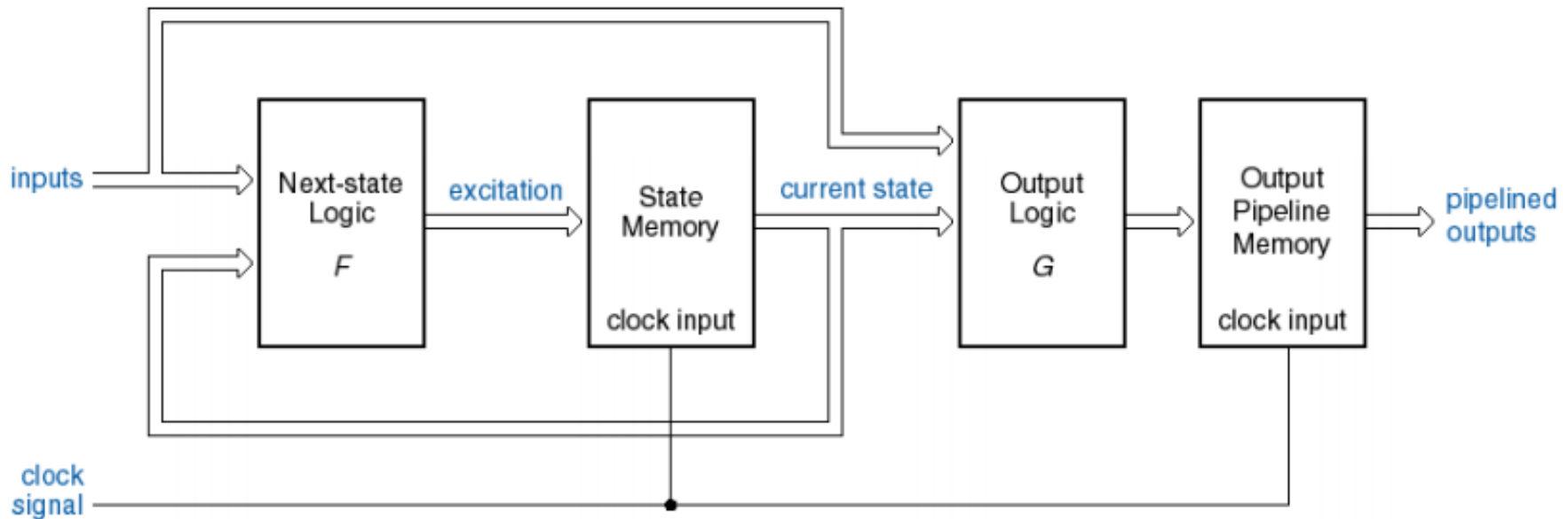
State Machine Structure (Moore)



When designing **high-speed circuit**, state variable can be used directly by the output pipeline, which means the **output and the clock can be synchronized**.

State Machine Structure (pipelined)

- Structure of State Machine in **pipeline**---- Mealy Model

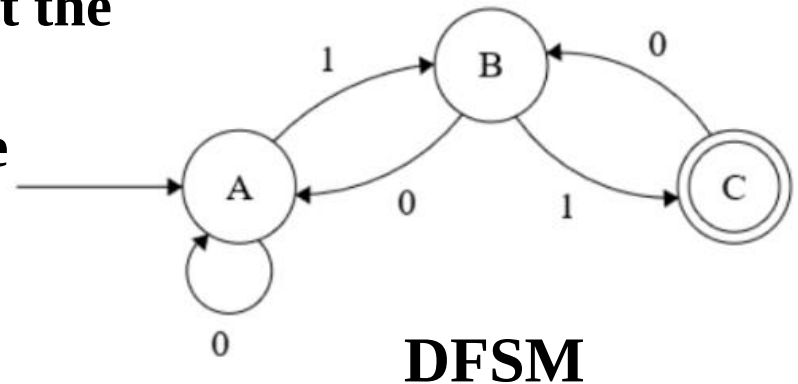


When designing high-speed circuit, the output of state machine and the clock always need to be completely synchronized. One solution is to just use state variable as output signal.

DFSM and NFSM

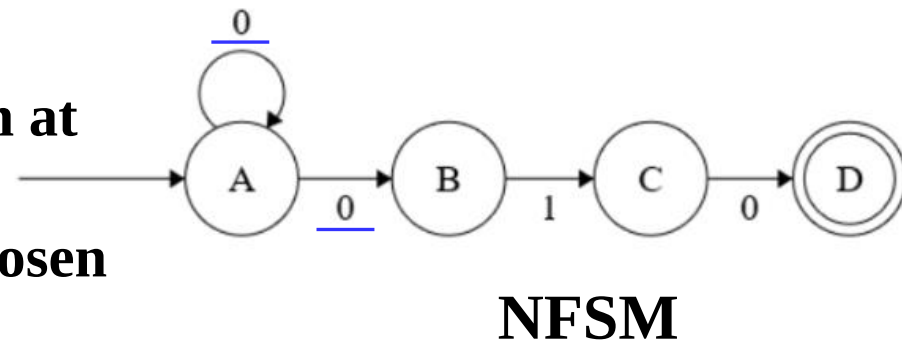
■ *Deterministic Finite State Machines (DFSM)*

- Given the current we know what the next state will be
- It has only one unique next state
- It has no choices or randomness



■ *Non-deterministic Finite State Machine (NFSM)*

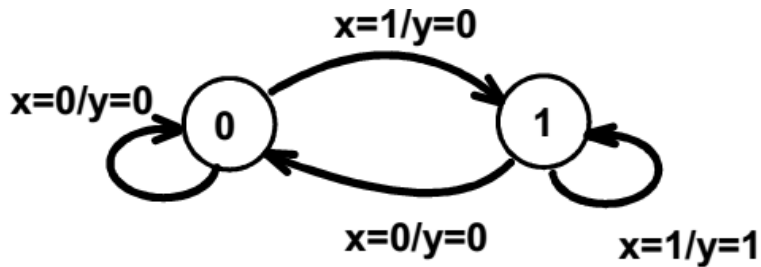
- Given the current there could be multiple next states
- The next state may be chosen at random
- All the next states may be chosen in parallel



Mealy and Moore models are two types of DFSM models.

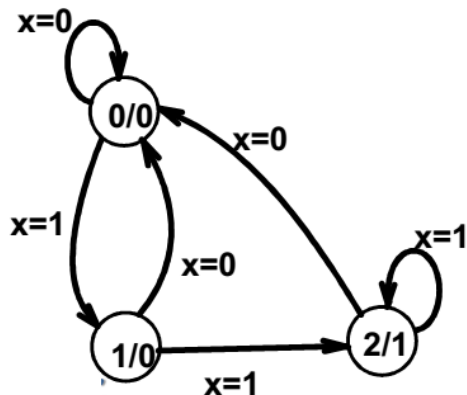
Moore and Mealy Example Tables

- Mealy Model state table **maps inputs and states to outputs**



Present State	Next State		Output	
	x=0	x=1	x=0	x=1
0	0	1	0	0
1	0	1	0	1

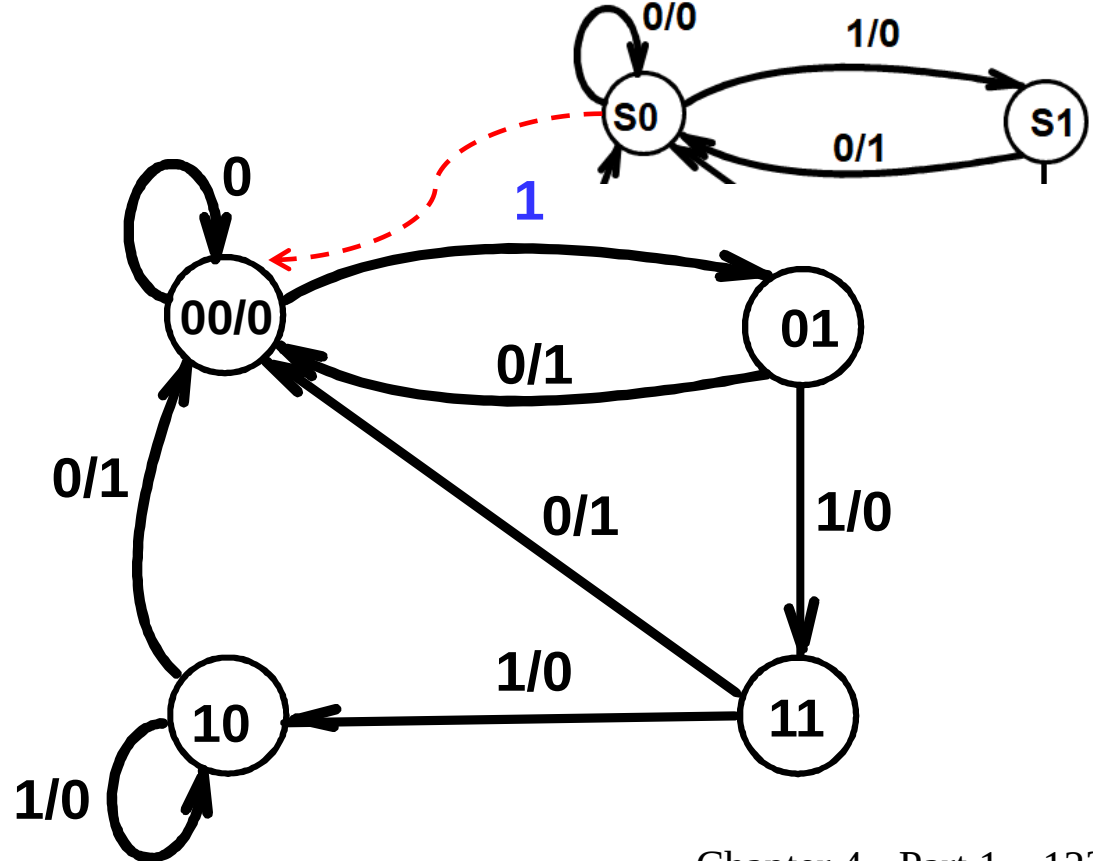
- Moore Model state table **maps states to outputs**



Present State	Next State		Output
	x=0	x=1	
0	0	1	0
1	0	2	0
2	0	2	1

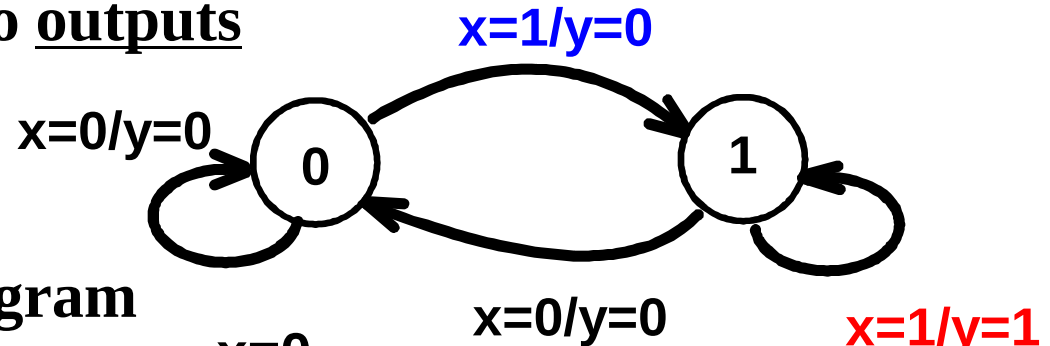
Mixed Moore and Mealy Outputs

- In real designs, **some outputs may be Moore type and other outputs may be Mealy type.**
- **Example: Figure 4-15(a) can be modified to illustrate this**
 - State 00: Moore
 - States 01, 10, and 11: Mealy
- **Simplifies output specification**

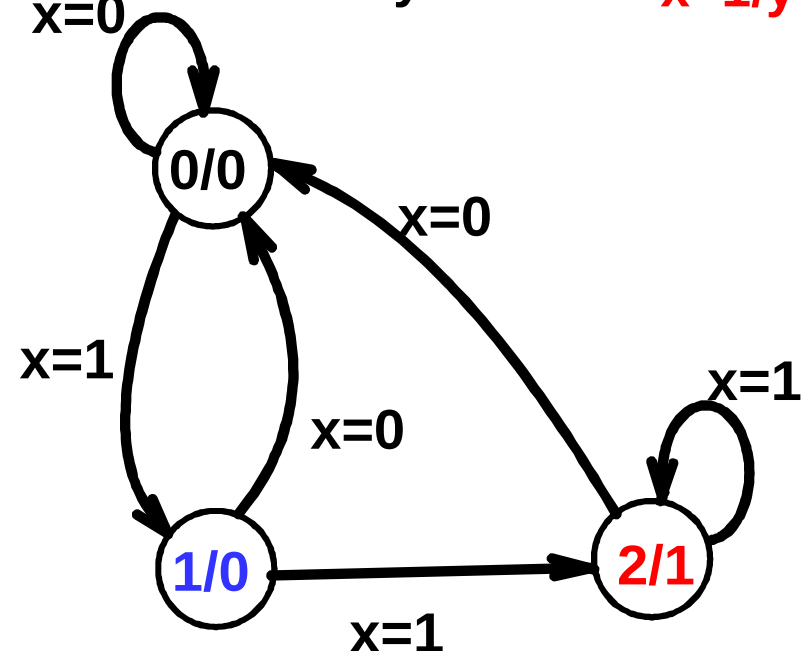


Conversion from Mealy to Moore

- Mealy Model State Diagram maps inputs and state to outputs



- Moore Model State Diagram maps states to outputs



- Mealy models have fewer states than Moore models and react faster to input.

Calculation of Allowable $t_{pd,COMB}$

- Compare the allowable combinational delay for a specific circuit:
 - a) Using edge-triggered flip-flops
 - b) Using master-slave flip-flops
- Parameters
 - $t_{pd,FF}(\text{max}) = 1.0 \text{ ns}$
 - $t_s(\text{max}) = 0.3 \text{ ns}$ for edge-triggered flip-flops
 - $t_s = t_{wH} = 2.0 \text{ ns}$ for master-slave flip-flops
 - Clock frequency = 250 MHz
- Calculations: $t_p = 1/\text{clock frequency} = 4.0 \text{ ns}$

Calculation of Allowable $t_{pd,COMB}$

- $t_p = 1/\text{clock frequency} = 4.0 \text{ ns}$
 - Edge-triggered: $4.0 \geq 1.0 + t_{pd,COMB} + 0.3$,
$$t_{pd,COMB} \leq 2.7 \text{ ns}$$
 - Master-slave: $4.0 \geq 1.0 + t_{pd,COMB} + 2.0$,
$$t_{pd,COMB} \leq 1.0 \text{ ns}$$
- **Comparison: Suppose that for a gate, $t_{pd} = 0.3 \text{ ns}$**
 - Edge-triggered: 9 gates allowed on a path
 - Master-slave: 3 gates allowed on a path